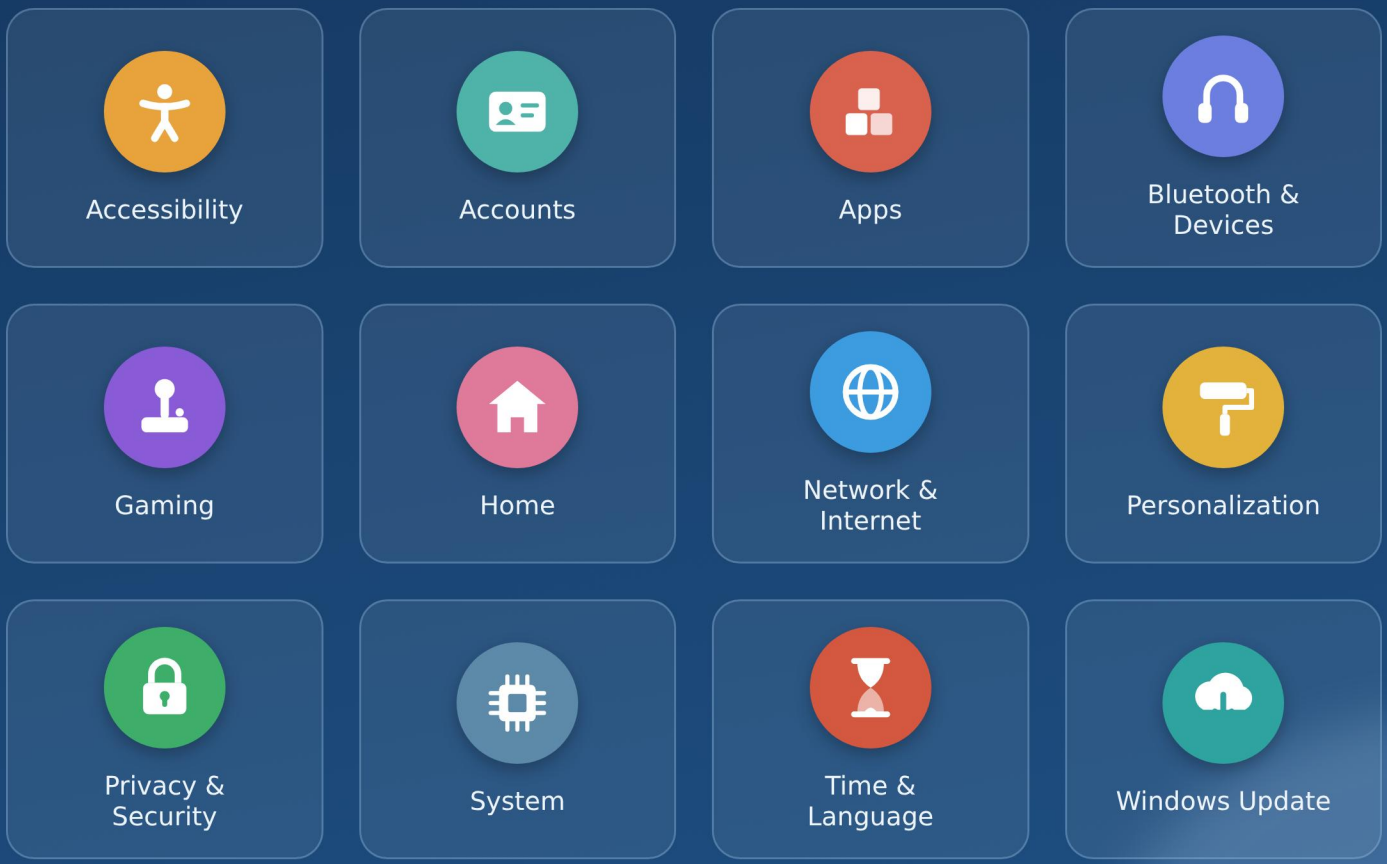
TECHNICIAN'S REFERENCE

The Windows 11 Settings Field Guide

Every page, toggle and link, side by side with the Settings app. Real-world scenarios and tech tips for technicians and everyday users.



Richard Stevens

First edition · October 2026

12 categories · 208 Settings screens · 507 pages
Verified on Windows 11, version 26H2

The Windows 11 Settings Field Guide

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Captured on Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711. The laptop Power & battery pages were captured on Windows 11 Pro, version 25H2, OS build 26200.8973. Settings change with Windows updates and can differ between devices, editions and versions.

This guide is provided “as is”, without warranty of any kind. The author is not responsible for any loss or damage resulting from changes made using it. Back up important data before changing system settings, especially on a customer’s PC.

First edition, October 2026.

This guide is dedicated to my loving sisters Dixie and Dianna.

About This Guide

Windows 11 has hundreds of settings spread across more than 200 screens in the Settings app. Most people only find the one they need after a long search, a forum thread, or a call to someone who "knows computers." The Windows 11 Settings Field Guide puts every one of them in one place and explains each in plain language.

Built to sit beside the Settings app

This guide is designed to be open on screen next to Windows Settings. Put the PDF on one side and Settings on the other, and work through a page together: every row in the guide matches something you can see, in the same order, with the same wording. You always know where you are, what each control does, and whether you have found everything on the page. Use the bookmarks panel or the clickable contents to jump straight to any page.

What's inside

- **Every page of the Settings app.** All 12 categories, from Accessibility to Windows Update: 208 Settings screens across 507 pages, in alphabetical order.
- **Checked against a real PC.** Every toggle, dropdown, button and link was recorded from screenshots of Windows 11 Pro, not written from memory. On-screen wording is quoted exactly, so what you read matches what you see.
- **The exact path to every page.** For example Settings → Privacy & security → Camera, so you always know where you are and how to get back.
- **A scenario for every setting.** Each entry says what the setting is for, with a short real-world situation where you would need it.
- **A Tech tip on every page.** The finer points that are not on the screen, such as shortcuts, common mistakes, and what to check first.

Why the scenarios matter

People rarely ask "where is the Filter keys setting?" They say "my keyboard stopped working," "my screen zoomed in by itself," or "my laptop shuts off when I close the lid." The scenarios connect those everyday problems to the setting that fixes them, so you can start from the symptom you have, not from a technical term you do not know yet.

For technicians

- Get from a customer's complaint to the right setting in seconds, on a service call or over the phone.
- See which settings are commonly changed by accident, and how to put them back.
- Spot when a problem comes from an organization's policy, a missing permission, or a hardware limit rather than a fault.
- Use it as a study and interview reference alongside CompTIA A+ preparation.

For everyday users

- No jargon and no prior experience needed. Each setting is described in plain terms, with an example of when you would use it.
- Fix common annoyances yourself, such as notifications, ads in Start, screen brightness, sleep timers and privacy settings, without risking something you do not understand.
- Learn what a setting does before you change it, with clear notes on the ones to be careful with.

Whether you fix computers for a living or just want yours to behave, this guide shows you where each setting lives, what it does, and when to use it.

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Accessibility

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- Audio
- Hearing Devices
- Captions
- Speech
- Keyboard
- Mouse
- Eye Control

Accessibility

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Accessibility Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility

Item	Description	Scenario
Vision (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Text size**	Icon of a large and small “A”. Subtext: “Text size that appears throughout Windows and your apps”. Opens the Text size page (documented below)	Customer with low vision wants larger text
▸ **Visual effects**	Sparkle icon. Subtext: “Scroll bars, transparency, animations, notification timeout”. Opens the Visual effects page (documented below)	Customer finds scroll bars, transparency or animations hard to see or distracting, or wants notifications to stay longer
▸ **Mouse pointer and touch**	Pointer icon. Subtext: “Mouse pointer color, size”. Opens the Mouse pointer and touch page	Customer has trouble locating the mouse pointer

	(documented below)	
▶ **Text cursor**	Text cursor icon. Subtext: “Appearance and thickness, text cursor indicator”. Opens the Text cursor page (documented below)	Customer has trouble finding the text cursor when typing
▶ **Magnifier**	Magnifying glass icon. Subtext: “Magnifier reading, zoom increment”. Opens the Magnifier page (documented below)	Customer needs to zoom into the screen
▶ **Color filters**	Palette icon. Subtext: “Colorblindness filters, grayscale, inverted”. Opens the Color filters page (documented below)	Customer with color blindness has trouble telling colors apart
▶ **Screen tint**	Layers icon. Subtext: “Add a subtle color overlay to make your screen more comfortable to view”. Opens the Screen tint page (documented below)	Customer has eye strain and wants a soft color overlay
▶ **Contrast themes**	Half-filled circle icon. Subtext: “Color themes for low vision, light sensitivity”. Opens the Contrast themes page	Customer wants a high-contrast theme

	(documented below)	
▸ **Narrator**	Screen icon with speech bubble. Subtext: “Voice, verbosity, keyboard, braille”. Opens the Narrator page (documented below)	Customer who is blind or has low vision needs Windows read aloud
Hearing (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Audio**	Speaker icon. Subtext: “Mono audio, audio notifications”. Opens the Audio page (documented below)	Customer who is deaf or hard of hearing in one ear wants mono audio, or a flash instead of sound
▸ **Hearing devices**	Ear icon. Subtext: “Presets, environment sound control, audio routing”. Opens the Hearing devices page (documented below)	Customer with a hearing aid wants to pair or manage it
▸ **Captions**	“CC” icon. Subtext: “Styles, live captions”. Opens the Captions page (documented below)	Customer wants captions for audio and video
Interaction (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Speech**	Microphone icon.	Customer wants

	Subtext: “Voice access, voice typing”. Opens the Speech page (documented below)	to control the PC or type by voice
▸ **Keyboard**	Keyboard icon. Subtext: “Sticky, Filter, and Toggle keys, on-screen keyboard”. Opens the Keyboard page (documented below)	Customer has trouble holding several keys at once, or needs an on-screen keyboard
▸ **Mouse**	Mouse icon. Subtext: “Mouse keys, speed, acceleration”. Opens the Mouse page (documented below)	Customer wants to move the pointer with the keypad, or change click settings
▸ **Eye control**	Eye-in-frame icon. Subtext: “Eye tracker, text-to-speech”. Opens the Eye control page (documented below)	Customer with an eye tracker wants to control the PC with their eyes

Tech tip: The page is grouped into Vision, Hearing and Interaction. Every row opens the page of the same name.

Text Size

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Text size

Item	Description	Scenario
Text size preview	Subtext: “The size of these words will change	Customer wants to see how large

	as you adjust the slider. Changes you make here will apply to most of the text on your device." Live preview text	the text will be before applying the change
Text size	Subtext: "Text size that appears throughout Windows and your apps". Slider (A → A) and Apply button	Customer with low vision wants larger text throughout Windows without changing display scaling

Tech tip: Text size makes text larger without resizing icons and layout, which display scaling would do.

Visual Effects

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Visual effects

Item	Description	Scenario
Always show scrollbars	Toggle, Off	Customer has trouble finding the scroll bar because it is hidden until they use it
Transparency effects	Subtext: "Make some window backgrounds slightly transparent". Toggle, On	Customer finds see-through window backgrounds hard to read, or

		wants them off for better performance on older hardware
Animation effects	Toggle, On	Customer is bothered by window animations, or the PC feels slow
Dismiss notifications after this amount of time	Dropdown, “5 seconds”	Customer says notifications disappear before they can read them

Tech tip: Turning off Animation effects and Transparency effects can make an older PC feel quicker and helps people who are sensitive to motion. A longer Dismiss notifications time helps customers who read slowly or miss pop-ups.

Mouse Pointer and Touch

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Mouse pointer and touch

Item	Description	Scenario
Mouse pointer (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Mouse pointer style**	Expandable row. 4 selectable style tiles: White (default), Black,	Customer has trouble locating the pointer and

	Inverted (black/white), Custom color (green)	wants a different color or style
▸ **Size**	Slider (small → large cursor)	Customer wants a bigger pointer
▸ **Customize pointer image**	Subtext: “Preview and change the appearance of each pointer image”. Collapsed	Customer wants to change how individual pointers look
▸ **Mouse indicator**	Subtext: “Show a circle around the mouse pointer when I press the Ctrl key”. Toggle, Off	Customer loses track of the pointer and wants a circle to find it when they press Ctrl
▸ **Mouse pointer trails**	Subtext: “Make mouse pointer movement easier to see by showing previous positions for a short time”. Toggle, Off, collapsed	Customer has trouble following the pointer as it moves
▸ **Enable mouse pointer shadow**	Subtext: “Show shadow under the mouse pointer”. Toggle, On	Customer wants the pointer to stand out more, or wants the shadow off
Touch indicator (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Touch**	Subtext: “Show a circle	Customer using

indicator	on the screen where I touch it". Expandable row. Toggle, On	a touchscreen wants visual feedback showing where they touched
▹ **Make the circle darker and larger**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer has trouble seeing the touch circle

Tech tip: For a customer who keeps losing the pointer, a larger size with the Custom color style is the quickest fix. The Mouse indicator (a circle when Ctrl is pressed) helps on large screens and multiple monitors.

Text Cursor

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Text cursor

Item	Description	Scenario
Text cursor indicator	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer has trouble finding their text cursor when typing in documents or browsers
▶ **Size**	Slider (small → large teardrop icon)	Customer wants a larger indicator on the text cursor
▶ **Recommended colors**	7 swatches: Purple (selected), Green, Yellow, Orange, Pink,	Customer wants the indicator in a color that stands

	Blue, Teal	out
▸ **Choose another color**	“+” button	Customer wants a color that is not among the seven swatches
Text cursor thickness (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Text cursor thickness preview**	“Here’s a preview of your changes.” Live preview	Customer wants to see a thickness change before settling on it
▸ **Text cursor thickness**	Slider (thin “Ab” → thick “Ab”)	Customer wants a thicker text cursor
Cursor blink rate (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Cursor blink rate preview**	“Here’s a preview of your changes.” Live preview	Customer wants to see a blink rate change before settling on it
▸ **Cursor blink rate**	Slider (None → Fast); Apply button (grayed out)	Customer finds the blinking distracting, or wants it faster or slower to track

		more easily

Tech tip: The Text cursor indicator adds a colored marker to the blinking cursor, which helps customers who lose their place while typing. Moving Cursor blink rate to None stops the blinking, which some people find distracting.

Magnifier

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Magnifier

Item	Description	Scenario
Magnifier	Subtext: “Press the Windows logo key ⊞ + the Plus sign to turn on Magnifier—and press the Windows logo key ⊞ + Esc to turn it off”. Toggle, Off	Customer with low vision needs to zoom into the screen to read small text, and the tech needs the shortcuts to turn it on and off
Zoom level	Subtext: “Press the Windows logo key ⊞ + the Plus sign or the Minus sign to zoom in or out—or press and hold Ctrl + Alt and rotate your mouse wheel”. “–” button, “200%”, “+” button	Customer wants Magnifier to zoom in more or less
Zoom increment	Dropdown, “100% (default)”	Customer says each zoom step is too big or too

		small
View	Dropdown, “Full screen (Ctrl + Alt + F)”; arrow	Customer wants to change how Magnifier is shown on the screen

Tech tip: If a customer says the screen suddenly “zoomed in”, Magnifier was probably turned on by accident with the Windows logo key + Plus sign. Press the Windows logo key + Esc to turn it off.

Color Filters

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Color filters

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Use a color filter to make colors on your screen easier to see and differentiate.”	—
Color filter preview (section header)	Color wheel graphic, colorful pinwheel photo, and gradient swatch chart (Red, Orange, Yellow, Green, Blue rows). Visual previews only	Customer wants to see what a filter does to colors before choosing it
Color filters	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer with color blindness has trouble

		telling certain colors apart, or wants a grayscale or inverted display for light sensitivity or reading comfort
▶ **Intensity**	Slider	Customer says the filter is too strong or too weak
▶ **Color Boost**	Slider	Customer wants colors stronger or softer
▶ **Reset intensity and color boost to defaults**	Reset button	Customer has adjusted the sliders and wants to start over
▶ **Filter type**	Radio buttons: Red-green (green weak, deuteranopia); Red-green (red weak, protanopia); Blue-yellow (tritanopia); Grayscale (selected); Grayscale inverted; Inverted	Customer knows which kind of color blindness they have, or wants grayscale or inverted colors

Tech tip: Color filters are for telling colors apart. Screen tint is for eye comfort, and turning it on disables color filters.

Screen Tint

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Screen tint

Item	Description	Scenario
Info banner	Text: “Turning on screen tint will disable color filters. If you use color filters frequently, you may need to keep screen tint off.” “Open color filters settings” link	Customer turns on screen tint and their color filter stops working
Show a color overlay on your display to reduce eye strain and improve viewing comfort	Toggle, Off	Customer has eye strain from long screen use and wants a soft color overlay
Tint color	6 swatches: Orange, Pink (selected), Yellow, Blue, Green, Gray	Customer wants a different overlay color
Custom tint	“View colors” button	Customer wants a tint color that is not among the swatches
Strength	Slider	Customer says the overlay is too strong or too faint

Tech tip: Screen tint is for eye comfort. Color filters are for telling colors apart. Turning on screen tint disables color filters.

Contrast Themes

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Contrast themes

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: "Use more distinct colors to make text and apps easier to see."	—
Theme preview (section header)	4 preview tiles: Aquatic, Desert, Dusk, Night sky	Customer wants to see the themes before choosing one
Contrast themes	Dropdown, "None"; Apply, Edit and Delete buttons (grayed out)	Customer with low vision or light sensitivity wants a high-contrast theme applied across Windows
Keyboard shortcut for contrast themes	Subtext: "Press left Alt + left Shift + Print Screen to turn a contrast theme on and off". Expandable row. Toggle, On	Customer wants the shortcut, or their screen suddenly changed colors
▸ **Notify me when I turn on contrast**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants a notification when the

theme from the keyboard		shortcut changes the theme
▸ **Play a sound when I turn contrast theme on or off from the keyboard**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants a sound when the shortcut changes the theme

Tech tip: The shortcut left Alt + left Shift + Print Screen turns a contrast theme on and off, so a customer whose screen suddenly changed colors may have pressed it by accident.

Narrator

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Narrator

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Narrator is a screen reader that describes what’s on your screen.”	—
Use Narrator (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Narrator**	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer who is blind or has low vision needs Windows read aloud to them
▸ **Keyboard**	Subtext: “Press the	Customer started

shortcut for Narrator	Windows logo key ⊞ + Ctrl + Enter to turn Narrator on and off". Toggle, On	Narrator by accident, or needs the shortcut to turn it on or off
▸ **Narrator Home**	Subtext: "Get help, access settings, and learn about new Narrator features". Collapsed	Customer wants help with Narrator or its settings
▸ **What's new in Narrator**	External link	Customer wants to know about new Narrator features
▸ **Complete guide to Narrator**	External link	Customer wants Microsoft's full instructions for Narrator
Narrator's voice (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Choose a voice**	Dropdown, "Microsoft David - English (United States)"	Customer wants Narrator to speak with a different voice
▸ **Add voices**	Add button	Customer wants more voices or languages for Narrator
▸ **Lower the volume of**	Toggle, On	Customer cannot hear Narrator

other apps when Narrator is speaking		over other sound, or wants other apps left at full volume
▸ **Narrator audio output device**	Dropdown, “Default audio device”	Customer wants Narrator to speak through headphones or another device
Verbosity (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Verbosity level**	Subtext: “Press Narrator + V to change verbosity”. Dropdown, “3 - All control details”	Customer says Narrator says too much or too little
▸ **Context level for buttons and controls**	Dropdown, “3 - Immediate context name and type”	Customer wants more or less context read out for buttons and controls
▸ **Have Narrator announce when I type**	Expandable row.	Customer wants to choose which typed keys Narrator announces
▹ **Letters, numbers, and punctuation**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants typed characters read back, or turned off

▹ **Words**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants whole words read back after typing
▹ **Function keys**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants function key presses announced
▹ **Arrow, Tab, and other navigation keys**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants navigation key presses announced
▹ **Toggle keys, like Caps lock and Num lock**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants Caps Lock and Num Lock changes announced
▹ **Shift, Alt, and other modifier keys**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants modifier key presses announced
Mouse and keyboard (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Narrator key**	Dropdown, “Caps Lock or Insert”	Customer wants to change which key is used for Narrator commands

▸ **On touch keyboards, activate keys when I lift my finger**	Toggle, Off	Customer using a touch keyboard wants keys to activate when they lift their finger
▸ **Read and interact with the screen using the mouse**	Toggle, Off	Customer wants Narrator to read what the mouse points at
▸ **Keyboard layout**	Dropdown, “Standard”	Customer wants a different Narrator keyboard layout
Narrator cursor (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Show the Narrator cursor**	Subtext: “The Narrator cursor is where Narrator is focused on your screen”. Toggle, On	Customer with low vision wants to see where Narrator is focused, or wants it hidden
▸ **Move my text cursor with the Narrator cursor as**	Toggle, Off	Customer wants the text cursor to follow Narrator as it reads

Narrator reads text		
▸ **Sync the Narrator cursor and system focus**	Toggle, On	Customer says Narrator and the system focus are in different places
▸ **Navigation mode**	Subtext: “Normal mode is recommended”. Dropdown, “Normal”	Customer wants Narrator to move through the screen differently
Braille (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Use a braille display with Narrator**	Subtext: “To use your braille display, you’ll need to install software”. Link that opens a sub-page	Customer has a braille display and wants to use it with Narrator
Experimental features (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Enable Narrator extensions**	Subtext: “Extensions customize the Narrator experience in some apps”. Toggle, On	Customer wants Narrator to behave differently in some apps
Manage data and services	Section header	—

(section header)		
▸ **Sync my Narrator settings on this device**	Subtext: “Anyone who signs into this PC can use and edit these settings (recommended for serial braille display users)”. Sync settings button	Customer wants every user on the PC to share the same Narrator settings
▸ **Get image descriptions, page titles, and popular links**	Subtext: “Press Narrator + Ctrl + D for an image description or page title—press Narrator + S twice quickly for a list of popular links”. Toggle, On	Customer wants Narrator to describe images or list popular links
▸ **Automatically send diagnostic and performance data**	Subtext: “Restart Narrator after turning this on—press Narrator + Alt + F to give feedback”. Toggle, Off	Customer asks whether Narrator sends data to Microsoft
▸ **Privacy Statement**	Subtext: “Understand how Microsoft uses your Narrator data and for what purposes”. External link	Customer wants to read how Narrator data is used

Tech tip: A PC that suddenly starts reading everything out loud usually has Narrator turned on by accident with the

Windows logo key + Ctrl + Enter. Press the same keys to turn it off, or turn off Keyboard shortcut for Narrator here to stop it happening again.

Audio

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Audio

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Make your device easier to hear or use without sound.”	—
Mono audio	Subtext: “Combine left and right audio channels into one”. Toggle, Off	Customer who is deaf or hard of hearing in one ear misses sounds that play only on the other side
Flash my screen during audio notifications	Dropdown, “Never”	Customer wants a visual flash instead of, or along with, notification sounds

Tech tip: Mono audio helps a customer with hearing in only one ear, or who listens with a single earbud, so they do not miss sound played on one side. Flashing the screen gives a visual alert in place of a notification sound.

Hearing Devices

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Hearing devices

Item	Description	Scenario
Your PC supports Bluetooth LE Audio hearing devices	Text: “Add your Bluetooth LE Audio hearing devices to your PC, then open Bluetooth settings to manage them.” “Go to Bluetooth” button	Customer with a compatible hearing aid wants to pair it with the PC, and the tech needs to know whether the hardware supports it
Connect a new device to this PC	Add device button	Customer is ready to pair a hearing device
More about Bluetooth LE Audio hearing devices	External link (opens icon)	Customer wants Microsoft’s information about compatible hearing devices
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Sound**	Subtext: “Volume levels, output, input, balance level, sound devices”. Link/row	Customer paired a hearing device and needs to adjust its volume separately from system volume

▸ **App volume and device preferences**	Subtext: “Volume levels per app, speakers”. Link/row	Customer wants to set volume for individual apps

Tech tip: The Related settings rows (Sound, App volume and device preferences) are worth pointing out to a customer who pairs a hearing device and then needs to adjust its volume separately from system volume. Those controls are one click away, not on this page.

Captions

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Captions

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Make your device easier to use without sound by displaying audio as text.”	—
Theme preview (section header)	Sample photo with caption overlay “Waves are caused by a flow of energy.”; expand icon	Customer wants to see how captions will look
Live captions	Subtext: “Audio and video will be captioned live on your screen”. Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer who is deaf or hard of hearing wants captions for any audio or video, not only apps with built-in captioning
▸ **Live captions**	“Press the Windows logo	Customer wants

shortcut text	key ⊞ + Ctrl + L to turn live captions on." Descriptive text	a quick way to start live captions
▶ **Live captions download and privacy text**	"Turning on live captions will download the live captions language files. Voice data will be processed locally and your data isn't shared to the cloud." Descriptive text	Customer asks whether live captions send their voice data to the cloud
Caption style	Dropdown, "Default"; Edit button, Delete button (grayed out)	Customer wants captions to look different

Tech tip: Live captions (Windows logo key + Ctrl + L) caption any audio playing on the PC, including video calls. Once the language files are downloaded, the speech is processed on the device.

Speech

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Speech

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: "Use your voice to type and control your device."	—
Voice access	Subtext: "Modern voice command feature to help you interact with your PC and dictate text".	Customer with limited mobility wants to control the whole PC

	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	and dictate text by voice
▸ **Voice access shortcut text**	“Press the Windows logo key ⊞ + Ctrl + S to turn voice access on or off.” Descriptive text	Customer wants a quick way to turn voice access on or off
▸ **Start voice access before you sign in to your PC**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants voice access to be usable at the sign-in screen
▸ **Start voice access after you sign in to your PC**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants voice access to start on its own after signing in
▸ **Related links: Learn more about voice access**	Link	Customer wants Microsoft’s information about voice access
Other voice command options (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Voice typing**	Text: “Dictate text with your voice. Press the Windows logo key ⊞ + H or select the mic button 🎙️ on the touch	Customer wants to dictate text only, without full voice control of the PC

	keyboard to dictate text anytime you're in a text box." Descriptive text	

Tech tip: Voice access (Windows logo key + Ctrl + S) controls the whole PC by voice, while voice typing (Windows logo key + H) is for dictating text only. Customers often mix the two up.

Keyboard

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Keyboard

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: "Make it easier to type and use keyboard shortcuts."	—
Sticky, Filter, and Toggle keys (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Sticky keys**	Subtext: "Press keyboard shortcuts that use multiple keys (such as Ctrl + S) one key at a time". Toggle, Off; arrow opens the Sticky keys page (documented below)	Customer with limited dexterity has trouble holding down several keys at once
▸ **Filter keys**	Subtext: "Set the sensitivity of the	Customer with tremors gets

	keyboard so it can ignore brief or repeated keystrokes". Toggle, Off; arrow opens the Filter keys page (documented below)	repeated keystrokes by accident
▶ **Toggle keys**	Subtext: "Play a sound when you press caps, num, or scroll lock". Toggle, Off	Customer wants a sound when Caps Lock, Num Lock or Scroll Lock changes
▶ **Notification preferences**	Expandable row.	Customer wants to change the alerts for Sticky, Filter and Toggle keys
▷ **Notify me when I turn on Sticky, Filter, or Toggle keys from the keyboard**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants a notification when one of these is turned on from the keyboard
▷ **Play a sound when I turn Sticky, Filter, or Toggle keys on or off from the keyboard**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants a sound when one of these is turned on or off from the keyboard

On-screen keyboard and access keys (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **On-screen keyboard**	Subtext: “Press the Windows logo key ⊞ + Ctrl + O to turn the on-screen keyboard on or off”. Toggle, Off	Customer cannot use a physical keyboard and needs the on-screen one
▸ **Underline access keys**	Subtext: “Access keys will be underlined even when not holding Alt”. Toggle, Off	Customer wants menu access keys always underlined
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Keyboard device**	Keyboard icon. Subtext: “Character repeat, hotkeys”.	Customer wants to change character repeat or hotkey settings

Tech tip: Sticky keys and Filter keys each have their own page, documented next.

Keyboard → Sticky Keys

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Keyboard → Sticky keys

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Make keyboard shortcuts easier by pressing each key individually, so you don’t have to hold multiple keys at once.”	—
Keyboard shortcut for Sticky keys	Subtext: “Press the Shift key 5 times to turn Sticky keys on or off”. Toggle, On	Customer turned Sticky keys on by accident after pressing Shift five times
Show the Sticky keys icon on the taskbar	Toggle, On	Customer wants to see when Sticky keys is active
Lock shortcut keys when pressed twice in a row	Subtext: “Shortcut keys include Shift, Ctrl, Alt and Windows logo key”. Toggle, On	Customer wants a shortcut key to stay held down until they press it again
Turn off Sticky keys when two keys are pressed at the same time	Toggle, On	Customer wants Sticky keys to switch off when they press two keys together
Play a sound when shortcut keys are	Subtext: “Shortcut keys include Shift, Ctrl, Alt, and the Windows logo	Customer wants a sound when a shortcut key is

pressed and released	key”. Toggle, On	pressed and released

Tech tip: Pressing Shift five times brings up the Sticky keys prompt, which gamers often trigger by accident. Turn off Keyboard shortcut for Sticky keys to stop the prompt.

Keyboard → Filter Keys

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Keyboard → Filter keys

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Set the sensitivity of the keyboard so it can ignore brief or repeated keystrokes.”	—
Keyboard shortcut for Filter keys	Subtext: “Press and hold the right Shift key for 8 seconds to turn on Filter keys”. Toggle, On	Customer’s keyboard suddenly ignores or slows keystrokes after they held the right Shift key
Show the Filter keys icon on the taskbar	Toggle, On	Customer wants to see when Filter keys is active
Beep when keys are pressed or	Toggle, On	Customer wants a beep when a keystroke is

accepted		accepted
Ignore quick keystrokes (slow keys)	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer wants the keyboard to ignore keys that are pressed only briefly
▸ **Wait before accepting a keystroke**	Dropdown, “0.0 seconds”	Customer needs a longer or shorter wait before a keystroke counts
Ignore unintended keystrokes (bounce keys)	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer’s tremor causes the same key to register twice
▸ **Wait before accepting repeated keystrokes**	Dropdown, “0.0 seconds”	Customer needs a longer or shorter wait before a repeated keystroke counts
Ignore repeated keystrokes (repeat keys)	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer’s held keys repeat too easily
▸ **Wait before accepting the first repeated keystroke**	Dropdown, “0.0 seconds”	Customer needs a longer or shorter wait before a key starts repeating

▶ **Wait before accepting subsequent repeated keystrokes**	Dropdown, “0.0 seconds”	Customer needs a longer or shorter wait between repeats

Tech tip: Holding the right Shift key for 8 seconds turns on Filter keys, after which the keyboard seems to ignore or lag on keystrokes. This is a classic “my keyboard stopped working” call. Check here and turn Filter keys off.

Mouse

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Mouse

Item	Description	Scenario
Snap to default button	Subtext: “Move mouse pointer to default button when opening a supported dialog”. Toggle, Off	Customer with limited dexterity wants the pointer to jump to the default button in dialog boxes
Hide pointer while typing	Subtext: “Hide mouse pointer if typing in supported apps”. Toggle, On	Customer says the pointer gets in the way of what they are typing, or wants it left visible
Double click speed	Subtext: “Amount of time needed between two clicks to make them a double click”. Slider	Customer has trouble double-clicking accurately

Click lock	Subtext: “Enables you to highlight or drag without holding down the mouse button”. Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer has trouble holding the mouse button down while dragging or highlighting
▸ **Amount of time mouse button needs to be down to lock**	Slider (disabled)	Customer wants Click lock to engage faster or slower
Activate on hover	Subtext: “Change which window receives keyboard input without clicking”. Expandable row. Toggle, Off	Customer wants a window to become active just by pointing at it
▸ **Amount of time mouse needs to be over a window to activate it**	Slider (disabled)	Customer wants windows to activate faster or slower on hover
▸ **Move window to top when activating for mouse hover**	Checkbox, unchecked (disabled)	Customer wants a window to come to the front when it activates
Mouse keys	Subtext: “Use your numeric keypad to move your mouse pointer”.	Customer cannot use a physical mouse and

	Expandable row. Toggle, Off	wants to move the pointer with the numeric keypad
▸ **Only use mouse keys when Num lock is on**	Checkbox, checked (disabled)	Customer wants mouse keys to work only while Num Lock is on
▸ **Show the mouse keys icon on the taskbar**	Checkbox, checked (disabled)	Customer wants to see when mouse keys is active
▸ **Hold the Ctrl key to speed up and the Shift key to slow down**	Checkbox, unchecked (disabled)	Customer wants to speed up or slow down the pointer with Ctrl and Shift
▸ **Mouse keys speed**	Subtext: “Change how fast the pointer moves when using mouse keys”. Slider with “–” and “+” (disabled)	Customer says the pointer moves too fast or too slowly with mouse keys
▸ **Mouse keys acceleration**	Subtext: “Change how quickly the pointer starts & stops when using mouse keys”. Slider with “–” and “+” (disabled)	Customer says the pointer starts or stops too abruptly or too slowly with mouse keys

Tech tip: The controls under Click lock, Activate on hover and Mouse keys are disabled until the toggle for that feature is turned on.

Eye Control

Navigation path: Settings → Accessibility → Eye control

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: "Use your eyes to control your device and use text-to-speech to talk."	—
Eye control	Subtext: "Connect an eye tracker to use eye control." (info icon). Expandable row. Toggle, Off (disabled, requires hardware)	Customer with an eye-tracking device wants to control the PC with eye movements, and the tech sees the toggle is disabled because no eye tracker is connected
▸ **Eye control keyboard layout text**	"When typing with eye control, only the EN-US keyboard layout is supported." Descriptive text	Customer using another keyboard layout asks why typing with eye control does not work for them

▶ **Related links: More info about eye control**	Link	Customer wants Microsoft's information about eye control
Privacy Statement	Subtext: "Understand how Microsoft uses your eye control data and for what purposes". External link	Customer asks how their eye control data is used

Tech tip: Eye control needs a connected eye tracker, so its toggle stays disabled without one.

SECTION 02 OF 12

Accounts

14 Settings screens · pages 50–77

- Your Info
- Sign-in Options
- Your Accounts
- Family
- Windows Backup
- Other Users
- Access Work or School
- Passkeys

Accounts

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Accounts Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts

Item	Description	Scenario
Account summary (top of page)	Circular avatar image, the account name, the account type (for example “Local Account”) and the role (for example “Administrator”)	Tech confirms who is signed in, and whether the account is local and has administrator rights
Rewards	Rewards icon. Subtext: “Sign In”	Customer asks about the Rewards link at the top of the page
OneDrive	Cloud icon. Subtext: “Back up files”	Customer wants to back up their files to OneDrive
Microsoft account	Microsoft logo. Subtext: “Sign in to get the most out of Windows”. Expandable row, shown expanded (contents below)	Customer on a local account wants to switch to a Microsoft account
▸ **Heading and**	“One account for	Customer asks

description	everything Microsoft". "Access your favorite Microsoft products and services with just one account. Your Microsoft account connects you to the files, photos, people, and content you care about most."	what a Microsoft account is for
▸ **Sign in and Learn more**	Sign in button and Learn more link, with an illustration of a laptop surrounded by app icons	Customer wants to sign in with a Microsoft account, or read about it first
Account settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Your info**	Person icon. Subtext: "Profile photo". Opens the Your info page (documented below)	Customer wants to change their profile photo or check their account type
▸ **Sign-in options**	Key icon. Subtext: "Windows Hello, security key, password, dynamic lock". Opens the Sign-in options page (documented below)	Customer wants to set up a PIN, face or fingerprint sign-in, or a password change
▸ **Your**	List-of-accounts icon. Subtext: "Add or manage	Customer wants to add or

accounts	accounts used in Windows". Opens the Your accounts page (documented below)	manage the accounts they use in Windows
▸ **Family**	Heart-and-person icon. Subtext: "Manage your family group, edit account types and device permissions". Opens the Family page (documented below)	Customer with kids or family members sharing the PC wants parental controls
▸ **Windows backup**	Backup icon. Subtext: "Back up your files, apps, preferences to restore them across devices". Opens the Windows backup page (documented below)	Customer is setting up a new PC or preparing for a reset
▸ **Other users**	Person-with-plus icon. Subtext: "Device access, work or school users, kiosk assigned access". Opens the Other users page (documented below)	Customer wants a separate login for another person, or a kiosk setup
▸ **Access work or school**	Briefcase icon. Subtext: "Organization resources like email, apps, and network". Opens the Access work or school page (documented	Customer needs to connect a work or school account to the PC

	below)	
▶ **Passkeys**	Person-with-key icon. Subtext: “Use your face, fingerprint, or PIN to sign in to apps and websites”. Opens the Passkeys page (documented below)	Customer wants to sign in to apps and websites with passkeys instead of passwords
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Account privacy**	Shield icon. Subtext: “View your privacy dashboard and manage activity data”. External-link icon	Customer wants to see or manage the data Microsoft keeps about their activity
▶ **Subscriptions**	List icon. Subtext: “Manage services and subscriptions from Microsoft”. External-link icon	Customer wants to check or cancel a Microsoft subscription
▶ **Rewards**	Medal icon. Subtext: “Earn and redeem points for using your favorite services and more”. External-link icon	Customer wants to use Microsoft Rewards points
▶ **Payment options**	Card icon. Subtext: “Manage how you pay	Customer wants to update the

	for purchases with your Microsoft account". External-link icon	card used for Microsoft purchases
▸ **Order history**	Clock-and-list icon. Subtext: "View recent purchases made with your Microsoft account". External-link icon	Customer wants to find a past Microsoft purchase
▸ **Account & billing help**	Question mark icon. Subtext: "Get support for subscriptions, payments, and billing". External-link icon	Customer needs support with a subscription, payment or billing problem

Tech tip: The main Accounts page repeats the account name, type and role from Your info, and every row under Account settings opens the page of the same name.

Your Info

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Your info

Item	Description	Scenario
Profile photo	Circular avatar image	Customer wants to personalize the picture shown for their account
Account name	The name of the signed-in user	Tech confirms which account is signed in
Account type	For example "Local	Customer is not

	account”	sure whether their account is local or linked to a Microsoft account
Account role	For example “Administrator”	Tech confirms the user has administrator rights before installing software or changing settings
Adjust your photo (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Take a photo**	“Open Camera” button	Customer wants to use a photo taken with their webcam
▸ **Choose a file**	“Browse files” button	Customer wants to use a picture saved on the PC
Account settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Sync card**	“Windows is better when settings and files automatically sync”.	Customer on a local account asks what a

	Descriptive card, shown for a local account	Microsoft account would add
▸ **Sign in with a Microsoft account instead**	Link	Customer wants to switch to a Microsoft account for cloud sync of settings and files

Tech tip: Check Account role first when a customer cannot install software or change system settings: a Standard user needs an administrator to approve those changes. Before using Sign in with a Microsoft account instead, make sure the customer knows the password for that Microsoft account.

Sign-in Options

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Sign-in options

Item	Description	Scenario
Ways to sign in (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Facial recognition (Windows Hello)**	Face icon. Expandable row. When it cannot be used it shows “This option is currently unavailable”	Customer wants to sign in with their face
▸ **Fingerprint recognition (Windows**	Fingerprint icon. Expandable row. When it cannot be used it shows	Customer wants to sign in with a fingerprint

Hello)	“This option is currently unavailable”	
▶ **PIN (Windows Hello)**	Keypad icon. Expandable row. When it cannot be used it shows “This option is currently unavailable”	Customer wants a PIN for faster sign-in
▶ **Security key**	USB security key icon. Subtext: “Sign in with a physical security key”. Expandable row	Customer wants to sign in with a physical security key
▶ **Password**	Key icon. Subtext: “Sign in with your account’s password”. Expandable row	Customer wants to change or review their password sign-in
Additional settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Dynamic lock**	Subtext: “Automatically lock your device when you’re away”. Expandable row	Customer wants the PC to lock itself when they walk away
▶ **Automatically save my restartable apps and restart them when I sign**	Toggle, Off	Customer’s apps do not reopen on their own after an update

back in		
▸ **Show account details such as my email address on the sign-in screen**	Toggle, Off	Customer wants their email address hidden or shown on the lock screen for privacy
▸ **Use my sign-in info to automatically finish setting up after an update**	Toggle, On	Customer wants Windows to finish setup after an update without asking them to sign in again
Related (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Lock screen personalization**	Monitor-with-lock icon. Subtext: “Apps and status, background picture, animations”. Cross-reference: Personalization → Lock screen	Customer wants to change what the lock screen shows
▸ **More about sign-in options**	Link, external-link icon. Opens an external help page	Customer wants Microsoft’s help page on sign-in options
Related	Section header	—

support (section header)		
▸ **Help with Sign-in options**	Globe icon. Expandable row, shown expanded. Contains help links, for example “Enabling automatic device locking feature” and “Changing your Microsoft account password”	Customer wants Microsoft’s help articles on sign-in options

Tech tip: The “Restart apps” link under Windows Update → Advanced options does not lead to its own page. It opens Sign-in options and lands on the “Automatically save my restartable apps” toggle. Also, “This option is currently unavailable” does not always mean broken hardware. It can mean the needed hardware (an IR camera or fingerprint reader) is missing, or the PIN has not been set up yet.

Your Accounts

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Your accounts

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Heading text: “Add or manage accounts used by apps in Windows”	—
Add accounts	Row with two links: “Add a Microsoft account” and “Add a work or school account”	Customer wants to add another account for the apps in Windows

		to use
Account rows	One row per account. Each shows an avatar (a photo or a default person icon), the account's email address and the account type, for example "Microsoft account". Down arrow expands the row	Customer has several accounts listed and wants to manage one of them
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Email & accounts**	Globe icon. Expandable row, shown expanded. Links below	Customer or tech wants Microsoft's help articles on email and accounts
▷ **Adjusting email sync frequency settings**	Link	Customer's email arrives late and they want to change how often it syncs
▷ **Creating an email signature**	Link	Customer wants a signature added to their email
▷ **Signing in to Outlook**	Link	Customer cannot sign in to Outlook

Tech tip: The accounts listed here are the ones apps in Windows can use. They are not necessarily the account Windows itself is signed in to, which is shown on Your info.

Family

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Family

Item	Description	Scenario
Microsoft Family	Subtext: "Manage family safety settings, see family activity, and more". Expandable row, shown expanded (contents below)	Customer with kids or family members sharing the PC wants parental controls or screen time limits
▸ **Promo heading**	"Hi [name]! Explore Microsoft Family". Personalized heading	Customer asks why this page looks like an advertisement
▸ **Promo description**	"Stay connected with loved ones and build healthy digital habits with Microsoft Family."	—
▸ **Open Family Settings**	Button	Customer wants to open the family safety settings
▸ **Learn more**	Link	Customer wants Microsoft's information

		about Microsoft Family
▶ **Promo image**	Illustration of the Microsoft Family app across devices	—
Your family (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Sign-in message**	“Sign in with a Microsoft account to manage your family group”	Customer on a local account cannot manage a family group
▶ **Sign in**	Button	Customer wants to sign in with a Microsoft account to start managing a family group
Related (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Microsoft 365 Family**	Microsoft logo. Subtext: “Subscription”.	Customer asks about their Microsoft 365 Family subscription

Tech tip: Family features need a signed-in Microsoft account, even when the user has administrator rights on a local

account. That explains why parental control options can look unavailable or promotional only.

Windows Backup

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Windows backup

Item	Description	Scenario
Account banner	Background image and the account name	Tech confirms which account the backup status belongs to
Status summary (3 tiles)	Three tiles: OneDrive, App list, Preferences. Each shows a status, for example “Not syncing” or “Not backed up”	Customer is setting up a new PC or preparing for a reset and wants to know what is protected
▶ **Info banner**	Text: “Some of these settings are managed by your organization.” Shown when it applies	Customer on a work PC asks why settings are locked
▶ **Info banner**	Text: “Some Windows features are only available if you are using a Microsoft account or work account.” Shown when it applies	Customer on a local account asks why backup options are unavailable
OneDrive folder syncing	Subtext: “The folders you select will be protected and available	Customer wants their Desktop, Documents and

	across your devices". "Manage sync settings" button	Pictures folders backed up to OneDrive
Remember my apps	Subtext: "Get quick access to your apps on any device". Toggle, Off (disabled)	Customer wants their app list saved so a new PC can restore it
Remember my preferences	Subtext: "Quickly access your preferences across Microsoft experiences". Toggle, Off (disabled). Expanded sub-items below	Customer wants their settings to follow them to another PC
▶ **Accessibility**	Checkbox, checked (disabled, grayed out)	Customer wants accessibility settings included
▶ **Accounts, WiFi networks and passwords**	Checkbox, checked (disabled, grayed out)	Customer wants saved Wi-Fi networks and passwords included
▶ **Personalization**	Checkbox, checked (disabled, grayed out)	Customer wants their theme and personalization included
▶ **Language preferences and dictionary**	Checkbox, checked (disabled, grayed out)	Customer wants their language settings and dictionary included

▸ **Other Windows settings**	Checkbox, checked (disabled, grayed out)	Customer wants all other settings included
Privacy resources	Link row: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer asks what is stored and where
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Windows backup**	Expandable row, shown expanded. Links below	Customer or tech wants Microsoft’s backup help articles
▹ **Reconnecting your File History drive now**	Link	Customer’s File History drive was unplugged and needs reconnecting
▹ **Backing-up and Restore**	Link	Customer wants help with backing up and restoring files

Tech tip: On a local account, the Remember toggles and their checkboxes are grayed out and everything shows as Not backed up or Not syncing, even though the checkboxes look

checked. A Microsoft or work account is required for these features.

Other Users

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Other users

Item	Description	Scenario
Other users (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Add other user**	“Add account” button	Customer wants a separate login for a family member or employee on a shared PC
▸ **User row**	The user’s name with the account type, for example “Local account”. Not expanded	Customer wants to change or remove another person’s account
Set up a kiosk (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Kiosk**	Subtext: “Turn this device into a kiosk to use as a digital sign, interactive display, or other things”. “Get started” opens the setup wizard (documented	Customer wants the PC to work as a digital sign, public terminal or other single-purpose device

below)

Tech tip: Kiosk mode creates a dedicated account that signs in automatically and is locked to one selected app, so the rest of Windows is not exposed.

Other Users → Kiosk Setup Wizard

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Other users → Kiosk → Get started

Item	Description	Scenario
Step 1: Create an account (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Step heading**	“Create an account”	—
▸ **Descriptive text**	“We’ll help you create an account that will automatically sign in on start up.”	—
▸ **Add a name**	Text input field	Customer names the new kiosk account
▸ **Choose an existing account**	Link (alternative to creating a new one)	Customer wants to use an account they already have
Step 2: Choose a kiosk app	Section header	—

(section header)		
▸ **Step heading**	“Choose a kiosk app”	—
▸ **Descriptive text**	“This is the only app that can be used in kiosk mode.”	—
▸ **Help me pick the right app**	Link	Customer is not sure which app to use
▸ **App list**	Scrollable, single-select list. Each row shows the icon, app name and publisher	Customer picks the one app the kiosk will run
▸ **Next**	Button	Customer wants to continue to the next step
▸ **Cancel**	Button	Customer wants to back out without setting up a kiosk

Tech tip: The wizard is documented through step 2 (Create an account and Choose a kiosk app).

Access Work or School

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Access work or school

Item	Description	Scenario
Page	Text under the page title:	—

description (top of page)	“Get access to resources like email, apps, and the network. Your work or school might control some things on this device when connected.”	
Add a work or school account	Connect button. Opens the Connect window (documented below)	Customer wants to join their work or school account to the PC
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Export your management log files**	Subtext: “Your log files will be exported to:” followed by a folder under the Public user’s Documents folder, ending in MDMDiagnostics. Export button	Tech troubleshooting a work or school managed PC needs the management log files to send to IT
▸ **Create a test-taking account**	Subtext: “Choose an account for the test taker and enter the address”. Opens the page documented below	A school or testing center wants to lock this PC into a restricted mode for testing
▸ **Add or**	Opens the page documented below	An IT technician wants to apply a

remove a provisioning package		pre-configured package to the device
▶ **Enroll only in device management**	Opens the Enroll only in device management window (documented below)	IT wants the device managed without adding a work or school account
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Access work or school**	Globe icon. Expandable row, shown expanded. Two links (below)	Customer or tech wants Microsoft's help articles on work or school access
▷ **Using Remote Desktop**	Link	Customer wants Microsoft's help on connecting to a work PC remotely
▷ **Configuring VPN**	Link	Customer wants Microsoft's help on setting up a work VPN

Tech tip: Connecting a work or school account can let that organization manage the device. Only connect one when the organization requires it. Export your management log files

creates the diagnostic files IT support usually asks for when device management fails.

Access Work or School → Create a Test-Taking Account

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Access work or school → Create a test-taking account

Item	Description	Scenario
Instructional text	“To take the test, sign out of Windows and then sign in with the test taker account. To stop the test, press Ctrl + Alt + Delete.”	Test taker needs to know how to start and stop the test
Add an account for taking tests	“Add account” button	A school or testing center wants to lock this PC into a restricted mode for standardized testing
Stop the test taker account	“Sign out of the test taker’s account and stop it from taking tests.” Link	Tech wants to end the test taker’s session
Configure your test taking account (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Enter the**	Text input field,	Tech sets the

test's web address	placeholder "Web address"	one website the test taker can reach
▶ **Test taking settings**	Expandable section, shown expanded	Tech chooses what the test taker is allowed to do
▷ **Require printing**	Checkbox, unchecked	Test requires the test taker to be able to print
▷ **Allow screen monitoring**	Checkbox, unchecked	Test allows screen monitoring software
▷ **Allow text suggestions**	Checkbox, unchecked	Test allows text suggestions while typing

Tech tip: If a yellow warning says "Remove the assigned access account to configure a test taking account", the web address field and checkboxes are disabled. They become usable once no assigned access account is active.

Access Work or School → Add or Remove a Provisioning Package

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Access work or school → Add or remove a provisioning package

Item	Description	Scenario
Packages (section	Section header	—

header)		
▸ **Description**	“Provisioning packages help set up your device for work or school.”	An IT technician wants to apply a pre-configured package to a work or school device
▸ **Add a package**	“+” icon button	Tech adds a package with the settings, apps or certificates to apply

Tech tip: A provisioning package (.ppkg file) applies settings, apps and accounts in one step, and usually comes from an organization’s IT department. Only add packages from a source the customer trusts.

Access Work or School → Connect

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Access work or school → Connect

Item	Description	Scenario
Window title	“Microsoft account”	—
Step heading	“Set up a work or school account”	Customer wants to join their work or school account to the PC
Descriptive text	Text about the resources the account gives access	Customer asks what their

	to and the organization's control over the device	employer or school can do after they connect
Email address	Text input field	Customer enters their work or school email address
Close (X)	Window control	Customer wants to close the window without connecting

Tech tip: Use a work or school email address here. A personal Microsoft account belongs under Your info or Your accounts instead. Connecting may enroll the PC in the organization's device management.

Access Work or School → Enroll Only in Device Management

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Access work or school → Enroll only in device management

Item	Description	Scenario
Window title	Purple title bar with the text "Microsoft account" and a Close (X) at the top right	—
Step heading	"Set up a work or school account"	IT wants to enroll the device in management

Descriptive text	“You’ll get access to resources like email, apps, and the network. Connecting means your work or school might control some things on this device, such as which settings you can change. For specific info about this, ask them.”	Customer asks what their employer or school can control on the PC
Email address	Text input field, placeholder “Email address”	Customer enters their work or school email address
Next	Button, grayed out while the email field is empty	Customer continues after entering their address

Tech tip: This window looks the same as the window opened by Connect. Close it without typing anything if it was opened by mistake.

Passkeys

Navigation path: Settings → Accounts → Passkeys

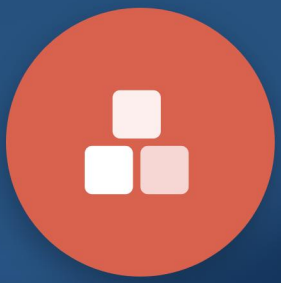
Item	Description	Scenario
Warning banner	“To use passkeys on this device, you must set up a Windows Hello PIN.” Yellow/amber alert	Customer’s passkeys appear unavailable

Set up	Button. Sets up a Windows Hello PIN	Customer needs a Windows Hello PIN before passkeys will work
Advanced options	Subtext: “Manage where your passkeys are saved”. Opens a sub-page	Customer wants to choose where passkeys are saved
Saved passkeys (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Descriptive text**	“Use the passkeys saved on this device to sign in to apps and websites without a password. Instead, your passkeys allow you to sign in using your face, fingerprint, or PIN through Windows Hello.” Includes a “Learn more about passkeys in Windows” link	Customer wants to sign in to apps and websites with passkeys instead of passwords
▸ **Search passkeys**	Search box with search icon	Customer wants to find one saved passkey
▸ **Sort by**	Dropdown, “Name (A to Z)”	Customer wants the passkey list in a different order

▶ **Empty state message**	For example “0 apps and websites found”	Customer has not saved any passkeys yet

Tech tip: Passkeys need a Windows Hello PIN first, so a customer who sees passkeys as unavailable usually has not set one up.

SECTION 03 OF 12



Apps

11 Settings screens · pages 79–94

- Installed Apps
- Advanced App Settings
- Default Apps
- Actions
- Offline Maps
- Apps for Websites
- Video Playback
- Startup
- Resume

Apps

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Apps Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Apps

Item	Description	Scenario
Installed apps	List icon. Subtext: “Uninstall and manage apps on your PC”. Opens the Installed apps page (documented below)	Customer wants to uninstall or manage an app
Advanced app settings	Window icon with a gear. Subtext: “Choose where to get apps, archive apps, uninstall updates”. Opens the Advanced app settings page (documented below)	Customer wants to restrict where apps come from, or roll back an update
Default apps	Window icon with a check mark. Subtext: “Defaults for file and link types, other defaults”. Opens the Default apps page (documented below)	Customer’s files or links open in the wrong program
Actions	Diamond icon with a sparkle. Subtext: “Windows can	Customer wants to control the actions Windows

	recommend actions from these apps.”. Opens the Actions page (documented below)	suggests from their apps
Offline maps	Map icon with a download arrow. Subtext: “Downloads, storage location, map updates”. Opens the Offline maps page (documented below)	Customer who travels wants maps available without an internet connection
Apps for websites	Window icon with an arrow. Subtext: “Websites that can open in an app instead of a browser”. Opens the Apps for websites page (documented below)	Customer wants website links to open in a desktop app instead of the browser
Video playback	Video camera icon. Subtext: “Video adjustments, HDR streaming, battery options”. Opens the Video playback page (documented below)	Customer’s videos look washed out or laggy
Startup	Screen icon with an upward arrow. Subtext: “Apps that start automatically when you sign in”. Opens the Startup page	Customer’s PC is slow to start and they want to stop apps from launching at sign-in

	(documented below)	
Resume	Screen and phone icon. Subtext: “Continue work across devices”. Opens the Resume page (documented below)	Customer wants to pick up on this PC where they left off on their phone

Tech tip: Every row opens the page of the same name.

Installed Apps

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Installed apps

Item	Description	Scenario
Search apps	Search bar with icon	Customer wants to find a specific app quickly, for example to uninstall it, instead of scrolling through the whole list
View toggle icons (list / grid / large grid)	Three icons at the top right to switch the layout	Customer prefers a visual icon grid instead of a detailed list, or the other way round
Filter by	Dropdown, “All drives”	Customer with apps installed on a secondary drive (like a Dev

		Drive) wants to see only the apps on that drive
Sort by	Dropdown, “Date installed”	Customer wants to sort by name or size instead, for example to find the largest apps taking up space
Result count	Text showing how many apps were found, for example “111 apps found”	Tech confirms the total number of installed apps on the system
Individual app rows	Icon, name, version, publisher, install date, size, “...” menu	Customer wants to uninstall, modify or move a specific app. The “...” menu opens those options

Tech tip: Choosing Sort by → size is one of the fastest ways to find what’s eating up disk space when a customer complains about low storage.

Advanced App Settings

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Advanced app settings

Item	Description	Scenario
Choose where	Dropdown, “Anywhere”	Customer wants

to get apps		Windows to restrict or warn about installs from outside the Microsoft Store
Share across devices	Expandable row, shown expanded: Off / My devices only (selected) / Everyone nearby	Customer wants to control cross-device app handoff
View apps and services you've given access to	Links: Microsoft account, Work or school account	Customer wants to review or remove access they gave to apps and services
Related links: Privacy Statement	Link	Customer wants the legal details on data sharing
Archive apps	Toggle, On	Customer asks why a rarely used app shows a cloud icon instead of opening instantly
App execution aliases	Opens the App execution aliases page (documented below)	Customer wants to control which app runs for a given command-line name
Uninstall	Opens another page	Customer wants

updates		to roll back a problematic app or Windows update
How to install a program	External link	Customer needs guided help installing software

Tech tip: If a customer cannot install a program they downloaded from the web, check Choose where to get apps first: “The Microsoft Store only” blocks every other installer. Archive apps removes the files of Store apps that are rarely used but keeps their shortcut; the app downloads again the next time it is opened.

Advanced App Settings → App Execution Aliases

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Advanced app settings → App execution aliases

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Apps can declare a name used to run the app from a command prompt. If multiple apps use the same name, choose which one to use.”	—
App list	Columns: App, Alias, State. One row per alias,	Customer wants to turn an alias

	each with an On/Off toggle. The apps listed depend on what is installed	on or off so the right app runs from a command prompt
▸ **Example: App Installer**	Two rows: python.exe and python3.exe, State On	Customer types “python” in Command Prompt and the Microsoft Store opens instead of their installed Python. Turning off these aliases lets the installed Python run

Tech tip: Some apps register more than one alias. The Microsoft Store CLI tool, for example, lists both store.exe and microsoftstore.exe.

Default Apps

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Default apps

Item	Description	Scenario
Set a default for a file type or link type (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Enter a file type or link**	Search box with search icon	Customer wants to choose which

type		app opens a certain file type, for example.pdf files always opening in Adobe Reader instead of Edge
▸ **Choose a default**	Row with “+” icon and external-link icon. Disabled (grayed out) until a file type or link type is entered	Customer has entered a file type and wants to pick the app for it
Set defaults for applications (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Search apps**	Search box with search icon. Filters the app list below it	Customer wants to find one app quickly in the list
▸ **App list (scrollable)**	Each row: app icon, app name, arrow (>) leading to a sub-page showing that app’s file type associations	Customer wants to review or change the defaults for one specific app

Tech tip: This is where to go when a customer says every time they click a PDF link it opens in the wrong program. Use the file type search at the top, or click into the specific app in the list.

Actions

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Actions

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: "Windows can recommend actions from these apps."	—
Microsoft 365 Copilot	Toggle, On to expand. Sub-action: "Start an agent for M365 Copilot App"	Customer wants Windows to stop suggesting actions from this app
Paint	Toggle, On to expand. Sub-action: "Remove background with Paint"	Customer wants Windows to stop suggesting actions from Paint
Photos	Toggle, On to expand. Sub-actions: "Blur background with Photos", "Erase objects with Photos", "Visual Search with Bing"	Customer wants Windows to stop suggesting actions from Photos

Tech tip: Each app row has one On/Off toggle for all of its actions. The sub-actions shown when a row is expanded are information only, with no toggle of their own.

Offline Maps

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Offline maps

Item	Description	Scenario
Maps (0 downloaded)	Shows how many map regions are downloaded. “Download maps” button opens the region picker	Customer who travels to areas with poor signal wants maps to work without an internet connection
Storage location	Dropdown, currently “Local Disk (C:)”. Chooses where offline maps are saved	Customer wants to control how much storage offline maps use, or save them to another drive
Metered connection	Toggle, Off. Controls whether maps download over metered connections (data charges may apply)	Customer wants to avoid data charges while maps download
Map updates	Expandable row, shown expanded. Text: “Automatically update maps when plugged in and not on a metered connection”.	Customer wants to control how offline maps are kept up to date
▸ **Update automatically when plugged in and on Wi-Fi**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants maps to update only when plugged in and on Wi-Fi

Check for map updates	Shows the date maps were last checked for updates. “Check now” button	Customer wants to update maps now, for example before a trip

Tech tip: Each downloaded map region takes up drive space. On a PC that is short of space on C:, check the map count here, or move Storage location to another drive. Map updates only download automatically while the PC is plugged in and not on a metered connection.

Apps for Websites

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Apps for websites

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Open links in an app instead of a browser.”	—
App list	Columns: App, Domain, State. Each row shows the app icon, app name, one associated domain and an On/Off toggle. An app can have several rows, one per domain. The apps shown depend on what is installed	Customer wants links for a specific website to open in the installed desktop app instead of the browser, or the other way round
▸ **Example: Microsoft Teams**	One row per domain, for example teams.microsoft.com, State On	Customer clicks a Teams meeting link and wants it to open in the

		Teams app, or wants it to open in the browser instead

Tech tip: When a link opens in an app instead of the browser, for example a meeting link opening in Teams, this page is the reason. Turn that domain Off to make the link open in the browser again.

Video Playback

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Video playback

Item	Description	Scenario
Video preview player	Live preview showing what video looks like with the current settings. Play button, scrub bar, and expand/fullscreen icon	Customer wants to see what a change does to video before keeping it
Preview description	“The preview shows what video will look like with your current settings.”	—
Process video automatically to enhance it (depends on your device hardware)	Toggle, On	Customer’s videos look washed out or laggy and they want to turn automatic enhancement on

		or off
Save network bandwidth by playing video at a lower resolution	Toggle, Off	Customer is on a metered connection and wants video to use less data
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **HDR**	Subtext: “Display capabilities, use HDR, Auto HDR”. Opens the HDR page under Display	Customer’s HDR video looks washed out and the tech needs the HDR settings
▸ **Display**	Subtext: “Display information”. Opens the Display page	Customer wants to check or change display settings
▸ **Power**	Subtext: “Screen and sleep, power mode, energy saver”. Opens the Power & battery page	Customer’s video playback is affected by power or energy saver settings

Tech tip: These settings affect apps that use the Windows video platform, such as Media Player and some streaming apps, not every video player in a browser. Turning on Save network bandwidth lowers the resolution, which helps on a metered or slow connection.

Startup

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Startup

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Apps can be configured to start when you log in. In most cases, apps will start minimized or may only start a background task.”	—
Sort by	Dropdown, currently “Name”	Customer wants the startup list ordered a different way, for example to find the apps with the highest impact
Full app list	Columns: App, Publisher / Path, Impact, State, Action icon. Each row shows the app icon, app name, publisher, startup impact rating (No impact / Low / Medium / High), an On/Off toggle, and either an arrow (opens a page with more detail) or an external-link icon	Customer complains their PC takes a long time to boot or feels sluggish right after login, and wants to stop unnecessary apps from starting automatically
▶ **Example:**	Publisher Anthropic,	Tech reads a row

Claude	PBC. Impact: No impact. State: Off.	to see who made the app and how much it slows startup
▶ **Example: Windows Security notification icon**	Publisher Microsoft Corporation. Impact: Low impact. State: On. External-link icon	Customer asks about an app that starts with Windows and is switched On, and the tech needs to know whether it is safe to turn off
▶ **Example: app with no name**	Shows a registry location instead of a name, for example a Run entry under HKEY_CURRENT_USER. External-link icon	Customer has a startup entry that does not have a name, and the tech needs to find where it comes from

Tech tip: The Windows Security notification icon starts with Windows and shows as On, rated Low impact. It is a security component, so leave it on even when a customer is trying to speed up startup. Use Sort by to bring the apps with the highest impact to the top.

Resume

Navigation path: Settings → Apps → Resume

Item	Description	Scenario
Resume	Subtext: “Start	Customer wants

	something on one device and continue on this PC". Toggle, Off. "Learn more" link	to pick up where they left off in a supported app when switching between their phone and this PC
Control which apps can use Resume (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **OneDrive**	Toggle, On. Grayed out while the main Resume toggle is Off	Customer says continuity is not working for an app even though its toggle shows On

Tech tip: A per-app toggle can show On but be grayed out. Check the main Resume toggle first.

SECTION 04 OF 12



Bluetooth & Devices

16 Settings screens · pages 96–138

- Devices
- Printers & Scanners
- Mobile Devices
- Cameras
- Mouse
- Keyboard
- Pen & Windows Ink
- AutoPlay
- USB

Bluetooth & Devices

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Bluetooth & Devices Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices

Item	Description	Scenario
Device tiles (top of page)	Tiles for connected or recently used devices. Example: a headset tile with the device name, "Not connected", a Connect button and a ".." menu. Next to it, an Add device tile with a "+" icon	Customer wants to reconnect a paired headset or add a new device without digging through pages
View more devices	Link row below the tiles	Customer's device is not among the tiles shown
Bluetooth	Toggle, On. Bluetooth icon. "Discoverable as "[device name]""	Customer's Bluetooth device will not pair, and the tech checks the master switch first
Devices	"Mouse, keyboard, pen, audio, displays and docks, other devices" —	Customer wants to see or manage everything

	Add device button (highlighted), opens the Devices page (documented below)	paired with the PC
Printers & scanners	"Preferences" — opens the Printers & scanners page	Customer needs to add or fix a printer
Mobile devices	"Instantly access your mobile devices from your PC" — opens the Mobile devices page	Customer wants to use their phone with the PC
Cameras	"Connected cameras, default image settings" — opens the Cameras page	Customer's webcam is not working or looks wrong
Mouse	"Buttons, mouse pointer speed, scrolling" — opens the Mouse page	Customer's pointer is too fast or the buttons are swapped
Keyboard	"Character repeat, hotkeys" — opens the Keyboard page	Customer's keys repeat too fast or too slowly
Pen & Windows Ink	"Right-handed or left-handed, pen button shortcuts, handwriting" — opens the Pen & Windows Ink page	Customer with a stylus wants pen buttons or handedness changed
AutoPlay	"Defaults for removable drives and memory cards" — opens the	Customer is tired of a pop-up appearing every

	AutoPlay page	time a USB drive is plugged in
USB	"Notifications, USB battery saver" — opens the USB page	Customer keeps seeing a "charging slowly" warning or USB device errors

Tech tip: The "Discoverable as" line shows the PC name other devices see in their Bluetooth list — worth knowing when a customer cannot find their PC from a phone or headset; the name is changed under System → About.

Devices

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Devices

Item	Description	Scenario
Bluetooth	Toggle, On. Bluetooth icon. "Discoverable as "[device name]""	Customer cannot pair anything and the tech confirms Bluetooth is actually on
Connect a new device to "[device name]"	Add device button (highlighted, primary)	Customer wants to pair a new headset, mouse or other Bluetooth device
Input (section header)	Section header	—

▶ **USB Receiver (keyboard icon)**	Green status dot (connected). Example: a wireless keyboard receiver	Customer's wireless keyboard stops responding and the tech checks the receiver is listed
▶ **USB Receiver (mouse icon)**	Green status dot (connected). Example: a second, separate receiver for a wireless mouse	Customer has two receivers and wonders which one belongs to which device
▶ **WH-1000XM5 (example headset)**	"Not connected". The same headset also appears under Audio	Customer asks why their headphones are listed twice
Audio (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **ACER S271HL (example monitor)**	Green status dot. A monitor with built-in speakers	Customer wants sound through the monitor and needs to find it here
▶ **Logi USB Camera (C270 HD WebCam) (example webcam)**	Green status dot. Listed under Audio because it has a built-in microphone	Customer's webcam microphone is missing from the list

▶ **Device with the PC's own name (laptop icon)**	Listed under the PC’s own name. "Not connected", Connect button	Tech sees an entry in the Audio list that carries the PC’s own name and wonders what it is
▶ **Speakers (Realtek(R) Audio) (example)**	Green status dot. The onboard motherboard audio output	Customer's speakers have disappeared and the tech checks the list
▶ **WH-1000XM5 (example headset)**	"Not connected", Connect button	Customer's headset is paired but not connected — click Connect
Other devices (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **DataTraveler 3.0 (example USB drive)**	Green status dot. "Device can perform faster when connected to USB 3.0" — an informational tip, not an error	Customer asks about a message on a flash drive plugged into a slower port
▶ **Disk 2.0 (example)**	Green status dot	Tech sees an unfamiliar disk entry and needs to know it is an attached drive

▶ **[phone name] (example phone)**	"Not connected". Shows connected with a battery percentage when the phone is linked through Phone Link	Customer wants to see their phone's battery level from the PC
▶ **TP-Link UB500 Adapter (example Bluetooth adapter)**	Bluetooth icon, green status dot, "Driver error"	Customer plugged in a USB Bluetooth adapter and nothing will pair — the driver needs reinstalling
Expanding a device row	One line, "Remove this device", with a Remove button. Seen on the headset and on the Bluetooth adapter	Customer wants to unpair a device and pair it again from scratch
Device settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Show notifications to connect using Swift Pair**	Toggle, On. "Connect to supported Bluetooth devices quickly when they're close by and in pairing mode"	Customer wants a pop-up when a nearby device is ready to pair, or does not
▶ **Download over metered connections**	Toggle, Off. "Device software (drivers, info, and apps) for new	Customer on a limited data plan is plugging in

	devices will download when you're on metered internet connections—data charges may apply"	new devices
▸ **Use LE Audio when available**	Toggle, On. "Windows will use LE Audio instead of Classic Audio for Bluetooth devices that support both"	Customer's headset sounds different or will not connect after an update
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Sound**	Cross-reference: the Sound page is documented under System	Customer's Bluetooth audio device is connected but silent
▸ **Display**	Cross-reference: the Display page is documented under System	Customer wants to connect a wireless display
▸ **Send or receive files via Bluetooth**	External link icon, opens a separate window	Customer wants to transfer a file to a phone over Bluetooth
▸ **More Bluetooth settings**	External link icon, opens a separate window	Tech needs the older Bluetooth options window

▸ **More devices and printer settings**	External link icon, opens a separate window	Tech needs the older devices and printers window
Related support: Help with Bluetooth & other devices	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains four links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for Bluetooth problems
▸ **Re-pairing Bluetooth earbuds for stereo sound**	Link	—
▸ **Troubleshooting Miracast connection issues**	Link	—
▸ **Toggling Bluetooth settings easily**	Link	—
▸ **Reinstalling Bluetooth drivers**	Link	—

Tech tip: The same physical headset can appear under both Input and Audio — that is normal for headsets with built-in controls, and worth explaining to customers who ask why

their headphones are listed twice. A "Driver error" on an adapter is usually fixed in Device Manager, outside Settings.

Printers & Scanners

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Printers & scanners

Item	Description	Scenario
Add a printer or scanner	Add device button (highlighted, primary)	Customer bought a new printer or scanner and needs to add it
Info banner	"Indicates printers that are available in Windows protected print mode." with a Learn more link and a dismiss (X) button	Customer asks what the small shield icons next to printer names mean
Installed printer list	Each row shows a printer icon, the name, a green shield with a check (compatible with Windows protected print mode), an optional status line, and an arrow that opens the printer's own page (documented below)	Customer wants to see every printer Windows knows about
▸ **HP OfficeJet 3830 series [printer ID] (example**	Green shield, status line "Driver error"	Customer's printer is installed but will not print — a

printer)		driver problem, so the driver needs reinstalling
▸ **Microsoft Print to PDF**	Green shield. The built-in virtual printer	Customer wants to save a document as a PDF instead of printing it
Printer preferences (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Windows protected print mode**	Green shield icon. "This feature helps ensure the latest security standard for printer software. Turning this on may limit the availability of some printers using an older default security standard." with a Learn more link. Button reads "Turn off" when the feature is on (a "Set up" button was seen on 25H2 when it was off)	Customer's older printer stopped showing up as an option after this feature was turned on
▸ **Default install printers using**	Toggle, On, greyed out (unavailable on this PC). "Install new printers using Windows Ready	Tech wants new printers installed without manufacturer

Windows Ready Print	Print when available for an improved print experience." with a Learn more link	drivers
▸ **Let Windows manage my default printer**	Toggle, On	Customer's default printer keeps changing — Windows sets the most recently used printer as the default while this is on
▸ **Download drivers and device software over metered connections**	Toggle, Off. "Data charges may apply"	Customer on a limited data plan is adding a new printer
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Print server properties**	Row with no arrow or icon shown	Tech needs print server settings such as forms and drivers
Related support: Help with Printers & scanners	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains four links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for printer problems

▸ **Setting your preferred default printer**	Link	—
▸ **Connecting a wireless printer easily**	Link	—
▸ **Checking current print jobs in queue**	Link	—
▸ **Connecting a scanner to your device**	Link	—

Tech tip: Windows protected print mode limits printing to modern drivers that meet a current security standard, so an older printer that works elsewhere can vanish or throw a security prompt once it is on — worth knowing when a printer "stopped working" after a security change; the Turn off button on this page is the first thing to check.

Printers & Scanners → Printer Details (Example: Microsoft Print to PDF)

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Printers & scanners → [printer name]

Item	Description	Scenario
Header	Printer icon, the printer name with its shield icon, "Printer status: Idle"	Customer wants to remove a printer they no

	(example), and a Remove button on the right	longer use
[printer name] settings (tab label)	Underlined tab label above the rows below	—
▸ **Open print queue**	External link icon, opens a separate window	Customer's document is stuck and will not print
▸ **Print test page**	External link icon	Tech confirms the printer and driver work
▸ **Printer properties**	External link icon	Tech needs the full legacy properties window for the printer
▸ **Printing preferences**	"Orientation, page order, pages per sheet, borders, paper source" — external link icon	Customer wants every print to default to landscape or double-sided
▸ **Additional printer settings**	"Rename your printer, pause printing" — expandable. Expanded: Rename your printer (Rename button) and Printing (Pause button)	Customer wants a clearer printer name, or needs to pause a printer that is jamming the queue
▸ **Hardware**	External link icon	Tech needs the

properties		hardware properties window for driver or port details
More information (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Scanners not appearing**	Question-mark icon, external link icon	Customer's scanner is missing from the list
Related support: Help from the web	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains three links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for printer problems
▸ **Setting your preferred default printer**	Link	—
▸ **Checking current print jobs in queue**	Link	—
▸ **Updating printer drivers**	Link	—

Tech tip: Open print queue is the first stop for a stuck job — a job that will not delete from there often needs the print

queue cleared with the Print Spooler service restarted, which sits outside Settings.

Mobile Devices

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Mobile devices

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro line	"Add and manage your mobile devices to make calls, keep up with conversations, view notifications, share files, and more."	—
Allow this PC to access content and capabilities from your mobile devices	Toggle, On. "Learn more about mobile devices" link	Customer's phone stopped showing up in Phone Link, and the tech checks this master switch first
Add a mobile device	Phone-with-plus icon. Add device button (highlighted, primary)	Customer wants to link a new phone to the PC
Mobile devices (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **[phone name] (example**	Phone thumbnail, the account email shown under the name (shown	Customer wants to see the phone's battery

phone)	as [account email]), battery "76%" with battery icon, toggle On. The opens the phone's own page (documented below)	level, or switch off access for one phone
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Show me suggestions for using my mobile device with Windows**	Toggle, On	Customer keeps getting prompts about linking their phone
▸ **Resume**	"Continue work across devices". Cross-reference: the Resume page is documented under Apps	Customer wants to pick up work from their phone on the PC
▸ **Start**	"Recent apps and items, folders". Cross-reference: the Start page is documented under Personalization	Customer wants phone notifications to show on the Start menu
▸ **Privacy resources**	Shield icon. Link text "About these settings and your privacy"	Customer asks what data the phone link shares

Tech tip: Each phone has its own toggle and detail page, so one phone can be switched off without removing it. The Resume page lives under Apps, and its list of apps only appears while Resume is turned On.

Mobile Devices → [phone name]

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Mobile devices → [phone name]

Item	Description	Scenario
Header	Phone thumbnail, the phone name, the account email (shown as [account email]), then a Bluetooth icon, a Wi-Fi icon and battery "76%" with battery icon. Remove button on the right	Customer is selling or replacing a phone and wants to unlink it from the PC
Allow this PC to access content and capabilities from your [phone name]	Toggle, On	Customer wants to cut off one phone's access without removing it
Controls (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Do Not Disturb**	"Turn on Do Not Disturb mode on this mobile device". Toggle, Off	Customer wants to silence the phone from the

		PC while working
▶ **Ringer mode**	"Set the volume level for notifications and alerts on this mobile device". Dropdown, currently "Silent"	Customer wants the phone muted or loud without picking it up
▶ **Play sound**	"Play a sound on this mobile device to help find it". Ring now button	Customer has lost the phone somewhere in the house
Features (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Show mobile device in File Explorer**	"Show device files, photos, and media in File Explorer". Toggle, On	Customer wants to copy photos from the phone without a cable
▶ **Get new photo notifications**	"Receive new notifications to open or edit photos from this device". Toggle, On	Customer wants a pop-up on the PC each time they take a photo
▶ **Remote PC controls**	"Remotely control your PC such as remote lock from this device". Toggle, On	Customer wants to lock the PC from their phone after leaving it unattended
▶ **Access PC's clipboard**	"Allow this device to access content that I copy on this PC". Toggle, On	Customer wants text copied on the PC to be pasteable on the

		phone
▶ **Resume**	"Continue tasks and other app activities from this device on your PC". Toggle, On	Customer wants to pick up something they started on the phone
▶ **Transferred files will save to**	"C:\Users\[user name]\Downloads\Mobile Devices". Expands to the two rows below	Customer cannot find files they sent from the phone
▷ **Open save location**	Open button. Opens the folder in File Explorer	Customer wants to jump straight to the received files
▷ **Change save location**	Change button	Customer wants received files saved on a bigger drive
▶ **Show device name in Windows Share**	"Make my device name available for file sharing". Toggle, On	Customer's phone does not appear as a share target
▶ **Use as a connected camera**	"Make this device's camera available to apps that use a webcam". Toggle, On	Customer's webcam is broken and they want to use the phone camera instead
Additional settings	Section header	—

(section header)		
▸ **Phone Link**	"Make calls, keep up with conversations, view your notifications, and more". Open Phone Link button	Customer wants the full Phone Link app for calls and texts
▸ **Privacy resources**	Shield icon. Link text "About these settings and your privacy"	Customer asks what data the phone link shares

Tech tip: Ring now is a quick way to confirm the phone is reachable from the PC, and transferred files go to the Downloads\Mobile Devices folder in the user profile unless the save location is changed.

Cameras

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Cameras

Item	Description	Scenario
Add a network camera	Camera-with-plus icon. Search for cameras button (highlighted, primary)	Customer has a network camera on the same network and wants Windows to find it
Connected cameras (section header)	Section header	—

▸ **[phone name] (Windows Virtual Camera) (example)**	Camera icon. The opens the camera's own page (documented below)	Customer's phone shows up in the camera list and they want to know why
▸ **Logi C270 HD WebCam (example webcam)**	Camera icon. The opens the camera's own page (documented below)	Customer's webcam looks wrong or will not turn on, and the tech opens its settings
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Camera privacy settings**	Camera icon. Cross-reference: the Camera page is documented under Privacy & security	Customer's camera shows a black picture because an app was denied access

Tech tip: A camera that works in one app but shows a black picture in another is worth checking under Camera privacy settings, where each app has its own switch.

Cameras → [phone name] (Windows Virtual Camera) (Example)

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Cameras → [phone name] (Windows Virtual Camera)

Item	Description	Scenario
Camera preview	Black preview box at the top left, with the camera name under it	Customer's phone camera shows a black picture and the tech checks the preview first
Troubleshoot	Button under the camera name	Customer's camera is not working and the tech wants Windows to try fixing it
Video rotation	Dropdown, currently "No rotation"	Customer's picture is sideways or upside down
Reset default camera settings	Reset settings button	Customer changed the image settings and wants to go back to the originals
▶ **Advanced camera options**	Edit button. Opens a pop-up window with the rows below, plus Apply and Cancel buttons	Tech needs the deeper camera controls
▷ **Allow multiple apps to use**	Toggle, Off. "When turned on, certain camera controls can only	Customer's camera works in one app but says

camera at the same time	be changed from camera settings page". Greys out and shows On while Turn on basic camera is On	it is busy in another
▹ **Turn on basic camera**	Toggle, Off. "Limits camera features to the basics"	Customer's camera has driver or feature problems and the tech wants to cut it down to the basics
▹ **Media type**	Dropdown, "Let Windows choose". "Preferred camera resolution". Greyed out while Turn on basic camera is Off; usable once it is On	Customer wants a specific camera resolution, so the tech turns on basic camera first to unlock the dropdown
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Camera privacy settings**	Camera icon. Cross-reference: the Camera page is documented under Privacy & security	Customer's camera shows a black picture because an app was denied access

Tech tip: In Advanced camera options, Media type stays greyed out until Turn on basic camera is switched On, and switching it On also greys out the multiple-apps toggle.

Cameras → Logi C270 HD WebCam (Example Webcam)

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Cameras → Logi C270 HD WebCam

Item	Description	Scenario
Camera preview	Live preview box at the top left, with the camera name under it	Customer says the webcam is not working and the tech checks whether the preview shows a picture
Troubleshoot	Button under the camera name	Customer's camera is not working and the tech wants Windows to try fixing it
Disable	Button next to Troubleshoot	Customer wants the webcam switched off completely for privacy
Basic settings	Slider icon. Expandable row, expanded by default	Customer's picture looks too dark, washed out or soft

▶ **Brightness**	Slider, sun icon	Customer's picture is too dark or too bright
▶ **Contrast**	Slider, half-filled circle icon	Customer's picture looks flat or too harsh
▶ **Sharpness**	Slider, triangle icon	Customer's picture looks soft or over-sharpened
▶ **Saturation**	Slider, palette icon	Customer's colors look washed out or too strong
Video rotation	Dropdown, currently "No rotation"	Customer's picture is sideways or upside down
Reset default camera settings	Reset settings button	Customer changed the sliders and wants to go back to the originals
▶ **Advanced camera options**	Edit button. Opens a pop-up window with the rows below, plus Apply and Cancel buttons	Tech needs the deeper camera controls
▷ **Allow multiple apps to use**	Toggle, Off. Same wording as on the phone's camera page	Customer's camera works in one app but says

camera at the same time		it is busy in another
▹ **Turn on basic camera**	Toggle, Off. "Limits camera features to the basics"	Customer's camera has driver or feature problems and the tech wants to cut it down to the basics
▹ **Media type**	Dropdown, "Let Windows choose", greyed out while Turn on basic camera is Off. Same as on the phone's camera page	Customer wants a specific camera resolution, so the tech turns on basic camera first to unlock the dropdown
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Camera privacy settings**	Camera icon. Cross-reference: the Camera page is documented under Privacy & security	Customer's camera shows a black picture because an app was denied access

Tech tip: Disable sits right beside Troubleshoot, so it is worth a look when an app cannot find a webcam that is plugged in.

The phone’s virtual camera page has no Basic settings sliders, so a customer looking for them there will not find them.

Mouse

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Mouse

Item	Description	Scenario
Primary mouse button	Mouse icon. Dropdown, currently "Left"	Left-handed customer wants the buttons swapped, or the buttons suddenly feel backwards
Mouse pointer speed	Pointer-with-speed-lines icon. Slider	Customer says the pointer is too slow or flies across the screen
Enhance pointer precision	Toggle, On	Customer says the pointer movement feels inconsistent
Scrolling (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Roll the mouse wheel to scroll**	Dropdown, currently "Multiple lines at a time"	Customer says the mouse wheel scrolls the wrong amount

▸ **Lines to scroll at a time**	Slider	Customer says the page scrolls too far or too little per wheel click
▸ **Scroll inactive windows when hovering over them**	Toggle, On	Customer wants to scroll a window without clicking on it first
▸ **Scrolling direction**	Dropdown, currently "Down motion scrolls down"	Customer wants scrolling to work like a phone or Mac, or it feels backwards
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Mouse pointer and touch**	"Pointer size and color". Cross-reference: the Mouse pointer and touch page is documented under Accessibility	Customer can't see the pointer and wants it bigger or a different color
▸ **Accessibility mouse settings**	"Double click speed, hide while typing, click lock". Cross-reference: the Mouse page is documented under	Customer wants to change how fast a double-click has to be

	Accessibility	
▸ **Additional mouse settings**	External-link icon. Opens the classic Mouse Properties window, a separate window outside Settings (documented below)	Tech needs the older mouse options window
▸ **Multiple displays**	"Change how cursor moves over display boundaries". Cross-reference: the Display page is documented under System	Customer's pointer gets stuck or jumps when moving between monitors
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Mouse**	Globe icon, expandable row, expanded by default. Four links: "Changing the primary mouse button", "Changing mouse scrolling settings", "Adjusting the mouse pointer speed", "Troubleshooting my mouse"	Customer wants Microsoft's own instructions for a mouse problem

Tech tip: Primary mouse button, pointer speed and the scrolling rows are the first things to check when a customer

says their mouse feels wrong. The older Mouse Properties window is reached from Additional mouse settings at the bottom of the page.

Mouse → Additional Mouse Settings (Mouse Properties Window)

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Mouse → Additional mouse settings

Item	Description	Scenario
Mouse Properties (separate window)	Opens from the Additional mouse settings row. Five tabs across the top (Buttons, Pointers, Pointer Options, Wheel, Hardware). OK, Cancel and Apply buttons at the bottom (Apply greyed out until something changes)	Tech needs the older mouse options that the Settings page does not have
Buttons tab	Tab, selected on opening	—
▸ **Button configuration**	Section. "Switch primary and secondary buttons" checkbox, unchecked, with a mouse picture on the right	Customer's mouse buttons feel backwards
▸ **Double-click speed**	Section. Speed slider (Slow to Fast) and a folder icon to test the setting	Customer's double-clicks do not open things reliably

▶ **ClickLock**	Section. "Turn on ClickLock" checkbox, unchecked. Settings button, greyed out until the box is checked	Customer wants to drag or highlight without holding the button down
Pointers tab	Tab, second from the left	Customer's pointer looks wrong or they want a different pointer set
▶ **Scheme**	Section. Dropdown, "Windows Default (system scheme)". Save As... button, Delete button (greyed out). Preview box on the right shows the current pointer	Customer wants to switch to a different pointer set, or save their own
▶ **Customize**	Scrollable list of pointer types, each with its picture. Visible: Normal Select (highlighted), Help Select, Working In Background, Busy, Precision Select, Text Select. The list continues below, with a scroll bar on the right	Customer's busy or text pointer looks wrong, and the tech finds that one pointer in the list
▶ **Enable pointer shadow**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the shadow under the pointer

		on or off
▶ **Use Default**	Button under the list, next to Browse...	Customer changed a pointer and wants the original back
▶ **Browse...**	Button next to Use Default	Customer has a pointer file and wants to use it
Pointer Options tab	Tab, third from the left	Customer wants the older pointer controls
▶ **Motion**	Section	—
▷ **Select a pointer speed**	Slider, Slow to Fast	Customer says the pointer is too slow or too fast
▷ **Enhance pointer precision**	Checkbox, checked	Customer says the pointer movement feels inconsistent
▶ **Snap To**	Section	—
▷ **Automatically move pointer to the default button in a dialog box**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants the pointer to jump to the OK-type button when a window opens
▶ **Visibility**	Section	—

▹ **Display pointer trails**	Checkbox, unchecked. The Short to Long slider under it is greyed out while the box is unchecked	Customer cannot follow the pointer on screen and wants a trail behind it
▹ **Hide pointer while typing**	Checkbox, checked	Customer says the pointer disappears when they type
▹ **Show location of pointer when I press the CTRL key**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer loses the pointer and wants a quick way to find it
Wheel tab	Tab, fourth from the left	Customer wants the older scrolling controls
▶ **Vertical Scrolling**	Section. "Roll the wheel one notch to scroll:"	—
▹ **The following number of lines at a time**	Option button, selected, with a number box beside it (currently 3) and up and down arrows	Customer says each wheel click scrolls too far or too little
▹ **One screen at a time**	Option button, not selected	Customer wants each wheel click to move a full screen

▶ **Horizontal Scrolling**	Section. "Tilt the wheel to scroll the following number of characters at a time:"	—
▷ **Number of characters**	Number box (currently 3) with up and down arrows	Customer has a tilt wheel and side-to-side scrolling is too fast or slow
Hardware tab	Tab, last on the right	Tech wants to see if Windows detects the mouse
▶ **Devices**	Section. List with Name and Type columns. Two entries, both "HID-compliant mouse", Type "Mice and other pointing devices"	Customer's mouse is not responding and the tech checks that it appears in the list
▶ **Device Properties**	Section for the selected device. Manufacturer, Location ("on USB Input Device") and Device status ("This device is working properly.")	Tech wants a quick status check on the mouse
▶ **Properties**	Button at the bottom right. Opens the selected device's own Properties window (documented below)	Tech wants the full device window for driver details

HID-compliant mouse Properties (separate window)	Opens from the Properties button on the Hardware tab. Four tabs across the top (General, Driver, Details, Events). OK and Cancel buttons at the bottom. Only the General tab is documented here, because the other tabs vary with the mouse and driver	Tech needs the full device window for driver details
General tab	Tab, selected on opening	Tech wants the basic facts about the device
▸ **Device name**	Mouse icon with “HID-compliant mouse”	Tech confirms which device the window is for
▸ **Device type**	“Mice and other pointing devices”	Tech confirms Windows sees it as a mouse
▸ **Manufacturer**	“Microsoft”	Tech wants to know who made the driver
▸ **Location**	“on USB Input Device”	Tech wants to know how the mouse is connected
▸ **Device status**	Box with the message “This device is working	Customer’s mouse is not

	properly.” and a scroll bar on the right	responding and the tech checks for an error message
▸ **Change settings**	Button at the bottom left with a shield icon	Tech needs to change device settings

Tech tip: Apply stays greyed out until something is changed, so Cancel closes the window without changing anything. The General tab of the device’s Properties window repeats what the Device Properties section on the Hardware tab already shows.

Keyboard

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Keyboard

Item	Description	Scenario
Keyboard character repeat (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Repeat delay and repeat rate preview**	Box with the heading “Repeat delay and repeat rate preview”, the text “Type to preview your changes.”, and a text box to type in	Tech tests a change to the two sliders below without opening another program
▸ **Keyboard character**	“A” with a clock icon. Slider from Short to	Customer says letters repeat too

repeat delay	Long, handle near the Short end	soon when they pause on a key, or the repeat takes too long to start
▸ **Keyboard character repeat rate**	“A” with circular arrows icon. Slider from Slow to Fast, handle at the Fast end	Customer says a held key types too fast, or too slowly
Shortcuts and hotkeys (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Customize Copilot key on keyboard**	Keyboard icon. Subtext: “Choose what happens when you press the Copilot key or Windows logo key + C”. Dropdown, currently “Copilot”	Customer presses the Copilot key by accident, or wants it to do something else
▸ **Use the Print screen key to open screen capture**	Toggle, On	Customer presses Print Screen and a capture tool opens when they expected a plain screenshot
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—

▸ **Keyboard accessibility**	Keyboard icon. Subtext: “Sticky, Filter, and Toggle keys, on-screen keyboard”. Cross-reference: the Keyboard page is documented under Accessibility	Customer's keys stick, repeat on their own, or they need an on-screen keyboard
▸ **Text input personalization**	Keyboard icon. Subtext: “Touch keyboard, voice typing, emoji and more, input method editor”. Cross-reference: the Text input page is documented under Personalization	Customer wants to change the touch keyboard, voice typing or emoji panel theme
▸ **Dynamic Lighting**	Lighting icon. Subtext: “Connected devices, effects, app settings”. Cross-reference: the Dynamic Lighting page is documented under Personalization	Customer has a keyboard with lighting and wants to change the effects
▸ **Spelling, typing, & keyboard settings**	Keyboard icon. Cross-reference: the Typing page is documented under Time & language	Customer wants autocorrect, spell check or typing options changed

Tech tip: The preview box lets the customer try a delay or rate change right away. If a key seems to repeat on its own, check the repeat delay first, then Filter keys under Accessibility → Keyboard.

Pen & Windows Ink

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Pen & Windows Ink

Item	Description	Scenario
Handwriting (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Handwriting panel settings**	Pen-and-paper icon. Subtext: “Choose how you write and how your text appears when you use the handwriting panel”. Expandable row, collapsed on opening. Two controls inside (below)	Customer uses a pen or touch screen and wants to change how the handwriting panel works
▷ **Font**	Dropdown, currently “Ink Free”	Customer wants their handwriting to appear in a different style
▷ **Write with your fingertip**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants to write in the handwriting panel with a finger, or wants that turned off
Related support (section header)	Section header	—

▸ **Help with Pen & Windows Ink**	Globe icon, expandable row, expanded by default. One link: “Changing my pen's battery”	Customer wants Microsoft's own instructions for changing the pen's battery

Tech tip: Handwriting panel settings is collapsed when the page opens, so a customer looking for the font or fingertip option has to expand the row first.

AutoPlay

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → AutoPlay

Item	Description	Scenario
Use AutoPlay for all media and devices	Toggle, On	Customer plugs in a USB drive or memory card and nothing pops up, or a window pops up every time and they want it stopped
Choose AutoPlay defaults (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Removable drive**	Dropdown, currently “Open folder to view files (File Explorer)”	Customer wants a different action when a USB drive is plugged

		in
▸ **Memory card**	Dropdown, currently “Open folder to view files (File Explorer)”	Customer wants a different action when a camera or phone memory card is inserted
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Default app settings**	Link text only, no icon or subtext. Cross-reference: the Default apps page is documented under Apps	Customer wants to change which app opens a certain kind of file

Tech tip: The two dropdowns only cover removable drives and memory cards. If a customer wants a particular app to open a certain file type, that is under Default apps.

USB

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → USB

Item	Description	Scenario
Connection notifications	Bell icon. Subtext: “Show a notification if there are issues connecting a USB device”. Toggle, On	Customer plugs in a USB device and gets a pop-up about a problem, or wants those

		warnings off
Show a notification if this PC is charging slowly over USB	Bell icon. Toggle, On	Customer sees a slow-charging warning when plugging in a phone or tablet
USB4 hubs and devices	USB port icon. Opens the USB4 hubs and devices page (documented below)	Customer has a USB4 dock or device and the tech wants to see what Windows detects

Tech tip: The USB4 hubs and devices page is information only. Both notification toggles are on the main USB page.

USB → USB4 Hubs and Devices

Navigation path: Settings → Bluetooth & devices → USB → USB4 hubs and devices

Item	Description	Scenario
USB4 domains information	Bar at the top with the text “Last updated: Now”. Copy button and Refresh button on the right	Tech wants to save the USB4 details for a ticket, or reload the page after plugging something in
USB4 domains (section	Section header	—

header)		
▶ **USB4 host router 1**	USB port icon, expandable row, expanded by default. Lists details as plain text with no controls: Manufacturer name, Model name, Domain ID, Device instance ID, Topology ID, Silicon vendor ID, Silicon product ID, Silicon revision, Firmware version, USB4 version, Total DP IN adapters, Tunneled DP IN adapters, Unavailable DP IN adapters. The values depend on the PC and are not recorded here	Tech wants to know which USB4 controller the PC has, and its firmware and USB4 version

Tech tip: Copy and Refresh are the only controls on this page. Everything else is information, and the details differ from one PC to the next.

SECTION 05 OF 12

Gaming

5 Settings screens · pages 140–147

- Xbox Mode
- Game Bar
- Captures
- Game Mode

Richard Stevens

Gaming

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Gaming Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Gaming

Item	Description	Scenario
XBOX mode	Controller-and-arrow icon. Subtext: “Enable, accessibility control hints”. Opens the Xbox mode page (documented below)	Customer wants to use the PC with a controller, like a console
Game Bar	Game Bar icon. Subtext: “Controller and keyboard shortcuts”. Opens the Game Bar page (documented below)	Customer wants to open or change the Game Bar overlay and its shortcuts
Captures	Capture icon. Subtext: “Save location, recording preferences”. Opens the Captures page (documented below)	Customer wants to change where game clips and screenshots are saved
Game Mode	Game controller icon. Subtext: “Optimize your PC for play”. Opens the Game Mode page (documented below)	Customer’s games run poorly and they want the PC tuned for play

Tech tip: Every row opens the page of the same name. The page has only these four rows.

Xbox Mode

Navigation path: Settings → Gaming → Xbox mode

Item	Description	Scenario
Configuration (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Enable Xbox mode**	Toggle, On	Customer using a handheld or controller-first device wants a console-like interface
▸ **Show Xbox mode in Task View**	Toggle, Off	Customer wants Xbox mode to appear when switching between windows
▸ **Show accessibility control hints in Task View**	Subtext: “Displays one-button alternative to combo button press”. Toggle, Off	Customer who struggles with combo button presses needs one-button alternatives shown

Tech tip: Xbox mode is a full-screen, controller-friendly layout aimed at handheld gaming PCs and controller use. If a customer finds a console-style screen they did not expect, this is the page where it is turned on or off.

Game Bar

Navigation path: Settings → Gaming → Game Bar

Item	Description	Scenario
Allow your controller to open Game Bar	Subtext: a “Get to know Game Bar” link. Toggle, On	Customer wants to open Game Bar from the controller for screenshots or performance overlays mid-game
Use 🎮 + ☰ as Guide button in apps	Subtext: “Trigger Guide button actions — like opening overlays — in supported apps. This won’t affect system use of the Guide button.” Toggle, On	Customer’s controller button opens an overlay they did not expect, or they want it to
All shortcuts	Subtext: “To edit Game Bar related shortcuts, press Windows logo key + G or go to Start > Game Bar > Settings”. Static instructional text, no toggle or link	Customer wants to change a Game Bar shortcut and cannot find the list on this page

Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Graphics**	Link/row, arrow (>)	Customer wants to change graphics settings for a game
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Game Bar**	Expandable row, shown expanded. Three links (below)	Customer or tech wants Microsoft's help articles on Game Bar
▷ **Record a game clip on your PC with Game Bar**	Link	Customer wants to record a game clip
▷ **Fix problems with Game Bar on Windows**	Link	Game Bar does not open or work properly
▷ **Keyboard shortcuts for Game**	Link	Customer wants the full list of Game Bar

Bar	shortcuts

Tech tip: The shortcut list for Game Bar is not on this page. Game Bar's shortcuts are edited inside Game Bar itself: press Windows logo key + G, or go to Start → Game Bar → Settings.

Captures

Navigation path: Settings → Gaming → Captures

Item	Description	Scenario
Captures location (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Screenshots and game clips location**	Text: "Screenshots and game clips will save to" followed by a Captures folder inside the user's Videos folder. "Open folder" button and "How to save to a different folder" link	Customer cannot find their game clips, or wants them saved somewhere else
Recording preferences (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Record what happened**	Subtext: "When something cool happened in your game, press Windows logo key + Alt + G to capture the	Customer wants to save the last moments of gameplay after something

	moment”. Toggle, Off	happens
▶ **Max recording length**	Subtext: “Set the duration for recordings you start”. Dropdown, “2 hours”	Customer’s recordings stop too soon or take too much space
▶ **Capture audio when recording a game**	Expandable row. Toggle, On	Customer’s clips have no sound, or they want sound off
▷ **Mute system and app audio when recording a game**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the game’s sound left out of the recording
▷ **Audio recording quality**	Dropdown, “128kbps (Recommended)”	Customer wants better or smaller audio in their clips
▷ **Microphone recording volume**	Slider	Customer’s voice is too quiet or too loud in recordings
▷ **System recording volume**	Slider	The game’s sound is too quiet or too loud in recordings
▶ **Video frame rate**	Subtext: “Recording at a higher frame rate may affect the quality of your	Customer wants smoother video or smoother

	game”. Dropdown, “30 fps (recommended)”	gameplay while recording
▸ **Video quality**	Subtext: “Recording higher quality video may affect the quality of your game”. Dropdown, “Standard”	Customer wants sharper video, or a game that runs better while recording
▸ **Capture mouse cursor when recording a game**	Toggle, On	Customer wants the mouse cursor left out of, or included in, recordings

Tech tip: Recording a game while it runs can affect how well the game performs. Higher frame rate and higher video quality both add to that.

Game Mode

Navigation path: Settings → Gaming → Game Mode

Item	Description	Scenario
Game Mode	Subtext: “Optimize your PC for play by turning things off in the background”. Toggle, Off	Customer’s game is stuttering or running poorly, and the tech confirms Windows is prioritizing the game
More about	Link, shown under the	Customer wants

Game Mode	subtext in the Game Mode row	Microsoft's explanation of Game Mode
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Graphics**	Graphics card icon. Opens the System → Display → Graphics page, documented in the System section	Customer wants to change graphics settings for a game

Tech tip: Game Mode gives the game priority and holds back things like Windows Update driver installs and restart notifications while playing. It is Off on the test PC. If a single game stutters, switching it on or off is a quick test before deeper troubleshooting.

SECTION 06 OF 12



Home

1 Settings screen · pages 149–152

- Home

Home

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Home

Navigation path: Settings → Home

Item	Description	Scenario
Device picture	Thumbnail of the current desktop background	—
Device name	[device name] in bold, with the model line under it, for example “System Product Name”. Rename link	Customer wants to give the PC a clearer name so it is easy to find on the network
Network tile	Wi-Fi icon. [network name] with the connection status, for example “Connected, secured”. Opens the main Network & internet page (Settings → Network & internet), documented in the Network & Internet section	Tech checks at a glance that the PC is online before troubleshooting
Windows Update tile	Update icon. “Windows Update” with “Last checked:” and how long ago. Opens the main	Tech checks at a glance whether Windows has looked for

	Windows Update page (Settings → Windows Update), documented in the Windows Update section	updates recently
Microsoft account card (section header)	Microsoft logo and the heading “It’s all here with Microsoft account”. Shown on a PC signed in with a local account	—
▶ **Card text**	“Sign in to connect your favorite Microsoft apps to your device.”	Customer asks why Settings keeps suggesting a Microsoft account
▶ **App icons**	A row of Microsoft app icons: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote, OneDrive, Defender and Clipchamp	—
▶ **Sign in**	Button	Customer decides to sign in with a Microsoft account to sync their apps
Recommended settings (section header)	Subtext: “Recent and commonly used settings”	—

▶ **Recommended setting rows**	One row per setting, each opening its own page, for example Storage, Installed apps and Sound. The list changes with how the PC is used	Customer opens the same few settings often and uses Home as a shortcut
Bluetooth devices (section header)	Subtext: “Manage, add, and remove devices”	—
▶ **Bluetooth**	Bluetooth icon. Subtext: “Discoverable as” [device name]. Toggle, On	Customer’s headphones will not pair and the tech checks that Bluetooth is on
▶ **Paired device rows**	One row per paired device, with its name, status (for example “Not connected”), a Connect button and a “...” more options button	Customer wants to reconnect their headphones without opening the full device list
▶ **View all devices**	Link. Opens Bluetooth & devices → Devices (documented in the Bluetooth & Devices section). Add device button on the same row	Customer wants to pair a new device or see every device on the PC
Personalize your device (section	Section header	—

header)

▸ **Theme gallery**	Six theme thumbnails in two rows, each showing a background with a sample window in its accent color. Selecting one applies that theme	Customer wants a quick new look without digging through Personalization
▸ **Color mode**	Palette icon. Dropdown, “Dark”. Same setting as Personalization → Colors	Customer wants to switch between light and dark mode
▸ **Browse more backgrounds, colors, and themes**	Link. Opens the main Personalization page (Settings → Personalization), documented in the Personalization section	Customer wants more choices than the six themes shown

Tech tip: Home is a dashboard, and its cards change with the account and with how the PC is used. A PC on a local account shows the Microsoft account sign-in card; a PC signed in with a Microsoft account shows different cards in its place. The model line under the device name comes from the PC’s firmware: “System Product Name” is a placeholder many motherboard makers leave on custom-built PCs, so it is not a Windows fault. On a store-bought PC the actual model shows here.

SECTION 07 OF 12



Network & Internet

18 Settings screens · pages 154–190

- Wi-Fi
- Ethernet
- VPN
- Mobile Hotspot
- Airplane Mode
- Proxy
- Dial-Up
- Advanced Network Settings
- Advanced Sharing Settings
- Data Usage
- Hardware and Connection Properties
- Network Reset

Network & Internet

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Network & Internet Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet

Item	Description	Scenario
Connection summary (top of page) (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Connected network**	Large Wi-Fi icon, the network name (for example “Wi-Fi ([network name])”) and the status “Connected, secured”	Tech sees at a glance what the PC is connected to and whether the connection is secured
▸ **Properties tile**	Info icon (i). Title “Properties”. Shows the network type and band, for example “Private network” and “6 GHz”	Tech wants the network type and band without opening the Wi-Fi pages
▸ **Data usage tile**	Pie chart icon. Title “Data usage”. Shows the total used over the last 30 days. Opens the Data usage page (documented under	Customer is worried about a data cap and wants a quick look at their usage

	Advanced network settings)	
Connection settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Wi-Fi**	Wi-Fi icon. Subtext: “Connect, manage known networks, metered network”. Toggle, On. Opens the Wi-Fi page (documented below)	Customer’s laptop has no Wi-Fi and the tech checks this toggle first, or the customer wants to pick a network
▸ **Ethernet**	Computer icon with a cable. Subtext: “Authentication, IP and DNS settings, metered network”. Opens the Ethernet page (documented below)	Customer’s desktop shows no internet over a cable
▸ **VPN**	Shield icon. Subtext: “Add, connect, manage”. Opens the VPN page (documented below)	Customer needs to set up or manage a VPN for work or a personal service
▸ **Mobile hotspot**	Hotspot icon. Subtext: “Share your internet connection”. Toggle, Off. Opens the Mobile hotspot page	Customer wants to share the PC’s internet with their phone or another device

	(documented below)	
▸ **Airplane mode**	Airplane icon. Subtext: “Stop wireless communication”. Toggle, Off. Opens the Airplane mode page (documented below)	Customer’s laptop shows no wireless connections at all
▸ **Proxy**	Network computer icon. Subtext: “Proxy server for Wi-Fi and Ethernet connections”. Opens the Proxy page (documented below)	Customer at a business location can’t get internet and needs to enter proxy settings
▸ **Dial-up**	Telephone icon. Subtext: “Set up a dial-up internet connection”. Opens the Dial-up page (documented below)	Customer has an old dial-up modem or ISP to set up
▸ **Advanced network settings**	Network adapters icon. Subtext: “View all network adapters, network reset”. Opens the Advanced network settings page (documented below)	Tech wants to see every network adapter, or needs the network reset option

Tech tip: Wi-Fi, Mobile hotspot and Airplane mode have toggles right on this page, so a customer’s “my Wi-Fi is gone” can often be checked without opening those pages.

Wi-Fi

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Wi-Fi

Item	Description	Scenario
Wi-Fi	Wi-Fi icon. Toggle, On	Customer's laptop has no Wi-Fi and the tech checks this toggle first
[network name] properties	Wi-Fi icon with a lock. Subtext: "Connected, secured". Opens the Wi-Fi → [network name] properties page (documented below)	Tech wants the full details of the network the PC is connected to
Show available networks	Antenna icon. Expandable row, collapsed on opening. The list is documented as Wi-Fi → Show available networks	Customer at a new location needs to pick their network from the list
Manage known networks	List icon. Subtext: "Add, remove, and edit networks". Opens the Manage known networks page (documented below)	Customer's laptop keeps joining an old network, or they want to add a hidden one
Hardware properties	Chip icon. Subtext: "View and manage Wi-Fi adapter properties". Opens the Hardware	Tech needs the adapter's model, driver version, band or link

	properties page (documented below)	speed
Random hardware addresses	Shuffle icon. Subtext: “Help protect your privacy by making it harder for people to track your device location.” Toggle, On	Privacy-conscious customer wants MAC randomization turned on or off, or a router with MAC filtering rejects the PC
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with WiFi**	Globe icon. Expandable row, shown expanded. Four links (below)	Customer or tech wants Microsoft’s help articles on Wi-Fi
▷ **Connecting to Wi-Fi using a QR code**	Link	Customer wants to join a network by scanning a code
▷ **Finding your IP address easily**	Link	Customer or tech needs the PC’s IP address
▷ **Run an internet speed test**	Link	Customer says the internet feels slow and wants to measure it

▹ **Setting up mobile hotspot**	Link	Customer wants to share their PC's connection with another device

Tech tip: Random hardware addresses appears here as a toggle and also on each network's own properties page as a dropdown. Check both when a router with MAC filtering rejects the PC.

Wi-Fi → [network name] Properties

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Wi-Fi → [network name] properties

Item	Description	Scenario
Wi-Fi network password	Hidden. Show button	Customer needs to share their Wi-Fi password with a guest
Connect automatically when in range	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the PC to rejoin this network on its own whenever it is in range
Network profile type	Public (selected) / Private	Customer can't see other PCs on the network for file sharing and needs Private

▸ **Configure firewall and security settings**	Link	Customer needs to allow an app through the firewall
Metered connection	Toggle, Off	Customer on limited hotspot data wants to reduce background usage
▸ **Set a data limit**	Link	Customer wants a warning before exceeding a data cap
Random hardware addresses	Dropdown, Off	Privacy-conscious customer wants MAC randomization for this network
IP assignment	“Automatic (DHCP)”. Edit button	Customer’s IT department requires a static IP on this network
DNS server assignment	“Automatic (DHCP)”. Edit button	Customer wants to set DNS by hand, for example to 1.1.1.1 or 8.8.8.8, for

		faster or safer browsing
SSID	The network name. Copy button	Customer needs to confirm which network name they are connected to
Protocol	The Wi-Fi standard in use, for example “Wi-Fi 6 (802.11ax)”	Customer wants to confirm their adapter supports the newer Wi-Fi standard
Security type	The security in use, for example “WPA3-Personal”	Customer needs to confirm their router’s security type matches what their device supports
Manufacturer	The Wi-Fi adapter’s maker	Tech identifies the adapter’s maker for driver troubleshooting
Description	The Wi-Fi adapter’s model name	Tech confirms the exact adapter model when sourcing a replacement driver
Driver version	The adapter’s driver version number	Customer’s Wi-Fi is glitchy and the

		tech checks whether the driver is outdated before updating it

Tech tip: If a customer's Wi-Fi keeps disconnecting and they suspect Windows is trying to use IPv6 when their router only supports IPv4, the IP settings for this network are near the bottom of this page.

Wi-Fi → Show Available Networks

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Wi-Fi → Show available networks (expanded)

Item	Description	Scenario
Connected network row	Network name with "Connected, secured". Info icon (i) and Disconnect button	Customer wants to disconnect from their own network for a moment to test another device
▶ **Info icon (i)**	Opens a quick network details popup	Tech wants a fast signal and security check without opening the full properties
Other nearby networks list	Each row shows the name, a lock icon if the network is secured, and	Customer at a new location needs to pick

	signal strength bars	their network from a crowded list of neighbors' networks
▸ **Passpoint-labeled network**	Connects with the carrier's credentials, no password needed	Customer with mobile service from a carrier connects to that carrier's hotspots without entering a password

Tech tip: Seeing the same network name twice is common with mesh or extender setups, or with duplicate broadcast names. It helps when a customer asks which one to pick.

Wi-Fi → Hardware Properties

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Wi-Fi → Hardware properties

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Section title on the page: "Wi-Fi properties"	—
IP assignment	"Automatic (DHCP)". Edit button	Customer's IT department requires a static IP
DNS server assignment	"Automatic (DHCP)". Edit button	Customer wants to set DNS by hand for faster or

		safer browsing
SSID	The network name. Copy button	Customer needs to confirm which network name they are connected to
Protocol	The Wi-Fi standard in use, for example “Wi-Fi 6 (802.11ax)”	Customer wants to confirm their adapter supports the newer Wi-Fi standard
Security type	The security in use, for example “WPA3-Personal”	Customer needs to confirm their router’s security type matches what their device supports
Manufacturer	The Wi-Fi adapter’s maker	Tech identifies the adapter’s maker for driver troubleshooting
Description	The Wi-Fi adapter’s model name	Tech confirms the exact adapter model
Driver version	The adapter’s driver version number	Tech checks whether the driver is outdated
Network band (channel)	The band and channel in use, for example “6 GHz	Customer’s router offers a 6

	(101)”	GHz band that older household devices can’t see, and the tech confirms which band this PC is on
Aggregated link speed (Receive/Transmit)	The link speed in Mbps, for example “2402/2402 (Mbps)”	Tech rules out a Wi-Fi bottleneck when a customer says the internet feels slow despite a fast plan

Tech tip: This page shows almost the same adapter and network details as the network’s own properties page. Only Network band (channel) and Aggregated link speed are unique to Hardware properties.

Wi-Fi → Manage Known Networks

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Wi-Fi → Manage known networks

Item	Description	Scenario
Search known networks	Search bar	Customer has dozens of saved networks from travel and wants to find one to remove

Sort by	Dropdown, currently “Preference”	Tech wants to reorder the saved networks, for example alphabetically instead of by priority
Filter by	Dropdown, currently “All”	Customer wants to see only the saved networks currently in range
Add a new network	“Add network” button	Customer wants to set up a hidden network (one that doesn’t broadcast its name) before ever being in range
Saved network row	Network name. Forget button	Customer’s laptop keeps joining an old neighbor’s or hotel’s network instead of their own, and the tech makes it Forget the unwanted one
▸ **arrow (>) on**	Opens that network’s	Tech wants the

a saved network row	properties (the Wi-Fi → [network name] properties page, documented above)	full properties of a saved network

Tech tip: When a laptop will not reconnect after the router's Wi-Fi password was changed, forget the saved network here and connect again with the new password.

Ethernet

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Ethernet

Item	Description	Scenario
Ethernet	Row showing the connection status, for example "Not connected". Expandable row, shown expanded (up arrow)	Customer's desktop shows no internet, and the first check is whether the Ethernet cable is actually connected
Authentication settings	Edit button	Customer's workplace uses 802.1X authentication on its wired network, which needs a username or certificate to connect

Metered connection	Toggle, Off. Text: “Some apps might work differently to reduce data usage...”	Customer with a capped wired connection (for example satellite or fixed wireless over Ethernet) wants to limit background data
▸ **Set a data limit**	Link	Customer wants Windows to warn them before hitting a monthly data cap on this wired connection
IP assignment	“Automatic (DHCP)”. Edit button	Customer’s router requires a static IP reservation for a device, for example for port forwarding to a home server
DNS server assignment	“Automatic (DHCP)”. Edit button	Customer wants faster or safer DNS, such as 1.1.1.1, instead of their ISP’s default
Manufacturer	The network adapter’s maker. Copy button	Tech identifies the adapter’s maker to find the

		right driver
Description	The network adapter's model name	Tech confirms the exact model, for example to check that a 2.5GbE adapter has a router or switch that supports it
Driver version	The adapter's driver version number	Tech checks for an outdated driver causing dropped connections
Physical address (MAC)	The adapter's MAC address, in the form XX:XX:XX:XX:XX:XX	Customer needs to add this address to their router's MAC filtering list to allow the wired connection

Tech tip: If updates or cloud sync seem stuck on a wired PC, check that Metered connection is Off, since a metered connection holds back some background downloads. The adapter details at the bottom (model, driver version, MAC address) are handy when checking for driver updates or registering the PC on a router.

VPN

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → VPN

Item	Description	Scenario
VPN connections (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Add VPN**	Button	Customer needs to set up a new VPN profile for work or a personal service
▶ **VPN profile**	A saved profile, for example “Work VPN”, with its status such as “Connecting”. Expandable row, shown expanded	Customer has a saved work VPN they use for remote access
▷ **Connecting to [server address]**	Live status with a spinner. Cancel button	VPN is stuck connecting and the customer needs to cancel and retry
Advanced settings for all VPN connections (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Allow VPN over metered networks**	Toggle, On	Customer on limited hotspot data still wants

		the VPN to work
▸ **Allow VPN while roaming**	Toggle, On	Customer traveling internationally wants the VPN active while roaming
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with VPN**	Link	Customer's VPN won't connect and the tech wants Microsoft's troubleshooting guidance

Tech tip: Add VPN covers the VPN types built into Windows. Most commercial VPN services use their own app, and their connection may not appear on this page. If a VPN stops working on a phone hotspot or while travelling, check the metered and roaming toggles.

Mobile Hotspot

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Mobile hotspot

Item	Description	Scenario
Mobile hotspot	Master toggle, currently	Customer wants

	On	to share their PC’s internet connection with their phone or another device
Share my internet connection from	Dropdown, “Wi-Fi” (grayed out while the hotspot is on)	Customer has both Wi-Fi and Ethernet and needs to pick which connection gets shared as the hotspot source
Share over	Dropdown, “Wi-Fi”	Customer wants to change how the hotspot is shared, for example over Bluetooth, if their hardware supports it
Power saving	Toggle, currently On. Text: “When no devices are connected, automatically turn off mobile hotspot”	Customer notices the hotspot turns off by itself. It is by design, to save power when idle
Properties	Expandable section, shown expanded (up arrow)	Customer wants to see or change the hotspot’s name and

		password
▸ **Network properties**	Edit button	Customer wants to rename the hotspot or change its password
▸ **Name**	The hotspot’s network name	Tech confirms the name to give to whoever wants to connect
▸ **Password**	The hotspot’s password, shown on the page	Customer needs the password to type into another device
▸ **Band**	“Any available”	Customer’s older device can’t see the hotspot, and the tech forces it to 2.4 GHz because the device doesn’t support 5 GHz
▸ **Security type**	“WPA2/WPA3”	Tech confirms the encryption standard in use
▸ **Scan to connect (QR code)**	QR image	Customer wants to connect a phone by scanning instead of typing the

password

Tech tip: Power saving turns the hotspot off when no device is connected, which is the usual reason a customer says it “keeps turning off”. The QR code is the easiest way to join a phone to the hotspot without typing the password.

Airplane Mode

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Airplane mode

Item	Description	Scenario
Info banner	Text: “We’ll remember if you turn on Bluetooth or Wi-Fi after turning on airplane mode. Next time you use airplane mode, Bluetooth or Wi-Fi won’t change.”	Customer is confused why their Wi-Fi stayed on the last time they used airplane mode
Airplane mode	Master toggle, currently Off	Customer’s laptop shows no Wi-Fi, Bluetooth or cellular at all, and this toggle being On by accident is a common first check
Wireless devices (section	Section header	—

header)		
▶ **Wi-Fi**	Toggle, currently On. Text: “Stays on in airplane mode”	Customer on a flight wants airplane mode on but still wants to use in-flight Wi-Fi
▶ **Bluetooth**	Toggle, currently On	Customer wants their Bluetooth headphones to keep working with airplane mode on
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Airplane mode**	Expandable row, shown expanded	Customer or tech wants Microsoft’s help articles on airplane mode
▷ **Activating airplane mode easily**	Link	Customer wants a quick tip, such as using the quick settings toggle instead of digging through Settings

Tech tip: Windows remembers whether Wi-Fi or Bluetooth was turned back on during airplane mode, which is why a customer may find Wi-Fi still on with airplane mode on. On a laptop whose Wi-Fi suddenly disappears, check this toggle and the keyboard's airplane key.

Proxy

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Proxy

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: "Use a proxy server for Ethernet or Wi-Fi connections. These settings don't apply to VPN connections."	—
Automatic proxy setup (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Automatically detect settings**	Toggle, currently On	Customer at a business location can't get internet, and Windows should detect the required proxy on its own, so this stays on
▶ **Use setup script**	Off. Set up button	Customer's employer gave

		them a proxy auto-config (PAC) script address that needs to be entered by hand
Manual proxy setup (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Use a proxy server**	Off. Set up button	Customer needs to enter a proxy address and port given by their IT department by hand

Tech tip: Because proxy settings don’t apply to VPN connections, fixing the proxy won’t fix a VPN that still isn’t working.

Dial-Up

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Dial-up

Item	Description	Scenario
Set up a new connection	Link. Opens the legacy Set Up a Connection or Network wizard (documented below)	Customer has an old dial-up modem or ISP and needs to configure it

Tech tip: Few customers still use dial-up, but Set up a new connection opens the classic wizard that also handles broadband (PPPoE) logins and manually adding a hidden Wi-Fi network.

Dial-Up → Set Up a Connection or Network (Legacy Wizard)

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Dial-up → Set up a new connection

Item	Description	Scenario
Connect to the Internet	"Set up a broadband or dial-up connection to the Internet". Highlighted when the wizard opens	Customer with an old dial-up ISP account needs to enter their phone number and credentials
Set up a new network	"Set up a new router or access point"	Customer is configuring a brand-new router from scratch
Manually connect to a wireless network	"Connect to a hidden network or create a new wireless profile"	Customer's Wi-Fi network doesn't broadcast its name and doesn't show in the normal list
Connect to a workplace	"Set up a dial-up or VPN connection to your workplace"	Customer needs an old-style dial-up VPN

		connection for a legacy work system
Next / Cancel buttons	Wizard navigation	Customer wants to continue with the wizard or back out of it

Tech tip: This is one of the few places in Windows 11 that still opens the old Control Panel wizard, an example of legacy interface surviving inside modern Settings.

Advanced Network Settings

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Advanced network settings

Item	Description	Scenario
Network adapters (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Adapter list**	Each row shows the adapter name, its description, a Disable button and a down arrow that expands the row. Examples: Ethernet, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth Network Connection, and virtual adapters such as VMware	Tech wants to see every network adapter on the PC in one place

▹ **Ethernet**	Status and adapter model, for example “Not connected”. Disable button	Customer’s Ethernet port isn’t being used, and the tech disables it so Windows stops treating it as a network priority
▹ **Wi-Fi**	Network name and adapter model. Disable button	Customer wants to turn Wi-Fi off without using Airplane mode, for example while testing Ethernet-only performance
▹ **Bluetooth Network Connection**	Description: “Bluetooth Device (Personal Area Network)”. Disable button	Customer set up Bluetooth tethering by accident and wants it off
▹ **Virtual adapters (for example VMware Network Adapter)**	Description such as “VMware Virtual Ethernet Adapter”. Disable button	Customer runs VMware and their real network feels slow, and the tech disables an unused virtual adapter to rule it out
More settings	Section header	—

(section header)		
▸ **Advanced sharing settings**	“Change network discovery and sharing settings”.	Customer can’t see other PCs on their home network for file sharing and needs network discovery turned on
▸ **Data usage**	Opens another page	Customer worried about a data cap wants to see how much each app and network has used
▸ **Hardware and connection properties**	Opens another page	Tech wants one technical view of all adapters (MAC address, speed, driver)
▸ **Network reset**	Subtext: “Reset all network adapters to factory settings”. Opens the Network reset page (documented below)	Tech wants to remove and reinstall all network adapters and set networking back to its defaults
Related settings	Section header	—

(section header)		
▶ **Windows Firewall**	External-link icon	Customer needs to allow an app through the firewall, or check it while troubleshooting a connection
▶ **Internet options**	External-link icon	Customer or tech needs the older Internet options settings
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Advanced network settings**	Globe icon. Expandable row, shown expanded. Four links (below)	Customer or tech wants Microsoft's help articles on these settings
▷ **Finding your app-wise data usage**	Link	Customer wants to know which apps are using their data
▷ **Finding your IP address easily**	Link	Customer or tech needs the PC's IP address
▷ **Run an**	Link	Customer says

internet speed test		the internet feels slow and wants to measure it
▹ **Resetting network adapters**	Link	Tech wants Microsoft's instructions before doing a network reset

Tech tip: Disabling and re-enabling an adapter here is a quick first fix for a connection that has stopped working, before trying Network reset. Virtual adapters from VPN or virtual machine software are normal and can usually be left alone.

Advanced Sharing Settings

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Advanced network settings → Advanced sharing settings

Item	Description	Scenario
Private networks (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Network discovery**	Toggle, On. Text: "Your PC can find and be found by other devices on the network"	Customer at home can't see other family PCs to share files and needs this On
▹ **Set up network connected**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants new devices on their home

devices automatically		network set up for easy access
▸ **File and printer sharing**	Toggle, Off. Text: “Allow others on the network to access shared files and printers on this device”	Customer wants to share a printer connected to this PC with another household PC
Public networks (labeled Current profile) (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Network discovery**	Toggle, Off	Customer at a coffee shop should not be discoverable, so Off is correct
▸ **File and printer sharing**	Toggle, Off	This should also stay Off on public or untrusted networks
All networks (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Public folder sharing**	Toggle, Off. Text: “Allow others on the network to	Customer wants a simple way to

	read and write files in Public folders”	share specific files with household members through the Public folder
▸ **File sharing connections**	“Use 128-bit encryption for devices that support it”. Dropdown, “128-bit encryption (Recommended)”	Customer has a very old device that can’t connect for file sharing, and the tech may need to lower the encryption for compatibility
▸ **Password protected sharing**	Toggle, On. Text: “Only people who have a user account and password on this PC can access shared files, printers, and Public folders”	Customer wants shared files locked down to authorized users of this PC
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help from the web**	Expandable row, shown expanded (up arrow)	Tech wants Microsoft’s guidance on network sharing settings

Tech tip: For sharing files on a home network, set that network to Private in its properties and turn on discovery under Private networks. Leave Public networks locked down, since that profile is used for cafés, hotels and other shared Wi-Fi.

Data Usage

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Advanced network settings → Data usage

Item	Description	Scenario
Total usage figure	Large figure at the top, labeled “From the last 30 days”	Customer thinks their internet is being throttled, and the tech checks whether they are near a data cap
Enter data limit	Text: “Windows can help you track data usage to stay under your limit—we’ll warn you when you’re close, but it won’t change your data plan”. Network selector dropdown. Enter limit button	Customer on a capped ISP plan wants Windows to warn them before they go over
Usage statistics (section header)	Section header. Filter by dropdown, currently “Last 30 days”	—

▶ **App usage list**	One row per app or service, largest first, with a bar and the amount of data used. Examples: a browser, System and Windows Update, a VPN service, a mail app, gaming services	Customer is surprised by how much data they use, and the tech shows which apps use the most

Tech tip: System and Windows Update showing a large number often explains a spike. Windows Update downloads in the background.

Hardware and Connection Properties

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Advanced network settings → Hardware and connection properties

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	One entry per network adapter. The example below is for an adapter that is not connected	—
Name	The adapter's name, for example "Wi-Fi 2". Copy button	Tech wants to copy the adapter's details for a ticket
Description	The adapter's model name	Tech confirms which adapter this entry is for
Physical address (MAC)	The adapter's MAC address, in the form	Tech needs the address to

	XX:XX:XX:XX:XX:XX	identify the adapter or add it to a router's filter list
Status	For example "Not operational"	Tech sees whether the adapter is working
Maximum transmission unit	For example "1500"	Tech checks the packet size when troubleshooting a connection
IPv4 address	For example a self-assigned 169.254.x.x/16 address (APIPA), which means there is no real network connection	Tech sees that the adapter never received an address from the router
IPv6 address	For example a link-local fe80:: address, which confirms there is no real IPv6 connection either	Tech confirms the adapter has no real IPv6 connectivity
DNS servers	The DNS servers the adapter uses, each labeled as encrypted or "Unencrypted"	Tech checks which DNS servers an adapter is using
Connectivity (IPv4/IPv6)	For example "Disconnected", consistent with a status of Not operational	Tech sees whether the adapter has any connectivity

Tech tip: A 169.254.x.x (APIPA) address with a status of Not operational and connectivity Disconnected is what an unused or inactive adapter looks like, such as a virtual adapter. It is not a real connectivity problem on a physical adapter.

Network Reset

Navigation path: Settings → Network & internet → Advanced network settings → Network reset

Item	Description	Scenario
Explanation text	Text: “This will remove then reinstall all your network adapters, and set other networking components back to their original settings. You might need to reinstall other networking software afterwards, such as VPN client software or virtual switches.”	Customer has tried the usual fixes and the tech is considering a full network reset
Restart notice	Text: “Your PC will be restarted.”	Customer needs to save their work before resetting
Network reset	“Reset now” button	Customer’s network is badly broken and the tech wants to start from default

Tech tip: The page warns that VPN client software or virtual switches may need to be reinstalled afterward, so note the customer’s VPN setup before resetting.

SECTION 08 OF 12



Personalization

13 Settings screens · pages 192–235

- Background
- Colors
- Themes
- Dynamic Lighting
- Lock Screen
- Text Input
- Start
- Taskbar
- Fonts
- Device Usage

Personalization

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Personalization Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization

Item	Description	Scenario
Preview	Picture of the current desktop background with a sample window drawn in the current mode and accent color	Customer wants to see the current look at a glance
Select a theme to apply (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Theme gallery**	Six theme thumbnails in two rows, each showing a background with a sample window in its accent color. Selecting one applies that theme	Customer wants a quick new look without opening the Themes page
Background	Subtext: “Background image, color, slideshow”. Opens the Background page (documented below)	Customer wants a different desktop picture
Colors	Subtext: “Accent color, transparency effects,	Customer wants dark mode or a

	color theme”. Opens the Colors page (documented below)	different accent color
Themes	Subtext: “Install, create, manage”. Opens the Themes page (documented below)	Customer wants a ready-made look with matching wallpaper, colors and sounds
Dynamic Lighting	Subtext: “Connected devices, effects, app settings”. Opens the Dynamic Lighting page (documented below)	Customer’s RGB keyboard or mouse lighting is not responding to Windows
Lock screen	Subtext: “Lock screen images, apps, animations”. Opens the Lock screen page (documented below)	Customer wants their own photo on the lock screen
Text input	Subtext: “Touch keyboard, voice typing, emoji and more, input method editor”. Opens the Text input page (documented below)	Customer wants to change how the touch keyboard or emoji panel looks
Start	Subtext: “Recent apps and items, folders”. Opens the Start page (documented below)	Customer wants fewer suggestions in Start
Taskbar	Subtext: “Taskbar	Customer wants

	behaviors, system pins". Opens the Taskbar page (documented below)	the taskbar icons on the left like Windows 10
Fonts	Subtext: "Install, manage". Opens the Fonts page (documented below)	Customer needs to install a font for a document
Device usage	Subtext: "Select all the ways you plan to use your device to get personalized tips, ads, and recommendations within Microsoft experiences". Opens the Device usage page (documented below)	Customer wants fewer tips and ads aimed at the wrong interests

Tech tip: The six themes at the top are a shortcut to the same theme gallery on the Themes page. Every other row opens the page of the same name. The same "Select a theme to apply" gallery also appears on the Home page under Personalize your device.

Background

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Background

Item	Description	Scenario
Preview thumbnail	Live preview of current desktop background at top	Customer wants to see how a change will look before applying

Personalize your background	Dropdown, currently “Picture”. Choices: Picture, Solid color, Slideshow, Windows spotlight. Description under the label: “A picture background applies to your current desktop. Solid color or slideshow backgrounds apply to all your desktops.”	Customer wants to switch from a static picture to a slideshow of rotating photos, a solid color, or Windows spotlight
Recent images	Thumbnail gallery of recently used backgrounds	Customer wants to quickly switch back to a background they used before
Choose a photo	Browse photos button	Customer wants to set a brand-new personal photo as their background
Choose a fit for your desktop image	Dropdown, currently “Fill”. Choices: Fill, Fit, Stretch, Tile, Center, Span. Also appears in Slideshow mode	Customer's background photo looks stretched or has black bars — tech changes the fit to Fit, Stretch, Tile, Center or Span to correct it

Choose your background color (Solid color mode)	Palette of 24 color swatches, one checked (dark purple on this PC). Under the heading “Choose your background color”	Customer wants a plain color desktop instead of a picture
Custom colors (Solid color mode)	View colors button	Customer wants a color that is not in the 24-swatch palette
Choose a picture album for a slideshow (Slideshow mode)	Browse button, with the currently chosen album folder shown below it ([album name])	Customer wants the desktop to rotate through photos from one folder
Change picture every (Slideshow mode)	Dropdown, currently “30 minutes”	Customer wants the slideshow to change faster or slower
Shuffle the picture order (Slideshow mode)	Toggle, Off	Customer wants the slideshow photos in random order
Windows spotlight mode	No extra rows appear under the dropdown in this mode. Only Related settings and Related support are shown below it	Customer picks Windows spotlight and asks where its options are

Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Contrast themes**	“Color themes for low vision, light sensitivity” Opens the Contrast themes page	Customer has low vision or light sensitivity and needs a high-contrast color theme
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Background**	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains four links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for background problems
▷ **Getting new wallpapers every day from Microsoft**	Link	—
▷ **Switching to a dark background theme**	Link	—
▷ **Create wallpapers**	Link	—

for your desktop		
▹ **Showing desktop icons**	Link	—

Tech tip: Windows spotlight changes the desktop picture daily and adds a “Learn about this picture” icon to the desktop. If a customer asks about that icon, this is why. When a photo looks stretched or has black bars, the fit setting fixes it: Fill crops to cover the screen, while Fit shows the whole picture with bars.

Colors

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Colors

Item	Description	Scenario
Preview thumbnail	Live preview of the current background with a sample window, drawn in the current mode and accent color	Customer wants to see how a mode or accent change will look before committing
Choose your mode	Dropdown, currently “Dark”. Choices: Light, Dark, Custom. Icon: paintbrush. “Change the colors that appear in Windows and your apps”	Customer finds Windows too bright or too dark, or wants light and dark mixed
Choose your default	Dropdown, currently “Dark”. Choices: Light,	Customer wants Windows itself

Windows mode (Custom mode)	Dark. Appears only when Choose your mode is set to Custom	(Start, taskbar) in one mode and apps in the other
Choose your default app mode (Custom mode)	Dropdown, currently “Dark”. Choices: Light, Dark. Appears only when Choose your mode is set to Custom	Customer wants apps in one mode and Windows itself in the other
Transparency effects	Toggle, On. Icon: sparkle in a dashed square. “Windows and surfaces appear translucent”	Customer finds translucent windows hard to read or wants a cleaner look
Accent color	Dropdown, currently “Manual”, section expanded. Choices: Automatic, Manual. Icon: paint palette. With Automatic, Windows picks the accent from the background; the palette stays visible but no swatch is checked	Customer wants the accent to follow the wallpaper, or to stay a fixed color
Recent colors	Five swatches of recently used accent colors; the current one is checked (purple on this PC)	Customer wants to switch back to an accent color used before
Windows colors	Palette of 48 color swatches in a grid, 9 per row (3 in the last row)	Customer wants to pick a standard

		Windows accent color
Custom colors	View colors button; opens the custom accent color picker described in the next row	Customer wants a color that is not in the palette
Choose a custom accent color (picker)	Opens from View colors. A color field with a circle marker and a color-name tooltip (e.g. Purple); a vertical bar showing the new color above the current color; a brightness slider; a More/Less expander. More reveals a format dropdown (choices: RGB, HSV), a hex code box (e.g. #A94DC1) and Red/Green/Blue number boxes (e.g. 169, 77, 193). Below: a Color preview with four sample tiles, and Done and Cancel buttons	Customer needs an exact brand color, entered by hex code or RGB values
Show accent color on Start and taskbar	Toggle, On	Customer wants Start and the taskbar to use the accent color, or to stay neutral
Show accent	Toggle, On	Customer wants

color on title bars and window borders		window title bars and borders to use the accent color, or to stay neutral
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Contrast themes**	“Color themes for low vision, light sensitivity” Opens the Contrast themes page	Customer has low vision or light sensitivity and needs a high-contrast color theme
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Colors**	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains four links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for color problems
▷ **Changing desktop or background colors**	Link	—
▷ **Resolving high contrast**	Link	—

problems		
▷ **Switching to a dark theme now!**	Link	—
▷ **Changing taskbar color**	Link	—

Tech tip: Custom mode lets Windows itself (Start and the taskbar) be dark while apps stay light, or the other way round. Show accent color on Start and taskbar only works when the default Windows mode is Dark.

Themes

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Themes

Item	Description	Scenario
Preview thumbnail	Live preview of current theme	Customer wants to preview before committing to a theme
Background	“Windows spotlight”	Confirms which background source the current theme uses
Color	“Purple” — shows the name of the current accent color; reads “Automatic” when	Confirms accent color behavior

	Accent color is set to Automatic	
Sounds	“Windows Default”	Customer wants distinct sounds bundled into a custom theme
Mouse cursor	“Windows Default” — shows the name of the current cursor scheme	Customer wants a different cursor bundled into their theme
Save	Button	Customer wants to save their custom Background/Color/Sounds/Cursor combo as a new theme
Current theme	“Custom” shown on the right, section expanded. “Choose a combination of wallpapers, sounds, and colors together to give your desktop more personality”	Explains why the theme shows as “Custom” instead of a named built-in theme
Theme gallery	Grid of seven theme thumbnails (four in the first row, three in the second). One of them has a small round badge icon in its corner	Customer wants a one-click coordinated theme instead of manual setup

Get more themes from the Microsoft Store	Browse themes button	Customer wants more themes not built into Windows
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Desktop icon settings**	External link icon	Customer wants to show/hide icons like This PC, Recycle Bin, or Network on the desktop
▶ **Contrast themes**	“Color themes for low vision, light sensitivity”. Opens the Contrast themes page (documented in the Accessibility section)	Customer with low vision needs a high-contrast theme
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Themes**	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains four links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for theme and desktop icon problems

▹ **Getting new wallpapers every day from Microsoft**	Link	—
▹ **Switching to a dark theme now!**	Link	—
▹ **Showing Recycle Bin on desktop**	Link	—
▹ **Showing icons on my desktop**	Link	—

Tech tip: Applying a theme replaces the background, accent color, sounds and mouse cursor all at once. If the customer has a setup they like (shown as “Custom”), use Save first so they can get it back. Desktop icon settings is still the place to bring back This PC or the Recycle Bin on the desktop.

Dynamic Lighting

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Dynamic Lighting

Item	Description	Scenario
Info banner	“No Dynamic Lighting-compatible devices detected.”	Customer's new RGB peripherals aren't showing up — first check is whether the

		hardware actually supports the Dynamic Lighting standard
Manage all Dynamic Lighting devices (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Use Dynamic Lighting on my devices**	Toggle, Off on this PC (no compatible devices detected). Icon: starburst	Master switch — customer wants to fully disable Windows-controlled RGB if it conflicts with game software
▸ **Compatible apps in the foreground always control lighting**	Toggle, Off on this PC	Customer wants their active game to control lighting instead of Windows
▸ **Background light control**	Expandable row, shown collapsed. “Let another app control lighting when an app or game isn't in use. Apps have control in the order you choose below.”	Customer wants a specific app to control lighting when nothing else is active

▹ **Dynamic Lighting Background Controller**	Draggable list item (six-dot drag handle), shown when Background light control is expanded	Customer wants to reorder priority among multiple background lighting apps
▶ **Brightness**	Slider, handle at the far right. “Change the brightness of your lights”. Greyed out and unavailable on this PC (no compatible devices detected)	Customer finds lighting too bright/distracting
▶ **Effects**	Dropdown, “Solid Color”. “Choose color themes and effects for your lighting”. Greyed out on this PC and the dropdown will not open, but the row still expands to show the three rows below	Customer wants a rainbow/breathing effect instead of a static color
▹ **Match my Windows accent color (inside Effects)**	Toggle, On	Customer wants the lighting to follow the Windows accent color
▹ **Main color (inside Effects)**	Palette of 49 color swatches, 9 per row (4 in the last row); one swatch is checked (blue on this	Customer wants a specific static lighting color

	PC)	
▹ **Custom colors (inside Effects)**	Select button	Customer wants a lighting color that is not in the palette
Learn more about Dynamic Lighting and background light control	Link, below the settings	—

Tech tip: Dynamic Lighting only controls keyboards, mice and other lights that support the Windows lighting standard. If the device maker's own RGB software should be in charge, turn off Use Dynamic Lighting on my devices so the two do not fight over the lights.

Lock Screen

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Lock screen

Item	Description	Scenario
Preview	Live preview of the lock screen with the time and date over the current image (the clock and date are sample values). In Slideshow mode a play-icon overlay appears in the top-left corner	Customer wants to see how the lock screen will look before changing it
Personalize	Dropdown, currently	Customer wants

your lock screen	“Slideshow”. Choices: Windows spotlight, Picture, Slideshow. Icon: monitor with lock. Expandable in Slideshow and Picture modes; in Windows spotlight mode there is nothing to expand	their lock screen to cycle through a photo slideshow, show one fixed picture, or show Microsoft's rotating images
Recent images (Picture mode)	Thumbnail gallery of five recently used lock screen images	Customer wants to switch back to a lock screen picture used before
Choose a photo (Picture mode)	Browse photos button	Customer wants a specific personal photo as the lock screen
Add an album for your slideshow (Slideshow mode)	Browse button	Customer wants the slideshow to use a specific folder of photos
Pictures (Slideshow mode)	Folder row, folder icon, Remove button. Two rows with the same name appear on this PC, each with its own Remove button; they most likely point to	Customer wants to stop using a folder in the slideshow

	different folders and look identical without deeper inspection	
Get fun facts, tips, tricks, and more on your lock screen	Checkbox, checked. Appears in both Slideshow and Picture modes	Customer is bothered by tips and suggestions appearing on the lock screen
Advanced slideshow settings (Slideshow mode)	Expandable section, expanded. Contains the four rows below	Customer wants finer control over the slideshow
▸ **Include camera roll folders from this PC and OneDrive**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants camera photos included in the slideshow
▸ **Only use pictures that fit my screen**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer sees cropped or letterboxed pictures on the lock screen
▸ **When my PC is inactive, show the lock screen instead of turning off the screen**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the slideshow to keep playing while the PC is idle

▶ **Turn off the screen after the slideshow has played for**	Dropdown, currently “Don't turn off”	Customer wants the screen to turn off after the slideshow has played for a while
Lock screen status	25H2 only: dropdown “None”, description “Choose an app to show detailed status on the lock screen”. Sat between the Turn off the screen dropdown and the sign-in toggle. Not present on 26H2 in any of the three modes	Customer wants weather or mail status on the lock screen (25H2)
Show the lock screen background picture on the sign-in screen	Toggle, On. Appears in all three modes	Customer wants the sign-in screen to match, or not match, the lock screen
Widgets	Toggle, Off. Icon: widgets. “Manage the widgets on your lock screen”. Appears in all three modes	Customer wants widgets such as weather on the lock screen
Suggest widgets for your lock screen	Toggle, Off. Appears in all three modes	Customer is getting widget suggestions on the lock screen, or wants them

Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Screen timeout**	Opens the screen timeout settings	Customer's screen turns off or locks too soon or too late
▶ **Screen saver**	External link icon, opens the Screen Saver Settings window	Customer wants to set up or turn off a screen saver
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Lock screen**	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains three links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for lock screen problems
▷ **Customizing your screen saver settings**	Link	—
▷ **Changing lock screen wallpaper**	Link	—
▷ **Fixing lock screen timeout**	Link	—

Tech tip: The same page also opens from Settings → Accounts → Sign-in options → Lock screen personalization. Unchecking Get fun facts, tips, tricks, and more removes most of the suggestions shown on the lock screen.

Text Input

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Text input

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Choose a theme for touch keyboard, voice typing, emoji and more, and input method editors."	Explains the page's purpose
Live preview panel	Shows sample keyboard/emoji panel	Customer previews theme before applying
Preview your input theme here	Interactive text box	Customer tests how theme looks with real typing
▶ **Emoji and more (Win + . or ;)**	Shortcut hint	Customer wants the emoji panel shortcut
▶ **Voice typing (Win + H)**	Shortcut hint	Customer wants the voice dictation shortcut
Theme	Expandable section, expanded. Paint-palette icon. Grid of 16 tiles in three columns: System	Customer wants their input tools to match a personal color

	default (plain text tile) plus 15 themes, each showing an “Aa” box and a microphone circle. Several tiles have gradient or artwork backgrounds, and the current choice has a highlight ring	preference
Custom theme	Button with a “+” icon, labeled “Custom theme”, at the bottom of the Theme section	Customer wants a fully custom color combo not in the presets
Touch keyboard	Expandable section, shown expanded	Customer with a touchscreen wants to adjust the on-screen keyboard
▸ **Keyboard size**	Slider (handle near the middle of the track on this PC)	Customer with a touchscreen finds the on-screen keyboard too small to tap accurately
▸ **Show key background**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants a cleaner look with key outlines hidden
▸ **Key text size**	Dropdown, “Small”. Choices: Small, Medium, Large	Customer with vision difficulty wants larger key

		labels
▶ **View your changes**	Open keyboard button	Customer wants to test the touch keyboard live after adjusting settings
Related links (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Show touch keyboard icon in taskbar**	Link	Customer on a non-touch PC wants the on-screen keyboard icon available for accessibility use
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Keyboard device**	“Character repeat, hotkeys” Opens the Keyboard device page	Customer has repeating or stuck keys, or wants to change keyboard hotkeys
▶ **Typing settings**	“Spelling, touch keyboard, hardware keyboard” Opens the Typing settings page	Customer wants autocorrect, spelling or typing behavior changed

Tech tip: The theme here colors the touch keyboard, emoji panel, voice typing and input method editors. It does not change a physical keyboard. Whether the touch keyboard icon shows on the taskbar is set under Personalization → Taskbar.

Start

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Start

Item	Description	Scenario
Layout options (section header)	Section header	—
Pinned	Toggle, On. Icon: pin. “Apps you've pinned to Start that you can customize”	Customer wants their pinned apps shown in Start, or the pinned area removed
Recent	Toggle, On. Icon: clock. “Recently added apps and used files”. Expandable row, shown expanded; contains the three checkboxes below	Customer wants to hide recent apps and files from Start
▸ **Show recently added apps**	Checkbox, checked	Customer just installed a new app and expects it to appear in Start automatically

▸ **Show recent and suggested files**	Checkbox, checked	Privacy-conscious customer does not want recently opened files showing up for others to see
▸ **Show tips and app recommendations**	Checkbox, checked	Customer finds Start menu ads and suggestions annoying and wants them turned off
All	Toggle, On. Icon: bulleted list. “Show all installed apps and system components in Start”. Expandable row; contains one checkbox	Customer wants the full app list available from Start
▸ **Show most used apps (grid and list views only)**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants Start to surface frequently used apps instead of pinning them manually
Start menu size	Dropdown, currently “Automatic (default)”. Choices: Automatic (default), Small, Large	Customer wants a larger or smaller Start menu for their screen
Other (section	Section header	—

header)		
Show mobile device in Start	Toggle, On. Icon: phone. “Calls, texts, and other notifications are shown in the Start menu”. Expandable row	Customer wants their phone calls and texts visible from the PC Start menu (via Phone Link)
▸ **Open Phone Link to choose more settings**	Open Phone Link button, shown when the row is expanded	Customer wants to change Phone Link settings
Folders	“These folders appear on Start next to the Power button” Opens the Folders sub-page documented below	Customer wants quick access to Documents, Downloads or Settings next to the Power button
Show account-related notifications	Toggle, On. “When off, required notifications are still shown”	Customer wants fewer account-related nags (like verify your email) appearing in Start
Show recent items in jump lists and File Explorer	Toggle, On. “When off, recent files will stop showing in Start menu”	Customer does not want recent files showing in jump lists and File Explorer
Hide your name and	Toggle, Off	Customer shares a screen or PC

profile picture on Start		and wants their name and picture hidden
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Start**	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains two links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for Start problems
▷ **Changing Start menu color**	Link	—
▷ **Opening the Start menu**	Link	—

Tech tip: Turning off Show recent and suggested files and Show tips and app recommendations removes most of the suggestions and ads from Start. Turning off Show recent items in jump lists and File Explorer also clears recent files from File Explorer's Home view.

Start → Folders

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Start → Folders

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Choose which folders appear on Start next to the Power button."	Explains the purpose of this sub-page

Settings	Toggle, Off	Customer wants one-click access to Settings right from the Start menu's power area
File Explorer	Toggle, On	Customer wants quick File Explorer access without opening the taskbar icon
Documents	Toggle, Off	Customer frequently accesses Documents and wants a shortcut in Start
Downloads	Toggle, Off	Customer constantly checks Downloads and wants faster access
Music	Toggle, Off	Customer wants a quick shortcut to their Music library
Pictures	Toggle, Off	Customer wants a quick shortcut to Pictures

Videos	Toggle, Off	Customer wants a quick shortcut to Videos
Network	Toggle, Off	Customer frequently browses network shares and wants quick access
Personal folder	Toggle, Off	Customer wants a shortcut to their user profile folder (C:\Users\[username])

Tech tip: Turning on Settings and File Explorer here puts one-click icons next to the Power button on Start, which helps customers who struggle to find Settings.

Taskbar

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Taskbar

Item	Description	Scenario
Taskbar items	Expandable section, expanded. “Show or hide buttons that appear on the taskbar”	Customer wants to add or remove buttons on the taskbar
▶ **Search**	Dropdown, currently “Search box”. Choices: Hide, Search icon only, Search icon and label,	Customer wants to shrink the search box to just an icon to

	Search box	save space
▶ **Task view**	Toggle, On	Customer wants to remove Task View since they use Alt+Tab instead
▶ **Widgets**	Toggle, Off	Customer wants quick access to news and weather widgets
▶ **Resume**	Toggle, On. “Show app with a badge notification when Resume is available”	Explains a badge icon the customer noticed on an app
System tray icons	Expandable section, expanded. “Choose which icons can appear in the system tray”	Customer wants to control which icons appear next to the clock
▶ **Emoji and more**	Dropdown, currently “Never”. Choices: Never, While typing, Always. “Show the Emoji and more panel icon (select Windows logo key + period (.) to open the panel anytime)”	Customer wants a visible emoji icon instead of using the keyboard shortcut
▶ **Pen Menu**	Toggle, Off. “Show pen menu icon when pen is in use”	Customer with a stylus wants quick pen settings access

▸ **Touch keyboard**	Dropdown, currently “When no keyboard attached”. Choices: Never, Always, When no keyboard attached. “Show touch keyboard icon”	Customer on a 2-in-1 wants the touch keyboard icon always visible
Other system tray icons	Expandable section, collapsed by default. “Show or hide additional system tray icons”	Customer wants to control visibility of specific background app icons individually
▸ **Hidden icon menu**	Toggle, On. “Icons which are turned off can be accessed in this menu”	Customer cannot find a tray icon that disappeared
▸ **One toggle per app with a tray icon**	Each row shows the app icon and name with an On/Off toggle, for example Microsoft OneDrive and Windows Explorer. The list depends on the apps installed	Customer wants one particular app icon always visible, or hidden, in the tray
Taskbar behaviors	Expandable section, expanded. “Taskbar alignment, badging, automatically hide, and multiple displays”	Customer wants to change how the taskbar looks and behaves
▸ **Taskbar**	Heading with description “Choose where the	Customer wants the taskbar at the

position	taskbar is positioned on your screen". Four picture tiles: Bottom (selected), Top, Left, Right	top or on a side of the screen
▶ **Taskbar icon alignment**	Dropdown, currently "Left". Choices: Left, Center. "Choose how your icons are positioned on the taskbar". Called Taskbar alignment on 25H2	Customer prefers the classic left-aligned look, or the centered Windows 11 look
▶ **Taskbar size**	Dropdown, currently "Default". Choices: Default, Small	Customer wants a smaller taskbar to gain screen space
▶ **Automatically hide the taskbar**	Checkbox, unchecked. Note under it: "This setting is only available when the taskbar is at the bottom."	Customer wants more screen space, with the taskbar hiding until moused to
▶ **Show badges on taskbar apps**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants notification count badges on taskbar icons
▶ **Show flashing on taskbar apps**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants a taskbar app to flash for attention (for example an incoming call)

▸ **Show my taskbar on all displays**	Checkbox, unchecked, greyed out on this PC	Customer with multiple monitors wants the taskbar on every screen
▸ **When using multiple displays, show my taskbar apps on**	Dropdown, currently “All taskbars”, greyed out on this PC	Customer wants app icons only on the monitor they are open on
▸ **Share any window from my taskbar**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants to quickly share a window from the taskbar
▸ **Select the far corner of the taskbar to show the desktop**	Checkbox, checked	Explains why clicking the bottom-right corner minimizes everything
▸ **Combine taskbar buttons and hide labels**	Dropdown, currently “Always”. Choices: Always, When taskbar is full, Never	Customer wants multiple windows of the same app grouped into one icon
▸ **Combine taskbar buttons and hide labels on other**	Dropdown, currently “Always”, greyed out on this PC	Same setting for secondary monitors

taskbars		
▶ **Show smaller app icons**	Dropdown, currently “When taskbar is full”. Choices: Always, When taskbar is full, Never. Called Show smaller taskbar buttons on 25H2	Customer with many open apps wants smaller icons to avoid overflow
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Date & time**	“Time zones, automatic clock settings, calendar display” Opens the Date & time page	Customer needs to fix the clock or time zone shown on the taskbar
▶ **Notifications**	“Alerts from apps and system, do not disturb” Opens the Notifications page	Customer wants to control which alerts appear on the taskbar
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Taskbar**	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains four links, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help articles for taskbar problems
▷ **Pinning your favorite contacts to**	Link	—

taskbar		
▹ **Showing the battery icon on the taskbar**	Link	—
▹ **Pinning an app to the taskbar**	Link	—
▹ **Changing taskbar color**	Link	—

Tech tip: Taskbar icon alignment set to Left gives the classic Windows 10 look. When a tray icon goes missing, check Other system tray icons and the Hidden icon menu before reinstalling anything. Automatically hide the taskbar only works with the taskbar at the bottom.

Fonts

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Fonts

Item	Description	Scenario
Info banner (top)	“Fonts Control Panel is being redirected here. To access the legacy interface, click this link or navigate to C:\WINDOWS\Fonts in File Explorer.” Info icon, dismiss (X) button	Explains to a customer why the old Fonts Control Panel now opens this Settings page instead

▶ **Legacy Fonts Control Panel interface**	Link	Tech needs the old-style font folder view for advanced management (for example deleting fonts or viewing hidden fonts)
Drag and drop to install	“Drag font files from File Explorer or your desktop and drop them here to install fonts on your device.” Dashed drop area with a Browse and install fonts button	Customer received a custom font file for a document or design project and needs to install it
Get more fonts in the Microsoft Store	External link icon, opens the Microsoft Store	Customer wants to browse and download free or paid fonts from the Store
Related settings	Expandable section, collapsed by default. Contains the three rows below	Customer needs a font-related tool
▶ **Adjust ClearType text**	External link icon, opens the ClearType Text Tuner	Customer finds text blurry or hard to read on their display
▶ **Find a character**	External link icon, opens the Character Map	Customer needs a special symbol or character

▶ **Download fonts for all languages**	Download icon	Customer needs font support for languages not currently installed
Available fonts (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Search bar**	“Type here to search”	Customer wants to check if a specific font is already installed
▶ **Filter by**	Dropdown, currently “Scripts for all languages”. A long alphabetical list of writing scripts: Adlam, Arabic, Arabic (Nastaliq variant), Armenian, Balinese, Bamum, Bangla, Berf, Bopomofo, Brahmi, Braille, Buginese, and more (only the first entries catalogued)	Customer wants to filter fonts by a specific script (for example Cyrillic or Arabic) for a multilingual document
▶ **Result count**	“92 fonts found” (sample value; depends on the fonts installed)	Confirms how many fonts are currently installed on this rig
▶ **Font cards**	Grid of preview cards, one per installed font,	Customer wants to preview or

	each showing sample text in that font and a “...” menu. Clicking the card opens that font's detail page (documented in the next table)	inspect a font
▶ **Font card “...” menu**	Two items: Hide, Uninstall	Customer wants to hide or remove a font they no longer use
Info banner (bottom)	“Are these font previews in a language different from what you expected? Click below to edit your preferred languages list.” Info icon, dismiss (X) button	Customer sees font previews in an unexpected language
▶ **Edit preferred languages**	Link	Customer wants to change the preferred languages list
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Fonts**	Expandable row, globe icon, expanded. Contains one link, listed below	Customer needs Microsoft help for adding fonts
▷ **Adding new**	Link	—

fonts from Microsoft Store

Tech tip: If a document shows the wrong font, check here whether that font is installed; the search bar is the quickest way. Hiding a font keeps it installed but out of app font lists, which is safer than uninstalling it.

Fonts → Font Details (Example: Avignon Pro)

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Fonts → Avignon Pro (any installed font)

Item	Description	Scenario
Preview box	"Type here to preview font"	Customer wants to see their own text in the font before using it
Change font size	Slider with a value label, currently "24 points"	Customer wants a larger or smaller preview
Font styles list	One row per style, each drawn in its own style. Example (Avignon Pro): Regular, Italic, Medium, Medium Italic, Demi, Demi Italic, Bold, Bold Italic, Xlight, Xlight Italic. The list depends on the font	Customer wants to see which weights and styles a font includes
Metadata	Section header	—

(section header)		
▸ **Font face selector**	“Select a font face to see its metadata.” Dropdown, currently “Regular”. Note below: “Metadata may differ between font faces within a family.”	Customer wants details for a specific style of the font
▸ **Full name**	Example: Avignon Pro	Customer needs the exact font name for a document or support request
▸ **Font file**	Example: C:\WINDOWS\FONTS\AVIGNON PRO-BOOK.TTF, with an Uninstall button beneath it	Tech needs the file location, or the customer wants to remove the font
▸ **Version**	Example: Version 1	Tech is checking whether a font is out of date
▸ **Manufacturer**	Example: SoftMaker Software GmbH and its licensors	Customer asks who made the font
▸ **Copyright**	Example text: copyright notice for the font	Customer asks about licensing for the font
▸ **Legal trademarks**	Example text: trademark notice for the font	Customer asks about licensing for the font

Tech tip: The Manufacturer and Copyright fields help check a font's license before a customer uses it in commercial work. Font file shows where the font lives in the Windows Fonts folder.

Device Usage

Navigation path: Settings → Personalization → Device usage

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Select all the ways you plan to use your device to get personalized tips, ads, and recommendations within Microsoft experiences." — More about device usage link	Explains to a privacy-conscious customer why Windows is asking about their usage habits
Development	Toggle, Off. "Build delightful apps, websites, and tools for the world"	Customer is a developer and wants Windows to surface dev-related tips and recommended tools
Gaming	Toggle, On. "Play and discover games, keep up with new releases"	Customer wants game-related tips and Xbox app recommendations
Family	Toggle, Off. "Connect	Customer setting

	with family members, edit safety settings, give everyone their own profile on this device”	up a shared family PC wants relevant Family Safety tips surfaced
Creativity	Toggle, On. “Bring your ideas to life with photos and videos”	Customer into photo/video editing wants creative app suggestions
School	Toggle, Off. “Take notes, write essays, collaborate on projects”	Student customer wants Windows to recommend note-taking and Office tools
Entertainment	Toggle, On. “Watch videos, browse the web, connect on social media”	Customer wants streaming/media app recommendations
Business	Toggle, On. “Track expenses, manage your business, chat with customers”	Small business owner wants relevant productivity tool suggestions
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: These toggles only change which tips, ads and recommendations Microsoft shows. Turning them all off does not change how any app works.

SECTION 09 OF 12



Privacy & Security

37 Settings screens · pages 237–300

- Windows Security
- Find My Device
- Recommendations & Offers
- Speech
- Inking & Typing Personalization
- Diagnostics & Feedback
- Search
- Location
- Camera
- Microphone
- Voice Activation
- Notifications
- Account Info
- Contacts
- Calendar
- Phone Calls
- Call History
- Email
- Tasks
- Messaging
- Radios
- Other Devices
- App Diagnostics
- Automatic File Downloads
- Documents
- Downloads Folder
- Music Library
- Pictures
- Videos
- File System
- Screenshot Borders
- Screenshots and Screen Recording
- Text and Image Generation
- Passkeys
- Foreground Text Access

Privacy & Security

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Privacy & Security Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security

Item	Description	Scenario
Security (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Windows Security**	Shield icon. Subtext: “Antivirus, browser, firewall, and network protection for your device”. Opens the Windows Security page (documented below)	Customer’s PC is showing security warnings
▸ **Find my device**	Device-with-pin icon. Subtext: “Track your device if you think you’ve lost it”. Opens the Find my device page (documented below)	Customer wants to be able to locate a lost laptop
Windows permissions (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Recommenda**	Lock icon. Subtext: “Advertising ID,	Customer wants fewer ads and

tions & offers	personalized offers, local content, app launches, settings suggestions, productivity tools". Opens the Recommendations & offers page (documented below)	suggestions
▶ **Speech**	Speech icon. Subtext: "Online speech recognition for dictation and other voice-based interactions". Opens the Speech page (documented below)	Customer's online voice recognition is not working
▶ **Inking & typing personalization**	Clipboard icon. Subtext: "Custom dictionary, words in your dictionary". Opens the Inking & typing personalization page (documented below)	Customer's autocorrect picks up wrong words
▶ **Diagnostics & feedback**	Heartbeat icon. Subtext: "Diagnostic data, inking and typing data, feedback frequency". Opens the Diagnostics & feedback page (documented below)	Customer is concerned about data sent to Microsoft
▶ **Search**	Magnifying glass icon. Subtext: "Search history,	Customer's Windows Search

	search apps, cloud content search, search indexing". Opens the Search page (documented below)	is not finding files
App permissions (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Location**	Arrow icon. Opens the Location page (documented below)	Customer's weather app or Find my device is not working
▸ **Camera**	Camera icon. Opens the Camera page (documented below)	A video call app cannot use the webcam
▸ **Microphone**	Microphone icon. Opens the Microphone page (documented below)	A voice call or dictation app cannot pick up sound
▸ **Voice activation**	Microphone icon. Opens the Voice activation page (documented below)	Customer's headset button does not launch their voice assistant
▸ **Notifications**	Bell icon. Opens the Notifications page (documented below)	Customer sees popups from apps they do not recognize
▸ **Account info**	Person-with-lines icon.	Customer is

	Opens the Account info page (documented below)	worried apps can see their account details
▶ **Contacts**	Two-people icon. Opens the Contacts page (documented below)	A contact-syncing app stopped working
▶ **Calendar**	Calendar icon. Opens the Calendar page (documented below)	A scheduling app cannot show meetings
▶ **Phone calls**	Phone icon. Opens the Phone calls page (documented below)	A calling app cannot start calls
▶ **Call history**	Clock icon. Opens the Call history page (documented below)	Customer does not want an app to see their call history
▶ **Email**	Envelope icon. Opens the Email page (documented below)	A third-party email app stopped syncing
▶ **Tasks**	Clipboard-with-check icon. Opens the Tasks page (documented below)	A to-do app is not syncing tasks
▶ **Messaging**	Speech bubble icon. Opens the Messaging page (documented below)	Customer with a cellular PC asks why an app can read their texts
▶ **Radios**	Radio waves icon. Opens the Radios page	Customer's Bluetooth or Wi-

	(documented below)	Fi keeps being switched by a background app
▸ **Other devices**	Device icon. Opens the Other devices page (documented below)	Customer asks why their PC syncs with nearby unpaired devices
▸ **App diagnostics**	Line-graph icon. Opens the App diagnostics page (documented below)	Customer notices a utility app can see what other apps are running
▸ **Automatic file downloads**	Cloud icon. Opens the Automatic file downloads page (documented below)	Customer blocked a cloud storage app and wants to let it ask again
▸ **Documents**	Folder icon. Opens the Documents page (documented below)	A backup or sync app cannot reach the Documents folder
▸ **Downloads folder**	Folder-with-arrow icon. Opens the Downloads folder page (documented below)	A file manager cannot see files in Downloads
▸ **Music library**	Folder-with-note icon. Opens the Music library page (documented below)	A music player cannot see the customer's songs

▶ **Pictures**	Picture icon. Opens the Pictures page (documented below)	A camera or photo backup app cannot save or read pictures
▶ **Videos**	Film strip icon. Opens the Videos page (documented below)	A video editor or media player cannot see videos
▶ **File system**	File icon. Opens the File system page (documented below)	An isolated desktop app cannot read or write the files it needs
▶ **Screenshot borders**	Picture icon. Opens the Screenshot borders page (documented below)	Customer sees a colored border around their screen during screen sharing
▶ **Screenshots and screen recording**	Picture-in-frame icon. Opens the Screenshots and screen recording page (documented below)	Customer worries an app captured their screen
▶ **Text and image generation**	Laptop icon. Opens the Text and image generation page (documented below)	Customer is confused why apps show AI writing or image suggestions
▶ **Passkeys**	Person-with-key icon. Opens the Passkeys	Customer's browser keeps

	page (documented below)	asking to save or use a passkey
▶ **Foreground text access**	Keyboard icon. Opens the Foreground text access page (documented below)	A writing assistant cannot insert text into the box the customer is typing in

Tech tip: The page is grouped under the headings Security, Windows permissions and App permissions. Those headings are not pages, so every page path goes straight from Privacy & security to the page name. Every row opens the page of the same name.

Windows Security

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Windows Security

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Windows Security is your home to view and manage the security and health of your device.” Open Windows Security button	Customer’s PC is showing security warnings, or the tech wants a quick health check before diagnosing other issues
Protection areas (section header)	Section header	—

▸ **Virus & threat protection**	Green check mark and the status “No actions needed.” External-link icon. Opens the Windows Security app	Tech checks antivirus status
▸ **Account protection**	Green check mark and the status “No actions needed.” External-link icon. Opens the Windows Security app	Tech checks sign-in and account protection
▸ **Firewall & network protection**	Green check mark and the status “No actions needed.” External-link icon. Opens the Windows Security app	Tech checks the firewall
▸ **App & browser control**	Green check mark and the status “No actions needed.” External-link icon. Opens the Windows Security app	Tech checks app and browser protection
▸ **Device security**	Green check mark and the status “No actions needed.” External-link icon. Opens the Windows Security app	Tech checks device security features
▸ **Device performance & health**	Subtext: “Reports on the health of your device.” External-link icon. Opens the Windows Security app	Tech wants the device health report

▸ **Family options**	Subtext: “Manage how your family uses their devices.” External-link icon. Opens the Windows Security app	Customer wants family safety options
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Windows Security**	Expandable row, expanded. Four links: “Updating Windows Security signatures manually”, “Activating Windows Security on your device”, “Allowing Microsoft Edge through firewall”, “Scanning your device for malware”	Customer’s antivirus definitions are out of date or a scan is needed, and the tech opens these help articles

Tech tip: All seven rows open the separate Windows Security app. This page is a launcher and does not hold settings itself.

Find My Device

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Find my device

Item	Description	Scenario
Info banner	Yellow warning banner: “To make changes, sign in with your Microsoft	Customer cannot change the setting because

	account." Sign in button. The banner depends on the account: an earlier capture on a non-administrator account showed "While this setting applies to everyone who uses this device, only administrators can make changes." with a Manage accounts button instead	they use a local account or are not an administrator
Find my device	Subtext: "Save this device's location when it's connected to the internet—go to account.microsoft.com to locate it". Toggle, On, grayed out until the banner's requirement is met	Customer's laptop was lost or stolen and they want location tracking turned on ahead of time
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Find my device needs a Microsoft account to show the device on account.microsoft.com. On a local account the toggle is grayed out, even when it shows On, so the customer has to sign in with a Microsoft account before tracking will work.

Recommendations & Offers

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Recommendations & offers

Item	Description	Scenario
Personalized offers	Subtext: “Get personalized tips, ads, and recommendations based on my Windows activity”. Toggle, Off. Expandable row	Customer wants fewer personalized tips and ads
▶ **Explanation text**	Text that Windows uses info about the device and how it is used to show personalized tips, recommendations and offers, and that Microsoft also uses data from other products. Includes a link to stop use of that other data	Customer asks what data is used for personalized offers
Allow websites to access my language list	Subtext: “Let websites show me content in my preferred language by accessing my language list”. Toggle, On	Customer wants websites to stop reading their language list
Improve Start and search results	Subtext: “Let Windows improve Start and search results by tracking which apps I open”. Toggle, On	Customer does not want Windows tracking which apps they open

Show notifications in Settings	Subtext: “Required notifications will be shown even if this setting is off”. Toggle, On	Customer wants fewer notices inside Settings
Recommendations and offers in Settings	Subtext: “Let Windows show me product recommendations and offers in Settings”. Toggle, On	Customer wants product offers out of Settings
Advertising ID	Subtext: “Let apps show me personalized ads by using my advertising ID”. Toggle, Off	Customer wants apps to stop using their advertising ID for personalized ads
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Privacy**	Expandable row, expanded. Three links: “Managing Microsoft account privacy settings”, “Changing privacy settings”, “Consumer health	Customer wants a plain explanation of Windows privacy settings before deciding which tracking options

	privacy”	to turn off

Tech tip: This page is the quickest way to cut down on ads and tracking-based suggestions while still keeping required system notifications visible.

Speech

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Speech

Item	Description	Scenario
Online speech recognition (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Page description**	“Use your voice for apps using Microsoft’s online speech recognition technology.”	—
▸ **Warning text**	“If you turn off online speech recognition, you won’t be able to use apps that use Microsoft’s online speech recognition technology. However, you can still use the Windows Speech Recognition app and other speech services that don’t use Microsoft’s online speech recognition technology.”	Customer asks what stops working if they turn it off

▶ **Online speech recognition**	Toggle, Off	Customer's voice commands or dictation in an app that relies on cloud speech are not working
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy Statement". Only two links here; this page has no Privacy dashboard link	Customer wants to read what Microsoft does with voice data before turning online speech recognition on

Tech tip: This setting only affects apps that use Microsoft's online speech recognition. The local Windows Speech Recognition app still works with it off.

Inking & Typing Personalization

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Inking & typing personalization

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	"Get better suggestions by creating a custom dictionary using your typing and handwriting info. If you turn off this setting, your dictionary will be cleared and your suggestions won't be personalized."	—

Custom inking and typing dictionary	Subtext: “Use my typing history and handwriting patterns to create a custom dictionary”. Toggle, On	Customer’s autocorrect or handwriting recognition picks up wrong words and they want to stop it learning
Custom dictionary	Link. Opens the Custom dictionary page (documented below)	Customer wants to clear or export what Windows has learned
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Turning off Custom inking and typing dictionary clears the dictionary straight away. If the customer may want their learned words later, export them on the Custom dictionary page first.

Inking & Typing Personalization → Custom Dictionary

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Inking & typing personalization → Custom dictionary

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	“This dictionary is used to make better typing suggestions and improve handwriting recognition	—

	for each of the languages you use”	
Clear your custom dictionary	Button	Customer’s autocorrect keeps suggesting wrong or embarrassing words
Export your custom dictionary	Button	Customer switching PCs wants to bring their personalized suggestions along
Privacy resources	One link only: “About these settings and your privacy”	Customer wants to know what Windows keeps in the dictionary before clearing or exporting it

Tech tip: Export saves the learned words so they can be moved to a new PC. Clear cannot be undone.

Diagnostics & Feedback

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Diagnostics & feedback

Item	Description	Scenario

Diagnostic data	Subtext: “Helps to improve Windows and keep it secure, up to date, and working as expected”. Status: “Sending required data”. Expandable row	Customer is concerned about how much data Windows sends to Microsoft
▶ **Required data text**	“You’re sending required diagnostic data” — “As a part of using Windows, your device sends Microsoft a limited set of data that is necessary to keep your device and operating system secure, up to date, and working as expected.”	—
▶ **Send optional diagnostic data**	Subtext: “Help Microsoft improve your Windows experience and fix problems more quickly by sending us additional diagnostic data. This includes data about websites you browse, how you use apps and features, and enhanced error reporting.” Toggle, Off	Customer wants to know what the optional data includes, or whether to send it
▷ **Optional data**	“Your device will be equally secure and will	—

reassurance	operate normally even if you choose not to send optional diagnostic data.”	
Improve inking and typing	Subtext: “Send optional inking and typing diagnostic data to Microsoft”. Toggle, Off. Expandable row	Customer wants to control inking and typing data sharing
▶ **Info banner**	Info icon. “Your current diagnostic data setting prevents sharing inking and typing data with Microsoft.”	Customer asks why the inking and typing toggle is unavailable
▶ **Improve the language recognition and suggestion capabilities of Microsoft apps and services by sending optional inking and typing diagnostic data to Microsoft**	Toggle, Off (disabled)	Customer wants the toggle on but it is grayed out
View diagnostic	Subtext: “View your data in the Diagnostic Data	Customer wants to see exactly

data	Viewer". Expandable row	what Windows sends
▶ **Turn on the Diagnostic Data Viewer**	Text: uses up to 1 GB of hard drive space. Toggle, Off	Customer wants to turn on the viewer and needs to know the space cost
▶ **View my data in the Diagnostic Data Viewer**	Subtext: "Open Diagnostic Data Viewer" button (disabled until the viewer is turned on)	Customer wants to open the viewer
Delete diagnostic data	Subtext: "Clear diagnostic data that Microsoft has collected about this device". Expandable row. After a delete has been requested, an info icon and "Last delete request:" with the date and time appear under the subtext	Customer wants the collected data deleted
▶ **Delete text**	"Once you delete your data here, we start removing copies from our systems. If you have a Microsoft account, you might have additional diagnostic data you can delete on the privacy dashboard." Delete	Customer wants to delete the data collected about this device

	button	
Feedback (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Feedback frequency**	Subtext: “Choose how often Windows asks for your feedback”. Dropdown, “Automatically (Recommended)”	Customer wants fewer feedback prompts
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: A tech can walk a worried customer through required versus optional diagnostic data, inking and typing data sharing, the Diagnostic Data Viewer, and how to delete data already collected.

Search

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Search

Item	Description	Scenario
Indexing status	Line near the top of the page showing the indexing state, for example “Done”, with counts of indexed and pending items	Customer’s Windows Search is not finding files and the tech checks whether indexing has

		finished
Search history	Subtext: “Store my search history on this device to improve search results”. Toggle, On. Expandable row	Customer wants search history stored or not
▸ **Clear device search history**	Clear button	Customer wants their stored search history cleared for privacy
Show search highlights	Subtext: “See content suggestions in the search box and in search home”. Toggle, On	Customer wants the content suggestions in the search box turned off
Search my accounts	Subtext: “Windows Search can personalize your search results by including your content from various apps and services”. Expandable row	Customer wants search to include, or leave out, content from their accounts
▸ **Microsoft account**	Subtext: “Allow Windows Search to provide results from the apps and services that you are signed in to with your personal Microsoft account”. Toggle, On	Customer wants personal account results in search, or not

▶ **Work or School account**	Subtext: “Allow Windows Search to provide results from the apps and services that you are signed in to with your work or school account”. Toggle, On	Customer wants work or school results in search, or not
Find my files	Subtext: “Choose where your PC will search for files”. Expandable row	Customer wants search to cover more or fewer places
▶ **Classic**	Subtext: “Search only your Documents, Pictures, and Music folders plus the desktop”. Radio button, selected. “Customize search locations” link	Customer wants search limited to their main folders
▶ **Enhanced**	Subtext: “Search your entire PC (may affect battery life and CPU consumption) – PC must be plugged in for initial indexing. You can manage which folders will be excluded from enhanced search.” Radio button, unselected	Customer wants search to cover the entire PC, and the tech warns about battery and CPU use
▶ **Excluded folders**	Text: “These folders won’t be included when searching your PC”. Add	Customer wants to keep certain folders out of

	an excluded folder button. A list of excluded folders follows (by default, system folders such as the ProgramData folder, the AppData folders and the Windows folder), each with a “…” more options button	search to protect performance
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Manage accounts on this device**	Link	Customer wants to manage the accounts on the PC
▸ **Personalize Windows Search on the taskbar**	Link	Customer wants to change how search looks on the taskbar
▸ **Advanced indexing options**	External-link icon	Tech needs the older indexing options window
▸ **Indexer troubleshooter**	External-link icon	Search results are missing or stale and the tech wants to run the troubleshooter

Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Switching from Classic to Enhanced search lets Windows search the whole PC. Excluding system folders keeps the performance cost down.

Location

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Location

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	“Windows can use your device’s capabilities like GPS or Wi-Fi to determine your location. Microsoft might use location data to improve the accuracy of its location services. Some desktop apps might not appear on this page or be affected by these settings.” “Learn more about location” link	—
Location services	Subtext: “When this is on, location will be available to Windows and anyone using this device can choose	Customer’s weather app or Find my device is not working, and the tech checks

	whether apps can access their location". Toggle, On	the master location switch
Let apps access your location	Subtext: "All apps can access approximate location, but you can choose which apps can access your precise location". Toggle, On. Expandable row	Customer wants to choose which apps can use their location
▸ **Store app list**	One row per Store app, each with its own toggle. The row for an app that used location shows a "Last accessed" date	Customer wants to see which apps used their location and when, and switch individual apps off
▸ **Let desktop apps access your location**	Subtext: "Desktop apps that have previously accessed your location are listed here". Toggle, On	Customer wants desktop apps to stop using their location
▸ **Desktop app list**	One row per desktop app that has used location, each with a "Last accessed" time	Customer wants to see which desktop apps used their location
▸ **Default location**	Subtext: "Windows, apps, and services can use the default location when we can't detect a	Customer wants a fallback location set

	more precise location". Set default button	
▸ **Allow location override**	Subtext: "Windows, apps, and services can use the location from a remote connection instead of this device's location". Toggle, On	Customer using a remote connection gets the wrong location
Recent activity	Subtext: "Review location access from the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page". Shows the number of requests, for example "513 requests". Expandable row, collapsed on opening	Customer wants to audit how often apps asked for their location
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Location**	Expandable row, expanded. One link: "Understanding unsigned	An unfamiliar desktop app shows up in the

	apps”	location list, and the tech checks what an unsigned app is before deciding whether to block it

Tech tip: A tech can review the full access history here and switch permissions per app. Use it when a customer is worried about which apps have been reading their location.

Camera

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Camera

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	“The settings on this page do not prevent you from signing in with your camera using facial recognition (Windows Hello). Some desktop apps might not appear on this page or be affected by these settings.” “Learn more about camera” link	—
Camera access	Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have camera access when this is on”. Toggle, On	A video call app cannot use the webcam and the tech checks the master switch

Let apps access your camera	Subtext: “Choose which apps can access your camera”. Toggle, On. Expandable row	Customer wants to choose which apps can use the camera
▸ **Store app list**	One row per Store app, each with its own toggle. An app that used the camera shows a “Last accessed” date	Customer wants to see which apps used the camera and when
▸ **Let desktop apps access your camera**	Subtext: “Desktop apps that have previously accessed your camera are listed here”. Toggle, On	Customer wants desktop apps blocked from the camera
▸ **Desktop app list**	One row per desktop app that has used the camera, each with a “Last accessed” date	Customer wants to see which desktop apps used the camera
Recent activity	Subtext: “Review camera access from the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page”. Shows the number of requests, for example “1 request”. Expandable row, collapsed on opening	Customer worries an app used the camera in the background
Related settings	Section header	—

(section header)		
▸ **Camera device settings**	Link	Customer wants to adjust their camera device
▸ **Sign-in options and facial recognition**	Link	Customer wants to set up or review face sign-in
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Camera**	Expandable row, expanded. Two links: “Managing camera permissions for apps”, “Understanding unsigned apps”	A customer’s webcam works in one app but not another, and the tech opens these help articles while checking which apps have camera access

Tech tip: These settings do not block Windows Hello face sign-in. If the camera works in one app but not another, check that app's toggle in the Store app list. Desktop apps such as video-call programs are only controlled together, by the Let desktop apps access your camera toggle.

Microphone

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Microphone

Item	Description	Scenario
Microphone access	Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have microphone access when this is on". Toggle, On	A voice call or dictation app cannot pick up sound and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your microphone	Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your microphone". Toggle, On. Expandable row	Customer wants to choose which apps can use the microphone
▸ **Store app list**	One row per Store app, each with its own toggle	Customer wants to switch the microphone off for one app
▸ **Let desktop apps access your microphone**	Subtext: "Desktop apps that have previously accessed your microphone are listed here". Toggle, On	Customer wants desktop apps blocked from the microphone

▶ **Desktop app list**	One row per desktop app that has used the microphone, each with a “Last accessed” time	Customer wants to see which desktop apps used the microphone, for example to diagnose unexpected background access
Recent activity	Subtext: “Review microphone access from the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page”. Shows the number of requests, for example “0 requests”. Expandable row, collapsed on opening	Customer wants to audit microphone use
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with**	Expandable row,	A customer’s

Microphone	expanded. Four links: “Troubleshooting microphone privacy settings”, “Resolving microphone detection problems”, “Enabling microphone for specific apps”, “Understanding unsigned apps”	headset mic is not picked up in a call app, and the tech opens these help articles while checking the permission toggles

Tech tip: If a call app cannot hear the customer, check the master switch, then the app’s own toggle. Desktop apps are only controlled together, by Let desktop apps access your microphone. If the permissions are fine, check the input device under System → Sound.

Voice Activation

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Voice activation

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	“Choose your privacy settings for voice activation. If microphone access is turned off, these settings will be unavailable.”	—
Microphone	Microphone icon. Link/row, arrow (>), shown as “On”. Opens the Microphone page. Voice activation requires	Customer’s voice activation does not work and the tech checks microphone

	microphone access	access first
Let apps access voice activation services	Microphone icon. Toggle, On. Expandable row	Customer wants to control whether apps can use voice keywords
▸ **Let apps use voice activation when device is locked**	Subtext: “If this device is locked, anyone can activate an app by speaking its voice keyword when this is on”. Toggle, On. Shown when the row above is expanded	Customer is concerned that voice commands can activate apps while the PC is locked
Apps that have requested voice activation access (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Assign a default app for headset button**	Headset icon. Subtext: “By default, allow the last used voice activation app to start when headset button is pressed”. Dropdown, “Last used app”	Customer’s headset button does not launch their voice assistant app
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy	Customer wants to read how their data is used or

	dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Leaving the locked-device toggle On means voice commands can trigger app actions without unlocking the PC. The section header names apps that have requested access, but no per-app list appears under it on this page.

Notifications

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Notifications

Item	Description	Scenario
Notification access	Bell icon. Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to their notifications when this is on". Toggle, On	Customer sees notification popups from apps they do not recognize and wants to control access
Let apps access your notifications	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your notifications". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read notifications
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: The banners and sounds for each app's notifications are under System → Notifications, not here.

Account Info

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Account info

Item	Description	Scenario
Account info access	Person icon. Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to their account info when this is on". Toggle, On	Customer is worried random apps can see their name, picture and account details
Let apps access your account info	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your account info". Toggle, On. Expandable row, reveals the app list	Customer wants to restrict which apps can read their account info
▸ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Feedback Hub	Customer wants to switch off one app
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard
Related	Section header	—

support (section header)		
▸ **Help with Account info**	Expandable row, expanded. One link: “Managing Microsoft account privacy settings”	Customer wants to know which account details apps can see and how to change their Microsoft account privacy settings

Tech tip: Turning off account info stops apps from showing the user’s name and picture. It does not affect signing in to Windows.

Contacts

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Contacts

Item	Description	Scenario
Contacts access	Two-people icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to their contacts when this is on”. Toggle, On	A contact-syncing app stopped working and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your contacts	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can access your contacts”. Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read contacts

Recent activity	Clock icon. Subtext: “Review contacts access from the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page”. Expandable row, shows “0 requests” when collapsed	Customer wants to see which apps used this permission in the last 7 days
▸ **No recent activity available**	Status text, shown when Recent activity is expanded and nothing happened in the 7-day window	—
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Recent activity is a 7-day access log. It does not appear on every App permissions page.

Calendar

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Calendar

Item	Description	Scenario
Calendar access	Calendar icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access	A scheduling app cannot show upcoming meetings and the

	to their calendar when this is on". Toggle, On	tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your calendar	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your calendar". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read the calendar
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: If a calendar app shows no events, check both toggles here before troubleshooting the account itself.

Phone Calls

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Phone calls

Item	Description	Scenario
Phone call access	Phone icon. Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if their apps can make phone calls when this is on". Toggle, On	A calling app cannot start calls and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps make phone calls	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can make phone calls". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can make calls
Recent activity	Clock icon. Subtext: "Review phone call	Customer wants to see which

	requests from the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page". Expandable row, shows "0 requests" when collapsed	apps used this permission in the last 7 days
▸ **No recent activity available**	Status text, shown when Recent activity is expanded and nothing happened in the 7-day window	—
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: This permission mainly matters on a PC with cellular service or one linked to a phone. On most desktops the app list is empty.

Call History

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Call history

Item	Description	Scenario
Call history access	Clock icon. Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access	Customer notices an unfamiliar app can see who

	to their call history when this is on". Toggle, On	they called and wants to restrict it
Let apps access your call history	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your call history". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read call history
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Like Phone calls, this mainly matters on a PC with cellular service or one linked to a phone. On most desktops no apps are listed.

Email

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Email

Item	Description	Scenario
Email access	Envelope icon. Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to their email when this is on". Toggle, On	A third-party email app stopped syncing and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your email	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your email". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read email

Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Email**	Expandable row, expanded. Three links: “Managing Microsoft account privacy settings”, “Changing my Microsoft account email”, “Unblocking my Microsoft account”	Customer is locked out of their Microsoft account or wants to change its email address, and the tech opens these help articles

Tech tip: This controls apps that read email through accounts added to Windows. It does not affect webmail opened in a browser.

Tasks

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Tasks

Item	Description	Scenario
Tasks access	Clipboard icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access	A to-do app is not syncing tasks and the tech checks the

	to their tasks when this is on". Toggle, On	master switch
Let apps access your tasks	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your tasks". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read tasks
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: This covers to-do apps that read tasks stored with the user's accounts. On many PCs no apps have asked for it.

Messaging

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Messaging

Item	Description	Scenario
Messaging access	Speech bubble icon. Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to read text messages with a cellular connection when this is on". Toggle, On	Customer with a cellular PC asks why an app can read their text messages
Let apps read messages	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can read messages". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read messages

Recent activity	Clock icon. Subtext: “Review text message access from the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page”. Expandable row, shows “0 requests” when collapsed	Customer wants to see which apps used this permission in the last 7 days
▶ **No recent activity available**	Status text, shown when Recent activity is expanded and nothing happened in the 7-day window	—
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: The wording “with a cellular connection” is specific to this page. The setting matters mainly on PCs with cellular service.

Radios

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Radios

Item	Description	Scenario
Radio control access	Radio waves icon. Subtext: “Anyone using	Customer’s Bluetooth or Wi-

	this device can choose if their apps have access to control device radios when this is on". Toggle, On	Fi keeps being switched by a background app
Let apps control device radios	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can control your device radios". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can turn the radios on or off
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Radios here means the wireless hardware such as Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and cellular.

Other Devices

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Other devices

Item	Description	Scenario
Communicate with unpaired devices (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Section text**	"Let your apps automatically share and sync info with wireless	Customer asks why their PC syncs with

	devices that don’t explicitly pair with your PC, tablet, or phone”	nearby devices they never paired
▶ **Communicate with unpaired devices**	Toggle, On, shown under the section text	Customer wants apps to stop syncing with unpaired devices
▶ **Example text**	Example: beacons. Static text	—
▶ **Choose apps that can communicate with unpaired devices**	Link	Customer wants to pick which apps may do this
Use trusted devices (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Section text**	“Let your apps use your trusted devices (hardware you’ve already connected, or comes with your PC, tablet, or phone)”	Customer asks whether apps can use hardware like an Xbox or a TV without a pairing step
▶ **Example text**	Examples: Xbox One, TVs, projectors. Static text, with no toggle or link shown under it	—

Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Unpaired-device communication is on by default and many customers do not know it exists.

App Diagnostics

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → App diagnostics

Item	Description	Scenario
App diagnostic access	Line icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to diagnostic info about other apps when this is on”. Toggle, On	Customer notices a system utility or antivirus app can see what other apps are running
Let apps access diagnostic info about your other apps	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can access diagnostic info about your other apps”. Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read this info
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Security and system-monitoring tools need this to see what other apps are running. An app here that the customer does not recognize is worth a closer look.

Automatic File Downloads

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Automatic file downloads

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description	"Windows can automatically download files from your online storage provider for apps that request them. If you block any of those apps from requesting automatic file downloads, you can allow them to make requests again."	—
Allow previously blocked apps to request automatic file downloads	Cloud icon. Subtext: "Previously blocked apps will be allowed to ask your permission to download files again". Allow button, grayed out when no app is blocked	Customer previously blocked a cloud storage app and wants to let it ask again
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy

	Statement”	dashboard
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Automatic file downloads**	Expandable row, expanded. One link: “Managing automatic file download notifications”	Customer keeps seeing prompts about apps downloading files from cloud storage and wants to manage those notices

Tech tip: The Allow button is grayed out when no app is currently blocked. The breadcrumb at the top of this page shows “...” in place of “Privacy & security”.

Documents

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Documents

Item	Description	Scenario
Documents library access	Folder icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to their documents library when this is on”. Toggle, On	A backup or sync app cannot reach the Documents folder and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can	Customer wants to restrict which

documents library	access your documents library". Toggle, On. Becomes an expandable row only when apps have asked for access; on the 26H2 recheck no apps were listed and the row could not be expanded	apps can read their documents
▸ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Feedback Hub	Customer wants to switch off an app they do not recognize
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: The apps in the list should be ones the customer recognizes, such as office suites, cloud sync tools and note-taking apps. An unfamiliar app is worth a closer look.

Downloads Folder

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Downloads folder

Item	Description	Scenario
Downloads folder access	Folder-with-arrow icon. Subtext: "Anyone using this device can choose if	A file manager or archive tool cannot see files

	their apps have access to their downloads folder when this is on". Toggle, On	in Downloads and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your downloads folder	List icon. Subtext: "Choose which apps can access your downloads folder". Toggle, On	Customer wants to choose which apps can read Downloads
Privacy resources	Links: "About these settings and your privacy" | "Privacy dashboard" | "Privacy Statement"	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Library permissions like this one apply to Store apps. Ordinary desktop programs can still open the Downloads folder whatever this page says.

Music Library

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Music library

Item	Description	Scenario
Allow access to music libraries on this device (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Section text**	"If you allow access, people using this device	Customer's music player

	will be able to choose if their apps have access to their music library by using the settings on this page. If you deny access, all apps that are available in the Microsoft Store on Windows 11 will be blocked from accessing any person's music library."	cannot see their songs
▶ **Allow access to music libraries on this device**	Toggle, On, shown under the section text	Tech checks the master switch
Allow apps to access your music library (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Section text**	"If you allow access, you can choose which apps can access your music library by using the settings on this page. If you deny access, apps that are available in the Microsoft Store on Windows 11 will be blocked from accessing your music library."	Customer wants to choose which apps can read the music library

▸ **Allow apps to access your music library**	Toggle, On, shown under the section text	Customer wants to block all apps from the music library
Choose which apps can access your music library (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Section text**	“Some apps need to access your music library to work as intended. Turning off an app here might limit what it can do.”	Customer wants to turn off one app
▸ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Media Player	Customer wants to switch off access for an app
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Music library uses longer section headings with explanatory text, while Pictures and Videos use the shorter row layout.

Pictures

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Pictures

Item	Description	Scenario
Pictures library access	Picture icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to their pictures library when this is on”. Toggle, On	A camera or photo backup app cannot save or read pictures and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your pictures library	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can access your pictures library”. Toggle, On. Expandable row, reveals the app list	Customer wants to restrict which apps can read their pictures
▸ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Camera and Scan	Customer wants to switch off an app
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: The Camera app needs this permission to save photos. If photos are not being saved, check that Camera is On in the app list.

Videos

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Videos

Item	Description	Scenario
Videos library access	Film strip icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to their videos library when this is on”. Toggle, On	A video editor or media player cannot see videos and the tech checks the master switch
Let apps access your videos library	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can access your videos library”. Toggle, On. Expandable row, reveals the app list	Customer wants to restrict which apps can read their videos
▸ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Camera and Media Player	Customer wants to switch off an app
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: Like Pictures, the Camera app needs this permission to save video recordings. Ordinary desktop programs are not controlled by this page.

File System

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → File system

Item	Description	Scenario
File system access	File icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to all of their files when this is on”. Toggle, On	A portable or isolated desktop app cannot read or write files it needs
Let apps access your file system	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can have access to all of your files”. Toggle, On	Customer wants to restrict broad file access
Reset file permissions on isolated Win32 applications	List icon. Expandable row	Customer wants to reset file permissions for an isolated desktop app
▸ **Empty-list text**	“After installing isolated Win32 applications, they will show up here”	—
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: This is one of the more security-sensitive toggles in App permissions, because it covers access to all of the user’s files.

Screenshot Borders

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Screenshot borders

Item	Description	Scenario
Screenshot border settings access	Picture icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps have access to settings for turning off screenshot borders when this is on”. Toggle, On	A customer sees a colored border around their screen during screen sharing and wants to control it
Let apps turn off the screenshot border	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can access your screenshot border settings”. Toggle, On. Expandable row, reveals the app list	Customer wants to choose which apps can turn the border off
▶ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Microsoft Clipchamp, Microsoft Teams and Snipping Tool. An app that has used the permission shows “Last accessed” with a date and time; an app that is running shows an info icon and “Currently in use”	Customer wants to switch off an app

▶ **Let desktop apps turn off the screenshot border**	Subtext: “Desktop apps that have previously requested access to your screenshot border settings are listed here”. Toggle, On. Shown at the bottom of the expanded app list	Customer wants to control desktop apps too
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: The breadcrumb at the top of this page shows “...” in place of “Privacy & security”. This page is a companion to Screenshots and screen recording.

Screenshots and Screen Recording

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Screenshots and screen recording

Item	Description	Scenario
Screenshots and screen recording access	Picture icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps can take screenshots or record the screen when this is on”. Toggle, On	Customer is worried an app took a screenshot or recorded their screen without their knowledge
Let apps take	List icon. Subtext:	Customer wants

screenshots and record the screen	“Choose which apps can take screenshots and record the screen”. Toggle, On. Expandable row, reveals the app list	to restrict which apps can capture the screen
▸ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Microsoft Teams and Snipping Tool	Customer wants to switch off an app
▸ **Let desktop apps take screenshots and record the screen**	Subtext: “Desktop apps that have previously requested access to take screenshots or record the screen are listed here”. Toggle, On. Shown at the bottom of the expanded app list	Customer wants to control desktop apps too
Recent activity	Clock icon. Subtext: “Review screenshot or screen recording requests in the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page”. Expandable row, shows “0 requests” when collapsed	Customer wants to see which apps used this permission in the last 7 days
▸ **No recent activity available**	Status text, shown when Recent activity is expanded and nothing	—

	happened in the 7-day window	
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: This page tracks actual capture events through Recent activity. Screenshot borders only controls a visual indicator. The breadcrumb at the top of this page shows “...” in place of “Privacy & security”.

Text and Image Generation

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Text and image generation

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description	“Text and image generation uses on-device generative AI technologies to quickly respond to requests. Turning these settings off will not affect apps and features using cloud AI technologies.”	—
Text and image generation	Picture icon. Subtext: “Windows and anyone using this device can use Text and image	Customer is confused why Notepad, Outlook or

	generation”. Toggle, On	Photos show AI writing or image suggestions
Let apps use Text and image generation	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can use Text and image generation”. Toggle, On. Expandable row, reveals the app list	Customer wants to choose which apps can use on-device AI
▶ **Per-app list**	One row per app, each with its own toggle, for example Microsoft Clipchamp, Notepad, Outlook, Photos, Snipping Tool and Xbox	Customer wants to switch off an app
Recent activity	Clock icon. Subtext: “See requests to use Text and image generation in the last 7 days.”. Shows “0 requests”. Expandable row, collapsed on opening	Customer wants to see which apps used the feature
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: This page covers on-device generative AI only. Cloud AI features are not affected by these toggles. The

breadcrumb at the top of this page shows “...” in place of “Privacy & security”.

Passkeys

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Passkeys

Item	Description	Scenario
Allow passkey access (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Passkey access**	Key icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps can create or use passkeys when this is on”. Toggle, On	Customer’s browser keeps asking to save or use a passkey, and the tech checks the master switch
▸ **Let apps create and use passkeys**	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can create and use passkeys”. Expandable row	Customer wants to choose which apps can create and use passkeys
▸ **Recent activity**	Clock icon. Subtext: “Review passkey creation or passkey usage requests in the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page”.	Customer worried about credential misuse wants to see what used passkeys recently

	Shows the number of requests. Expandable row. When expanded, each log entry shows the app and the date and time it accessed	
Allow passkey autofill (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Passkey autofill access**	Key icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps can enumerate passkeys when this is on”. Toggle, On	Customer wants to control which apps can list their passkeys
▸ **Let apps autofill passkeys**	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can enumerate passkeys”. Expandable row. An app in this list can show an expand arrow in place of a toggle, for example Quick Assist	Customer wants to choose which apps can autofill passkeys
▸ **Recent activity**	Clock icon. Subtext: “Review passkey enumeration in the last 7 days. The most recent access data is also captured in other sections in this page”.	Customer wants to audit passkey lookups

	Shows the number of requests. Expandable row, with its own log of entries (app, date and time)	
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: The page has two separate sections, one for creating and using passkeys and one for autofill. Each has its own master toggle, app list and Recent activity log.

Foreground Text Access

Navigation path: Settings → Privacy & security → Foreground text access

Item	Description	Scenario
Foreground text access	Laptop icon. Subtext: “Anyone using this device can choose if their apps can modify text in focusing text box when this is on”. Toggle, On	An administrator wants no app on a shared PC to be able to change what users type, so the tech turns this Off for every account
Let apps access to	List icon. Subtext: “Choose which apps can	Text in a customer’s form

modify text in focusing text box	modify text in focusing text box”. Toggle, On. Apps that request this permission are listed under it; none were listed on the test PC	changes as they type, and the tech checks this page to see which apps are allowed to rewrite text
Privacy resources	Links: “About these settings and your privacy” | “Privacy dashboard” | “Privacy Statement”	Customer wants to read how their data is used or open the privacy dashboard

Tech tip: This page was not covered in the 25H2 captures of this guide. It controls which apps can change the text in the box you are typing in, such as AI writing or autocorrect tools. Like the other App permissions pages, the top toggle is the device-wide switch and the second toggle applies to the signed-in user. If a writing assistant will not insert its suggestions, check both toggles here first. On the test PC no apps were listed under the second toggle, which means no app had asked for this permission yet.

SECTION 10 OF 12



System

57 Settings screens · pages 302–446

- Display
- Sound
- Notifications
- Focus
- Power
- Power & Battery (Laptop)
- Storage
- Share
- Multitasking
- Advanced
- Activation
- Troubleshoot
- Recovery
- Projecting to This PC
- Remote Desktop
- Clipboard
- System Components
- AI Components
- Optional Features
- About

System

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

System Overview

Navigation path: Settings → System

Item	Description	Scenario
Device name	"[device name]" — Rename link	Customer's PC needs a clear name on the network, such as "Smith-Front-Desk"
System Product Name	"System Product Name" — placeholder text	Tech sees the generic placeholder on a custom-built desktop; on a prebuilt PC or laptop it shows the real model for driver and warranty lookups
Microsoft 365	"View benefits" link	Customer asks whether their Office subscription is still active
OneDrive	"Back up files" link, red	Tech checks

	dot	whether Desktop, Documents, and Pictures are backed up before a repair or reset
Windows Update	"Last checked: 44 minutes ago" link	Tech confirms updates are running before starting a diagnosis
Display	"Monitors, brightness, night light, display profile" — arrow	Customer's screen is blurry, too small, or on the wrong monitor
Sound	"Volume levels, output, input, sound devices" — arrow	Customer has no audio, the wrong output device, or a mic that isn't working
Notifications	"Alerts from apps and system, do not disturb" — arrow	Customer is flooded with pop-ups, or misses alerts
Focus	"Reduce distractions" — arrow	Customer wants a distraction-free block of time
Power	"Screen and sleep,	Customer's PC

	power mode, energy saver" — arrow	sleeps too soon, never sleeps, or shuts down unexpectedly
Storage	"Storage space, drives, configuration rules" — arrow	Customer's drive is nearly full
Share	"Share files, photos, links and more" — arrow	Customer wants to send files to a nearby PC
Multitasking	"Snap windows, desktops, task switching" — arrow	Customer's windows snap in ways they don't want
Advanced	"Performance, optimization, and developer features" — arrow	Tech enables Developer Mode or changes the default terminal
Activation	"Activation state, subscriptions, product key" — arrow	Customer's PC shows "not activated" after a motherboard swap
Troubleshoot	"Recommended troubleshooters, preferences, history" — arrow	Tech runs a built-in fix before digging deeper
Recovery	"Reset, advanced startup, go back" — arrow	Customer's PC won't boot properly and

		needs a reset or a rollback
Projecting to this PC	"Permissions, pairing PIN, discoverability" — arrow	Customer wants to use this PC as a wireless display for a phone or laptop
Remote Desktop	"Remote Desktop users, connection permissions" — arrow	Customer wants to reach this PC from another location
Clipboard	"Cut and copy history, sync, clear" — arrow	Customer wants Win+V history, or needs it cleared on a shared PC
System components	"Manage system components that are preinstalled on Windows" — arrow	Tech checks or repairs a built-in Windows component
AI components	"View and uninstall AI components that are installed on your PC" — arrow	Customer wants to see which AI features are installed, or remove them to free space
Optional features	"Extra functionality for your device" — arrow	Tech adds a feature such as OpenSSH, or removes one the customer doesn't

		use
About	Last page in the list	Tech checks the PC's specifications and Windows version

Tech tip: The "System Product Name" placeholder on a custom-built desktop comes from the motherboard firmware, and Rename changes only the PC name, not that line — worth knowing when a customer's build shows no model number and you need another way to identify the machine for drivers.

Display

Navigation path: Settings → System → Display

Item	Description	Scenario
Brightness & color (section header)	Section header	—
Night light	Toggle, Off. "Use warmer colors to help block blue light" — arrow opens the Night light page	Customer works late and gets eye strain from a bright screen in the evening
Color profile	"Determine how colors appear on your screen" — arrow opens the Color management page	Customer's colors look washed out after a driver or monitor change, or a designer

		needs a specific profile
HDR	"More about HDR" link — arrow opens the HDR page	Customer's HDR video looks washed out, or HDR is on for a monitor that doesn't handle it well
Scale & layout (section header)	Section header	—
Scale	Dropdown, "125%". "Change the size of text, apps, and other items". Options: 100% (Recommended), 125%, 150%, 175%. Arrow opens the Custom scaling page	Customer can't read small text on a high-resolution screen
Display resolution	Dropdown, "1920 × 1080 (Recommended)". "Adjust the resolution to fit your connected display". 13 options, from 1920 × 1080 down to 1280 × 720; the list depends on the monitor and driver	Customer's screen looks stretched or blurry after a driver reinstall — needs the recommended resolution back
Display orientation	Dropdown, "Landscape". Options: Landscape,	Customer's screen appears

	Portrait, Landscape (flipped), Portrait (flipped)	sideways or upside down, or they just mounted a monitor in portrait
Multiple displays	Expandable section — "Choose the presentation mode for your displays". The presentation mode options are not visible on this single-monitor PC	Customer adds a second monitor or a projector
▸ **Remember window locations based on monitor connection**	Checkbox, checked	Customer docks and undocks a laptop and wants windows to return to the external monitor
▸ **Minimize windows when a monitor is disconnected**	Checkbox, checked	Customer unplugs a monitor and doesn't want every window piled onto the laptop screen
▸ **Detect other display**	Detect button	Customer's second monitor is plugged in but isn't showing up

▶ **Connect to a wireless display**	Connect button	Customer wants to cast to a smart TV or wireless adapter without a cable
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
Advanced display	"Display information, refresh rate" — arrow	Tech checks the monitor details and refresh rate
Graphics	Arrow (no description text)	Customer's game runs on the wrong GPU
Screen tint	"Add a subtle color overlay to make your screen more comfortable to view" — arrow opens the Screen tint page under Accessibility	Customer finds the screen harsh and Night light isn't enough
Position of on-screen indicators	"Volume, brightness and other controls will appear in this location" — arrow opens the Notifications page	Customer's volume popup covers something on screen
Related support (section header)	Section header	—

▶ **Help with Display**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▹ **Adjusting display brightness settings easily**	Link	Customer can't find the brightness control, or it's missing on a desktop monitor
▹ **Syncing refresh rates for smooth playback**	Link	Customer sees choppy video or motion
▹ **Setting up dual monitors easily**	Link	Tech walks a customer through adding a second screen
▹ **Setting up multiple monitors**	Link	Customer has three or more screens, or a second screen that isn't detected

Tech tip: Two of the Related settings links (Screen tint and Position of on-screen indicators) lead to pages that live under Accessibility and Notifications, and the Color profile row opens a page titled Color management — worth knowing when a customer asks where one of these settings is hiding.

Display → Night Light

Navigation path: Settings → System → Display → Night light

Item	Description	Scenario
Show warmer colors on your display to help you sleep	Button, "Turn on now" (reads "Turn off now" when Night light is on)	Customer wants the warm tint on for the evening, or off quickly for color-accurate work
Status line	"Off until sunset (7:08 PM)" — appears when a schedule is on	Tech confirms the schedule is working
Strength	Slider (no numeric value shown)	Customer finds the default too orange or too faint
Schedule night light	Toggle, Off — expandable	Customer wants Night light to start and stop on its own
▸ **Sunset to sunrise**	Radio button, selected. Shows the times, for example "(7:08 PM – 7:28 AM)"	Customer wants a set-it-and-forget-it schedule that follows the seasons
▸ **Set hours**	Radio button	Customer wants the tint at the same time every

		night
▶ **Turn on**	Time picker, "9:00 PM" (hour, minute, and AM/PM boxes)	Customer picks the evening start time
▶ **Turn off**	Time picker, "7:00 AM"	Customer picks the morning end time
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help from the web**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▷ **Adjusting display brightness automatically**	Link	Customer's brightness keeps changing on its own
▷ **Scheduling night light for better sleep**	Link	Customer wants help setting up the schedule

Tech tip: Night light only shifts the screen's color warmer; it doesn't change brightness — worth knowing when a customer says the screen is still too bright at night and the real fix is the brightness control.

Display → Color Management

Navigation path: Settings → System → Display → Color profile (page title: Color management)

Item	Description	Scenario
Select a display to change its settings	Dropdown, "Display 1: S271HL" — "More about color management" link	Customer has several monitors and needs the right one picked
Color profiles (section header)	Section header	—
Add color profile	"Add profile" dropdown button. "Associate a color profile with the selected display". Options: Add as SDR Profile, Add as HDR Profile — each opens a file-browse window that starts in the Downloads folder	Designer has a profile file from their monitor maker or calibration tool
Filter by	Dropdown, "All Profiles". Options: All Profiles, HDR Profiles, SDR Profiles	Tech narrows a long profile list
Sort by	Dropdown, "Name". Options: Name, HDR Profiles, SDR Profiles, Publisher	Tech finds a profile by name or by who supplied it
Profile list	"No profile found."	Tech confirms

		the monitor has no custom profile attached
Color calibration (section header)	Section header	—
Display color calibration	"Calibrate display color, brightness, and contrast" — Calibrate display button opens the Display Color Calibration wizard in its own window (welcome screen with a "How do I calibrate my display?" link, Next and Cancel buttons)	Customer's colors look off after a monitor swap and they need a better match for photo or video work

Tech tip: The Display Color Calibration wizard opens in its own window and calibrates whichever monitor it is on — on a multi-monitor PC, drag it onto the right screen before clicking Next, as the welcome screen says.

Display → HDR

Navigation path: Settings → System → Display → HDR

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Get a brighter and more vibrant picture for high dynamic range (HDR) games, videos, and	Customer expects HDR from a monitor that can't do it

	apps. This depends on your PC and display." — "More about HDR" link	
Preview video	Play button, seek slider, expand button. "The preview shows what video will look like with your current settings. Move this window to the display you're adjusting to get an accurate preview."	Tech compares how video looks before and after a change
Select a display to view or change its settings	Dropdown, "Display 1: S271HL"	Customer has several monitors and needs the right one
Display capabilities	Expandable section (currently expanded). Extra HDR controls are expected on a supported display; not visible on this PC	Tech checks whether the monitor reports HDR support
▶ **HDR video streaming, games, apps and more**	"Not supported" — status line, not a control	Tech explains to the customer why HDR options are missing
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—

Video playback	"Video adjustments, HDR streaming, battery options" — arrow opens the Video playback page (documented under Apps)	Customer's video looks wrong, or video playback drains a laptop battery

Tech tip: The "HDR video streaming, games, apps and more" line is a status, not a switch — when it reads "Not supported", check that line first when a customer asks where the HDR option went.

Display → Custom Scaling

Navigation path: Settings → System → Display → Scale (arrow) → Custom scaling

Item	Description	Scenario
Warning banner	"You shouldn't change these settings unless you need to—it can cause text and apps to become unreadable. All your displays will be set to the custom scaling size you enter and it can be difficult to go back to your original settings."	Tech warns a customer who wants to "just try a number"
Custom scaling	Text box, placeholder "100 - 500". "Enter a custom scaling size between 100% - 500% (not recommended)"	Customer finds none of the preset sizes comfortable

▶ **Checkmark button**	Applies the typed value; grayed out until a value is entered	Customer confirms a custom value after typing it
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
Text size	Arrow (no description text)	Customer wants bigger text without scaling everything
Advanced display	"Display information, refresh rate" — arrow	Tech checks the monitor details and refresh rate
Graphics	Arrow (no description text)	Customer's game runs on the wrong GPU

Tech tip: A custom value applies to every connected display, and the page's own warning says it can be hard to undo — worth knowing before a customer types a number to fix one small screen; the preset Scale dropdown is the safer first choice.

Display → Advanced Display

Navigation path: Settings → System → Display → Advanced display

Item	Description	Scenario
Select a	Dropdown, "Display 1:	Customer has

display to view or change its settings	S271HL"	several monitors and needs the right one
Display information	Expandable section (currently expanded). Header: "S271HL" — "Display 1: Connected to NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5060"	Tech confirms which monitor is connected to which GPU
▸ **Desktop mode**	"1920 × 1080, 60 Hz" — read-only	Tech confirms the resolution and refresh rate Windows is drawing at
▸ **Active signal mode**	"1920 × 1080, 60 Hz" — read-only	Tech spots a mismatch when the cable or monitor limits the signal
▸ **Variable refresh rate**	"Not Supported"	Tech explains why adaptive sync options are missing
▸ **Bit depth**	"8-bit"	Tech checks color depth when troubleshooting banding
▸ **Color format**	"RGB"	Tech diagnoses odd colors, since some

		connections use other formats
▸ **Color space**	"Standard dynamic range (SDR)"	Tech confirms HDR is off
▸ **Display adapter properties for Display 1**	Link — opens a separate classic Windows window with an Adapter tab (graphics adapter model, memory, firmware version) and a Monitor tab	Tech looks up the GPU model or memory for driver, warranty, or game requirements
Choose a refresh rate	Dropdown, "60 Hz". "A higher rate gives smoother motion, but also uses more power" — "More about refresh rate" link. Options: 60 Hz, plus four rates marked with an asterisk (75.03, 72.19, 70.07, 56.25 Hz) that are not the display's native rate	Customer sees choppy motion, or a monitor stuck at 60 Hz
▸ **Dynamic refresh rate**	Toggle, Off (grayed out). "To help save power, Windows adjusts the refresh rate up to the selected rate above". Message: "Dynamic refresh rate isn't supported" — "More about dynamic refresh	Laptop customer wants better battery life; not available on this desktop monitor

rate" link

Tech tip: Desktop mode and Active signal mode can differ when a cable or monitor limits the signal, and refresh rates marked with an asterisk are not the monitor's native rate — worth knowing when a customer picks one and the picture looks wrong; go back to the rate without the asterisk.

Display → Graphics

Navigation path: Settings → System → Display → Graphics

Item	Description	Scenario
Default settings	Section header. Banner: "You'll need to restart your app or game to see your changes."	Customer changes a setting and sees no effect in a game that's already running
Optimizations for windowed games	Toggle, On. "Reduce latency and use advanced features in compatible games by using flip presentation model." — "More about optimizations for windowed games" link	Customer's game feels laggy in windowed or borderless mode
Advanced graphics settings	Expandable section (currently expanded)	Tech reaches the GPU scheduling option
▸ **Hardware-accelerated**	Toggle, On	Tech tries this toggle when

GPU scheduling		troubleshooting stutter or driver problems
Custom settings for applications	Section header. Banner: "Custom settings only apply when apps support the feature."	Explains why a custom setting seems to have no effect
Search this list	Search box	Tech finds one app in a long list
Filter by	Dropdown, "All apps". Options: All apps, Apps I configured, Apps added for me	Tech reviews the customer's own custom choices
Add an app	Add desktop app button and Add Microsoft Store app button	Customer's app isn't in the list
App list	Expandable rows, one per app. Desktop apps show a file path (for example "ASUS NodeJS Web Framework" — C:\Program Files (x86)\ASUS\ArmouryDevice\asus_framework.exe); Store apps show the publisher (for example "Camera" — Microsoft Corporation). The list depends on what's installed	Tech picks the app that's misbehaving

▶ **GPU preference**	Dropdown, "Let Windows decide (Power saving)". Options: Let Windows decide (Power saving), Power Saving, High Performance, each with the adapter name in brackets (here "NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5060")	Customer's game runs slowly because it's on the wrong GPU
▶ **Optimizations for windowed games**	Toggle, On (per app)	One game misbehaves in windowed mode
▶ **Reset to default settings**	Reset button, grayed out until a setting is changed	Tech undoes custom choices for one app

Tech tip: GPU preference only gives a real choice on a PC with more than one graphics processor — on this single-GPU desktop both named options show the same card, so it matters most when a laptop customer's game is running on the wrong GPU.

Sound

Navigation path: Settings → System → Sound

Item	Description	Scenario
Output (section header)	Section header	—

Choose where to play sound	Expandable section (currently expanded). "Apps might have their own settings". Value: "Speakers"	Customer has no sound, or sound from the wrong device such as a monitor or headset
▸ **Speakers**	"Realtek(R) Audio" — "Default device" — arrow opens the Speakers properties page	Tech checks which device is the default
▸ **Pair a new output device**	Add device button	Customer wants to connect Bluetooth speakers or headphones
Volume	Slider, "51"	Customer's sound is too quiet or too loud
Mono audio	Toggle, Off. "Combine left and right audio channels into one"	Customer has hearing loss in one ear, or uses a single earbud
Input (section header)	Section header	—
Choose a device for speaking or recording	Expandable section (currently expanded). "Apps might have their own settings". Value: "Microphone"	Customer's mic isn't picked up in calls
▸ **Microphone**	"Logi C270 HD	Tech checks

	WebCam" — "Default device" — arrow opens the Microphone properties page	which mic is the default
▶ **Pair a new input device**	Add device button	Customer wants to use a Bluetooth headset mic
Volume	Slider, "100"	Customer's mic is too quiet, or distorting because the level is too high
Advanced (section header)	Section header	—
Troubleshoot common sound problems	"Output devices" link and "Input devices" link	Customer has no sound or a mic that isn't picked up, and the tech runs the troubleshooter first
All sound devices	"Turn devices on/off, troubleshoot, other options" — arrow	Customer's device is missing from the lists because it's switched off
Volume mixer	"App volume mix, app input & output devices"	Customer has one app that is

	— arrow	too loud or too quiet
More sound settings	External-link icon — opens the classic Windows Sound window (tabs: Playback, Recording, Sounds, Communications). The Playback tab lists every device with its status (Default Device, Disabled, Disconnected) and has Configure, Set Default, and Properties buttons	Tech needs older sound options, or wants to see every device Windows knows about, including disconnected ones
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
Position of on-screen indicators	"Volume, brightness and other controls will appear in this location" — arrow opens the Notifications page	Customer's volume popup covers something on screen

Tech tip: The legacy "More sound settings" dialog is still where a few things live that never made it into the modern Settings redesign — like the system sound scheme (the classic Windows startup/error/notification sounds) and the Communications tab behavior. Good one to remember for

tech interviews since a lot of newer techs don't know it's still there.

Sound → Speakers Properties

Navigation path: Settings → System → Sound → Properties (opened from the Speakers row)

Item	Description	Scenario
Speakers	"Realtek(R) Audio" — Rename link	Customer has two sets of speakers and needs to tell them apart
Provider, Driver date, Driver version	Read-only values — "Check for driver updates" link	Tech checks for an old driver when audio crackles or goes missing after an update
General (section header)	Section header	—
Audio	"Don't allow" button. "Allow apps and Windows to use this device for audio". Clicking it opens a pop-up: "You're currently using this device, so if you select 'Don't allow' you'll stop hearing	Tech turns off a device that keeps stealing the default output

	audio" with a second Don't allow button	
Output settings (section header)	Section header	—
Format	Test button and dropdown, "24 bit, 192000 Hz (Studio Quality)". Eight options, from "16 bit, 44100 Hz (CD Quality)" to "24 bit, 192000 Hz (Studio Quality)"; the list depends on the hardware and driver	Customer hears crackling or no sound; tech tries a different format
Volume	Slider, "51" — expandable (shows a Left channel slider "51" and a Right channel slider "51")	Customer's left speaker is louder than the right
Advanced settings (section header)	Section header	—
Audio enhancements	Dropdown, "Device Default Effects". "Select an enhancement available for your device". Options: Off, Device Default Effects	Customer's audio sounds muffled or tinny; tech tries Off

Spatial sound	Dropdown, "Off". "Choose an immersive audio experience that simulates a realistic environment (3D Spatial Sound)". Options: Off, Windows Sonic for Headphones — "Get more spatial sound apps from the Microsoft Store" link	Customer wants 3D audio on headphones for games or movies
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help from the web**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▷ **Troubleshooting headphone detection**	Link	Customer plugs in headphones and Windows doesn't notice them
▷ **Adjusting volume balance settings**	Link	Customer hears one side louder than the other
▷ **Adjusting audio output settings**	Link	Tech needs Microsoft's guidance on output options

▹ **Configuring spatial sound**	Link	Customer wants help turning on 3D audio

Tech tip: Don't allow turns the device off after a confirmation pop-up, and a disabled device drops off the main Sound page — worth knowing when a customer says their speakers vanished; check All sound devices, where disabled devices are still listed.

Sound → Microphone Properties

Navigation path: Settings → System → Sound → Properties (opened from the Microphone row)

Item	Description	Scenario
Microphone	"Logi C270 HD WebCam" — Rename link	Customer has two mics and needs to tell them apart
Provider, Driver date, Driver version	Read-only values — "Check for driver updates" link	Tech checks for an old driver when the mic cuts out
General (section header)	Section header	—
Audio	"Don't allow" button. "Allow apps and Windows to use this device for audio"	Tech turns off a mic that keeps taking over as the default input
Input settings	Section header	—

(section header)		
Format	Dropdown, "1 channels, 16 bit, 48000 Hz (DVD Quality)"; options depend on the hardware and driver	Customer's mic sounds distorted, or an app needs a specific format
Input volume	Slider, "100"	Customer's mic is too quiet, or distorting because the level is too high
Microphone test	"Start test" button — expandable. "Start the test, then talk or play audio at a normal level for a few seconds"	Tech confirms the mic works without opening another app
▸ **Test mode for microphone audio processing**	Dropdown, "Default". "Choose different modes to hear how recorded audio will sound"	Tech compares how the mic sounds with and without processing

Tech tip: On this PC the microphone belongs to a Logitech webcam, so it shows up as its own input device — worth knowing when a customer says the webcam works but nobody can hear them; check which input device is the default.

Sound → All Sound Devices

Navigation path: Settings → System → Sound → All sound devices

Item	Description	Scenario
Output devices (section header)	Section header	—
Speakers	"Realtek(R) Audio" — "Default device" — arrow opens the device page	Tech checks or changes a working output device
Realtek Digital Output	"Realtek(R) Audio" — "Disabled" — arrow opens the device page	Customer's digital output is missing from the main Sound page because it's switched off
Input devices (section header)	Section header	—
Microphone	"Logi C270 HD WebCam" — "Default device" — arrow opens the device page	Tech checks or changes a working input device
Stereo Mix	"Realtek(R) Audio" — "Disabled" — arrow opens the device page	Tech needs a disabled input device and finds it here instead of

		on the main Sound page

Tech tip: Disabled devices (Realtek Digital Output and Stereo Mix here) are listed on this page but not on the main Sound page — worth knowing when a customer says a device is missing.

Sound → Volume Mixer

Navigation path: Settings → System → Sound → Volume mixer

Item	Description	Scenario
System (section header)	Section header	—
Volume	Slider, "51"	Customer's overall sound is too quiet or too loud
Output device	Dropdown, "Speakers (Realtek(R) Audio)"	Customer's sound comes from the wrong device
Input device	Dropdown, "Microphone (Logi C270 HD WebCam)"	Apps aren't picking up the mic because the wrong input is the default
Apps (section header)	Section header	—

System sounds	Slider, "100" — expandable	Customer's Windows alert sounds are too loud compared with their music
▸ **Output device**	Dropdown, "Default" (only one entry on this PC)	Customer wants one app's sound sent to a different device
▸ **Input device**	Dropdown, "Default" (only one entry on this PC)	Customer wants one app to use a different mic
Other apps	Each app currently using sound is listed with its own slider and device choices; none were listed on this PC at the time	Customer's video call is too quiet while music is loud
Reset	Button. "Reset sound devices and volumes for all apps to the recommended defaults"	Tech undoes a mess of per-app volume or device choices

Tech tip: Each app's Output and Input device dropdowns follow the system default unless changed here, so one app can play through a different device than everything else — worth checking when only one app has no sound.

Notifications

Navigation path: Settings → System → Notifications

Item	Description	Scenario
Notifications	Toggle, On. "Get notifications from apps and other senders" — expandable	Customer wants all pop-ups off, or none are showing
▸ **Allow notifications to play sounds**	Checkbox, checked	Customer's alerts are too noisy, or missed because the sound is off
▸ **Show notifications on the lock screen**	Checkbox, checked	Customer on a shared or public PC doesn't want message previews visible before sign-in
▸ **Show reminders and incoming VoIP calls on the lock screen**	Checkbox, checked	Customer misses a call or reminder while the PC is locked
▸ **Show notification bell icon**	Checkbox, checked	Customer can't find the notification center, or wants the bell hidden
Do not disturb	Toggle, Off. "Notifications will be sent directly to notification	Customer wants quiet during a presentation or

	center"	call
Turn on do not disturb automatically	Expandable section (collapsed in the main view)	Customer wants quiet time to start without remembering to turn it on
▸ **During these times**	Checkbox, unchecked. Turns on the schedule below	Customer wants quiet hours overnight
▸ **Turn on**	Time picker, "11:00 PM" (grayed out until the checkbox is checked)	Customer picks the evening start time
▸ **Turn off**	Time picker, "7:00 AM" (grayed out until the checkbox is checked)	Customer picks the morning end time
▸ **Repeat**	Dropdown, "Daily" (grayed out until the checkbox is checked)	Customer wants quiet hours on certain days only
▸ **When duplicating your display**	Checkbox, checked. "(priority notification banners are also hidden)"	Customer presents on a projector without private alerts showing
▸ **When playing a game**	Checkbox, checked	Customer's pop-ups interrupt gameplay
▸ **When using an app in full-screen mode**	Checkbox, checked. "(priority notification banners are also	Customer watches full-screen video

	hidden)"	without interruptions
▶ **For the first hour after a Windows feature update**	Checkbox, checked	Customer's PC piles up setup pop-ups after a big update
Set priority notifications	Arrow opens the Set priority notifications page	Customer wants calls or alarms to get through while Do not disturb is on
Focus	"Session duration, hide badges on apps" — arrow opens the Focus page	Customer wants to start a focus session
Notifications from apps and other senders (section header)	Section header	—
Sort by	Dropdown, "Most recent". Options: Most recent, Name	Tech finds an app in a long list
App rows	One row per app (for example Snipping Tool, Outlook, MEGAsync, Bluetooth, Microsoft 365 Copilot): toggle, summary such as	Customer wants to silence one noisy app without turning off everything

	"Banners, Sounds" (or "Off"), and an arrow that opens that app's own page	
Additional settings	Expandable section (collapsed in the main view)	Tech reaches the tips and suggestions options
▸ **Suggest ways to get the most out of Windows and finish setting up this device**	Checkbox, checked	Customer keeps getting "finish setting up your PC" prompts
▸ **Get tips and suggestions when using Windows**	Checkbox, unchecked	Tech turns this off on a customer's PC to cut distracting tips
Indicators from keyboard actions (section header)	Section header	—
Position of on-screen indicators	Dropdown, "Bottom center". "Volume, brightness and other controls will appear in this location". Options:	Customer's volume and brightness popups cover something on

	Bottom center, Top left, Top center	screen

Tech tip: There are three places to silence notifications — the master Notifications toggle, Do not disturb, and each app's own page — so check all three when a customer says an app never alerts them; an app that is switched off shows "Off" under its name in the list.

Notifications → Set Priority Notifications

Navigation path: Settings → System → Notifications → Set priority notifications

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Choose which notifications are allowed while do not disturb is on, all others will remain in notification center. Alarms and important app notifications aren't affected by these settings."	Tech sets a customer's expectations before building an exception list
Calls and reminders	Expandable section (currently expanded)	—
▸ **Show incoming calls, including VoIP**	Checkbox, checked	Customer doesn't want to miss a call during quiet hours
▸ **Show**	Checkbox, checked	Customer

reminders, regardless of app used		doesn't want to miss a calendar or task reminder
Apps	Expandable section (currently expanded). "Show all notifications from selected apps" — Add apps button	Customer wants one messaging app to get through while everything else stays quiet
▸ **App list**	Clock, Game Bar, Nearby sharing, Snipping Tool — each with a "..." menu	Tech reviews which apps are exempt

Tech tip: The page itself says alarms and important app notifications aren't affected by these settings — worth knowing when a customer asks why an alert still showed up while Do not disturb was on.

Notifications → App Page (Outlook as the Example)

Navigation path: Settings → System → Notifications → [app name]

Item	Description	Scenario
Notifications	Toggle, On	Customer wants one noisy app silenced without touching any other
Preview pictures	Two illustrations: a banner at the bottom right of the screen, and	Tech shows a customer what each checkbox

	the notification center	controls
Show notification banners	Checkbox, checked	Customer finds this app's pop-ups distracting but wants to keep the notifications
Show notifications in notification center	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants to review missed notifications later
Hide content when notifications are on lock screen	Toggle, On	Customer on a shared PC doesn't want message text visible on the lock screen
Play a sound when a notification arrives	Toggle, On	Customer wants to silence one app's chime without muting everything
Priority of notifications in notification center	Radio buttons: Top ("Show at the top of notification center"), High ("Show above normal priority notifications in notification center"), Normal ("Show below high priority notifications	Customer never wants to miss messages from one app

	in notification center") — Normal is selected	

Tech tip: Banners, the notification center, lock screen content, and sound are separate controls for each app, so "no pop-up" doesn't mean the notification was lost — it may still be waiting in the notification center.

Focus

Navigation path: Settings → System → Focus

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Focus sessions help you get more done by reducing distractions. When you start a session, these settings will apply for a set amount of time."	Tech sets a customer's expectations before they start a session
Focus	Expandable section (currently expanded) — "Start focus session" button	Customer wants a distraction-free block of time for work or study
▸ **Session duration**	Minus and plus buttons, "30 mins"	Customer wants a shorter or longer session
▸ **Show the timer in the Clock app**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants to see the time left in a session
▸ **Hide badges**	Checkbox, checked	Customer's

on taskbar apps		taskbar badges pull attention away
▸ **Hide flashing on taskbar apps**	Checkbox, checked	Customer's apps flash orange on the taskbar to get noticed
▸ **Turn on do not disturb**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants notification pop-ups silenced while working
More about focus	External-link icon — opens Microsoft's help page	Tech looks up Microsoft's guidance on Focus
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
Notifications	"Alerts from apps and system, do not disturb" — arrow opens the Notifications page	Customer wants to change what can interrupt a session

Tech tip: Focus has its own Turn on do not disturb checkbox, so Focus and Do not disturb are linked but set in two places — worth knowing when a customer asks why their notifications suddenly went quiet.

Power

Navigation path: Settings → System → Power

Item	Description	Scenario
Energy recommendations	"Lower your carbon footprint by applying these recommendations" — progress bar "1 of 4" — arrow opens the Energy recommendations page	Tech checks quickly whether a PC is set up to save power
Power Mode	Expandable section (currently expanded). "Optimize your device based on power use and performance". Value: "Best Performance"	Customer's PC feels slow, or they want lower power use
▸ **Plugged in**	Dropdown, "Best Performance". Options: Best Power Efficiency, Balanced, Best Performance	Tech finds the PC set to a lower power mode
Screen, sleep, & hibernate timeouts	Expandable section (currently expanded). "Choose what happens when your device is idle for a specified time"	Customer's PC sleeps too soon or never sleeps
▸ **Turn my screen off after**	Dropdown, "Never". "Turn off the screen after 5 minutes to save energy. Higher settings	Customer's screen stays on all day, or goes dark too soon

	use more energy"	
▸ **Make my device sleep after**	Dropdown, "Never". "Turn on sleep after 15 minutes to save energy. Higher settings use more energy"	Customer's PC never sleeps, or sleeps in the middle of a download
▸ **Make my device hibernate after**	Dropdown, "Never"	Customer leaves the PC on for long stretches and wants to save power
▸ **Banner**	"Screen and sleep settings don't apply when the lock screen slideshow is playing." — "Change slideshow settings" link	Customer's screen won't turn off despite the timeouts
▸ **Related links**	"Choosing energy efficient sleep settings" link	Tech looks up Microsoft's sleep setting guidance
Energy saver	Expandable section (currently expanded). "Reduce power consumption and increase battery life by limiting some background activities". Value: "Off"	Laptop customer wants longer battery life
▸ **Always use energy saver**	Toggle, Off	Customer wants lower power use

		even on mains power
Power & sleep button controls	Expandable section (collapsed in the main view). "Choose what happens when you interact with your device's physical controls"	Customer's power button does the wrong thing
▸ **Pressing the power button will make my PC**	Dropdown, "Shutdown" (Plugged in). Options: Do Nothing, Sleep, Hibernate, Shutdown, Display Off	Customer wants the power button to sleep the PC instead of shutting it down
▸ **Pressing the sleep button will make my PC**	Dropdown, "Sleep" (Plugged in). Same five options	Customer's keyboard sleep key does the wrong thing

Tech tip: The screen, sleep, and hibernate timeouts are all set to Never on this desktop, and a lock screen slideshow overrides the screen and sleep timeouts (the page's own banner says so) — worth knowing when a customer says their PC never sleeps or the screen never turns off.

Power → Energy Recommendations

Navigation path: Settings → System → Power → Energy recommendations

Item	Description	Scenario
Header	"Great start—keep	Tech sees at a

	going!" with a green leaf icon. "Apply energy saving recommendations to lower your carbon footprint" — "Learn more" link	glance how many recommendation s are applied
Apply all	Button	Customer wants the PC set up for lower power use in one click
Set the power mode for best energy efficiency	Apply button, warning icon	Customer wants lower power use
Put my device to sleep after 10 minutes	Apply button, warning icon. "When you apply this change, we'll also update the timeout setting for your screen"	Customer's PC never sleeps
Turn off my screen after 3 minutes	Apply button, warning icon	Customer's screen stays on all day
Turn off my screen saver	Green check mark, already applied — arrow opens the Lock screen page (documented under Personalization)	Tech confirms a screen saver isn't wasting power

Tech tip: Apply all changes the power settings for the whole PC — on this PC it would start putting the device to sleep after 10 minutes and turning the screen off after 3 — worth

knowing before applying it on a PC that runs long downloads or serves files.

Power & Battery (Laptop)

Navigation path: Settings → System → Power & battery

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 25H2, OS build 26200.8973 (laptop)

Item	Description	Scenario
Battery level	Large battery percentage with a battery icon, for example “61%”. Below it: “Estimated time remaining:” with hours and minutes	Customer asks how long the battery will last before they need to plug in
Energy recommendations	Leaf icon. Subtext: “Lower your carbon footprint by applying these recommendations”. Progress bar with how many recommendations are applied, for example “3 of 8”. Opens the Energy recommendations page (documented below)	Customer wants their laptop to use less power without working through every setting
Energy saver notice	Info icon. “Power mode cannot be set when energy saver is on.” Shown only while Energy	Customer cannot change Power Mode because the dropdowns

	saver is on	are grayed out
Power Mode	Subtext: “Optimize your device based on power use and performance”. Shows the current mode, for example “Best Power Efficiency”. Expandable row	Customer’s laptop feels slow on battery
▶ **Plugged in**	Dropdown, “Best Performance”. Choices: Best Power Efficiency, Balanced, Best Performance. Grayed out while Energy saver is on	Customer wants full speed while charging
▶ **On battery**	Dropdown, “Best Power Efficiency”. Same three choices. Grayed out while Energy saver is on	Customer wants a longer battery life when unplugged
Screen, sleep, & hibernate timeouts	Subtext: “Choose what happens when your device is idle for a specified time”. Expandable row	Customer’s screen goes dark too quickly while they read
▶ **Plugged in (section header)**	Section header	—
▷ **Turn my screen off after**	Dropdown, “5 minutes (Recommended)”	Customer wants the screen to stay on longer at their desk

▹ **Make my device sleep after**	Dropdown, “5 minutes (Recommended)”	A long download stops because the laptop goes to sleep
▶ **On battery (section header)**	Section header	—
▹ **Turn my screen off after**	Dropdown, “3 minutes (Recommended)”	Customer wants to save battery by turning the screen off sooner
▹ **Make my device sleep after**	Dropdown, “3 minutes (Recommended)”	Customer wants the laptop to sleep sooner when left unplugged
Battery percentage	Subtext: “Display battery percentage on taskbar”. Toggle, On	Customer wants the exact battery number next to the taskbar icon
Energy saver	Subtext: “Reduce power consumption and increase battery life by limiting some background activities”. Status shows “On” or the turn-on level, for example “Turns on at 30%”. Expandable row	Customer’s battery runs down too fast on a long day away from a charger

▶ **Always use energy saver**	Toggle. Off by default; when On, Energy saver stays on even when plugged in	Customer wants Energy saver on all the time
▶ **Turn energy saver on automatically when battery level is at**	Dropdown, “30%”. Shown only while Always use energy saver is Off	Customer wants Energy saver to start earlier, at a higher battery level
▶ **Lower screen brightness when using energy saver**	Toggle	Customer complains the screen dims on its own when the battery gets low
Battery usage	Expandable row	Customer wants to know what is draining the battery
▶ **Battery levels**	Time period dropdown, “Last 24 hours”. Chart of battery level over time with 100% and 50% lines and a marker where Energy saver turned on. Below it, Screen on, Screen off and Sleep totals	Tech checks how fast the battery drops over a normal day
▶ **Battery usage per app**	Search box and Sort by dropdown, “Overall usage” (choices: Overall	Tech finds one app using a large share of the

	usage, In use, Background, Name). A count of apps found, then one row per app with its In use and Background share and time, its total percentage and a “…” button. Shows “No apps used battery during this time period.” when nothing ran on battery	battery in the background
Lid, power & sleep button controls	Subtext: “Choose what happens when you interact with your device’s physical controls”. Expandable row	Customer’s laptop does the wrong thing when they close the lid
▶ **Plugged in (section header)**	Section header	—
▷ **Pressing the power button will make my PC**	Dropdown, “Shutdown”. Choices: Do Nothing, Sleep, Hibernate, Shutdown	Customer wants the power button to put the laptop to sleep instead of shutting it down
▷ **Pressing the sleep button will make my PC**	Dropdown, “Sleep”. Choices: Do Nothing, Sleep, Hibernate, Shutdown	Customer wants the sleep key to hibernate instead

▹ **Closing the lid will make my PC**	Dropdown, “Sleep”. Choices: Do Nothing, Sleep, Hibernate, Shutdown	Customer uses an external monitor and wants the laptop to keep running with the lid closed
▶ **On battery (section header)**	Section header	—
▹ **Pressing the power button will make my PC**	Dropdown, “Sleep”. Choices: Do Nothing, Sleep, Hibernate, Shutdown	Customer wants the power button to behave the same on battery
▹ **Pressing the sleep button will make my PC**	Dropdown, “Sleep”. Choices: Do Nothing, Sleep, Hibernate, Shutdown	Customer wants to save more battery by hibernating instead
▹ **Closing the lid will make my PC**	Dropdown, “Shutdown”. Choices: Do Nothing, Sleep, Hibernate, Shutdown	Customer loses unsaved work because the laptop shuts down when they close the lid
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with**	Expandable row,	Customer wants

Power	expanded. Four links: “Extending your battery life effectively”, “Shortening display turn-off duration”, “Adjusting power and sleep settings”, “Lock your Windows PC automatically”	tips on making the battery last longer

Tech tip: This page appears only on a PC with a battery; a desktop shows the simpler Power page instead. Power Mode cannot be changed while Energy saver is on, so turn Energy saver off first. If a laptop shuts down or sleeps when the lid closes, check Lid, power & sleep button controls before anything else. Settings does not show battery health; to check wear, run powercfg /batteryreport in Command Prompt and open the report it saves. Hovering over the battery icon on the taskbar shows the charge, whether it is plugged in, and whether Energy saver is on.

Power & Battery (Laptop) → Energy Recommendations

Navigation path: Settings → System → Power & battery → Energy recommendations

Item	Description	Scenario
Page header	Leaf icon that fills as more recommendations are applied. Status message, for example “Great start—keep going!”, then “Apply	Customer wants every power-saving change made in one click

	energy saving recommendations to lower your carbon footprint". Learn more link. Apply all button	
Recommendation rows (section header)	Eight recommendations. Each row shows whether it is applied; the count on the Power & battery page (for example "4 of 8") comes from this list	—
▸ **Set the power mode for best energy efficiency**	Green check mark. Already applied. Arrow opens the related setting	Tech confirms the laptop is set to save power on battery
▸ **Turn on Dark Mode**	Exclamation icon. Not yet applied. Apply button	Customer wants a little more battery life and does not mind a dark theme
▸ **Set the screen brightness for best energy efficiency**	Green check mark. Already applied. Arrow opens the related setting	Customer asks why the screen is dimmer than before
▸ **Put my device to sleep after 3**	Exclamation icon. Not yet applied. Apply button. Subtext: "When you	Customer wants the laptop to sleep quickly

minutes	apply this change, we'll also update the timeout setting for your screen"	when left alone
▸ **Turn off my screen after 3 minutes**	Exclamation icon. Not yet applied. Apply button	Customer wants the screen to turn off sooner to save battery
▸ **Save power by optimizing screen contrast and brightness for the content shown**	Exclamation icon. Not yet applied. Apply button	Customer notices the brightness changing with what is on screen after applying this
▸ **Turn off my screen saver**	Green check mark. Already applied. Arrow opens the related setting	Tech confirms a screen saver is not keeping the display awake
▸ **Stop USB devices when my screen is off to help save battery**	Green check mark. Already applied. Arrow opens the related setting	A USB device disconnects while the screen is off, and the tech traces it to this recommendation

Tech tip: Apply all changes several settings at once, including sleep and screen timeouts and Dark Mode. Before using it on a customer's laptop, check that they are happy with a 3-minute sleep, since that is a common cause of "my

laptop keeps going to sleep" complaints. Each applied recommendation can still be changed on its own settings page.

Storage

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage

Item	Description	Scenario
Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB	Heading with a usage bar — "423 GB used", "506 GB free"	Customer's drive is nearly full; tech sees the used and free space at a glance
Other	"153 GB/423 GB used" with a usage bar — arrow opens its category page	Tech finds a large share of the drive in a category the customer didn't expect
Documents	"150 GB/423 GB used" with a usage bar — arrow opens its category page	Customer's drive is full of their own files, not Windows
Installed apps	"52.8 GB/423 GB used" with a usage bar — arrow opens the Installed apps page under Apps (documented in the Apps section)	Customer wants to know which programs take up the most room

Temporary files	"18.6 GB/423 GB used" with a usage bar — arrow opens its category page	Tech clears out space quickly without touching the customer's files
Pictures	"4.86 GB/423 GB used" with a usage bar — arrow opens its category page	Customer's photo library is eating the drive
Show more categories	Link — opens the Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB page with the full category list	Tech expands the list to see the smaller categories
Storage management (section header)	Section header	—
Storage Sense	Toggle, On. "Automatically free up space, delete temporary files, and manage locally available cloud content" — arrow opens the Storage Sense page	Customer wants Windows to clean up on its own
Cleanup recommendations	"Over 5.00 GB of storage available for cleanup" — arrow opens the Cleanup recommendations page	Tech sees how much Windows thinks can be safely cleared
Advanced storage	Expandable section (currently expanded).	Tech reaches the drive-level tools

settings	"Backup options, Storage Spaces, other disks and volumes"	
▸ **Storage used on other drives**	Arrow opens its own page	Customer has a second drive and wants to see what's filling it
▸ **Where new content is saved**	Arrow opens its own page	Customer wants new downloads, documents, or apps saved to a different drive
▸ **Storage Spaces**	Arrow opens its own page	Customer wants to pool several drives into one
▸ **Disks & volumes**	Arrow opens its own page	Tech needs to see the PC's drives and partitions
▸ **Backup options**	Arrow opens the Windows backup page under Accounts	Customer wants to back up their files
▸ **Drive optimization**	External-link icon — opens a separate window outside Settings	Tech optimizes a hard drive, or checks that a drive is being maintained
Related support (section	Section header	—

header)		
▶ **Help with Storage**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▷ **Emptying recycle bin in windows**	Link	Customer deleted files and the space didn't come back
▷ **Fixing low disk space**	Link	Customer's drive is nearly full
▷ **Check storage on pc**	Link	Customer wants to see where their space went
▷ **Using disk cleanup**	Link	Tech looks up Microsoft's guidance on the Disk Cleanup tool

Tech tip: The main page shows only some categories, and several rows lead to pages that live elsewhere in Settings, such as Installed apps (Apps) and View update settings (Windows Update) — worth knowing when a customer asks where a Storage setting went. System & reserved, for example, appears only after Show more categories.

Storage → Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Show more categories (page title: Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB)

Item	Description	Scenario

Storage usage	Section header. Usage bar with "423 GB used" and "506 GB free". "This is how your storage is used and how you can free up space."	Customer's drive is nearly full; tech sees the used and free space again before digging in
Other	"153 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage other large folders"	Tech finds a big folder the customer didn't expect
Documents	"150 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Documents folder"	Customer's drive is full of their own files, not Windows
Installed apps	"52.8 GB" with a usage bar. "Uninstall unused or undesired apps & features" — opens the Installed apps page under Apps (documented in the Apps section)	Customer wants to remove programs they don't use
System & reserved	"36.4 GB" with a usage bar. "System files help Windows run properly"	Customer asks why 36 GB is gone and they can't delete it
Temporary files	"18.6 GB" with a usage bar. "Choose which temporary files to remove" — opens the Temporary files page	Tech clears out space quickly without touching the customer's files

Pictures	"4.86 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Pictures folder"	Customer's photo library is eating the drive
Desktop	"3.43 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Desktop folder"	Customer saves everything to the desktop and it's getting huge
Videos	"2.81 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Videos folder"	Customer's video files are taking space
Maps	"425 MB" with a usage bar. "Delete offline maps or change their location"	Customer downloaded maps for travel and wants the space back
OneDrive	"46.6 MB" with a usage bar. "Remove unused cloud-backed content"	Customer's OneDrive files are using local space they'd rather free
Music	"0 bytes" with a usage bar. "Manage the Music folder"	Customer's Music folder is empty on this PC
Mail	"0 bytes" with a usage bar. "Manage mail with the default app"	Customer asks how much room their mail takes locally
Other people	"0 bytes" with a usage bar. "Remove unused local accounts"	Tech removes an unused local account that's

		still holding files
Last refreshed	"Last refreshed on 10/11/2026 9:45 PM"	Tech checks whether the numbers on the page are current
Refresh	Button	Customer deleted files and the numbers haven't changed

Tech tip: System & reserved is not among the five categories on the main Storage page, so it only appears here — worth knowing when a customer asks why 36 GB is gone and sees nothing about it on the first page.

Storage → Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB → Temporary Files

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB → Temporary files

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Some temporary files are needed by apps. Below is a list of files you can remove now."	Tech explains to a customer why not everything on the list can be removed
Remove files	Button	Tech clears the checked items to free space
Refresh	Link with a refresh icon	Tech rescans after the customer deleted

		something
Total selected	"46.1 MB" — updates as boxes are checked	Tech sees how much space the current selection frees before clicking Remove files
Cleanup system files	Highlighted button	Tech frees space from system-level files that the list above doesn't offer
Last scanned	"Last scanned at 10/11/2026 9:30 PM"	Tech checks whether the list is current
Downloads	Checkbox, unchecked. "14.0 GB". "Warning: These are files in your personal Downloads folder. Select this if you'd like to delete everything. This does not respect your Storage Sense configuration."	Customer's Downloads folder is huge and they want it emptied
Delivery Optimization Files	Checkbox, unchecked. "264 MB". "Delivery Optimization is used to download updates from Microsoft. These files are stored in a dedicated cache to be uploaded to	Tech needs a bit more room and the customer isn't sharing updates with other PCs

	other devices on your local network (if your settings allow such use). You may safely delete these files if you need the space."	
Recycle Bin	Checkbox, unchecked. "187 MB". "The Recycle Bin contains files you have deleted from your computer. These files are not permanently removed until you empty the Recycle Bin."	Customer deleted files and the space didn't come back
Thumbnails	Checkbox, checked. "24.1 MB". "Windows keeps a copy of all of your picture, video, and document thumbnails so they can be displayed quickly when you open a folder. If you delete these thumbnails, they will be automatically recreated as needed."	Tech clears a safe cache that Windows rebuilds on its own
Temporary Internet Files	Checkbox, checked. "21.8 MB". "The Temporary Internet Files folder contains webpages stored on your hard disk for quick	Tech clears web cache the customer won't miss

	viewing. Your personalized settings for webpages will be left intact."	
Temporary files	Checkbox, checked. "114 KB". "Apps can store temporary information in specific folders. These can be cleaned up manually if the app does not do it automatically."	Tech clears leftover files an app didn't clean up itself
Windows error reports and feedback diagnostics	Checkbox, checked. "72.6 KB". "Diagnostics files generated from Windows errors and user feedback."	Tech clears old error report files
DirectX Shader Cache	Checkbox, checked. "40.0 KB". "Clean up files created by the graphics system which can speed up application load time and improve responsiveness. They will be re-generated as needed."	Tech clears a graphics cache that Windows rebuilds on its own
Updates	Section header. "1.15 GB"	Tech sees how much space is taken by update files
▶ **View update**	Link — opens the Windows Update page	Tech goes to the update settings

settings	(documented under Windows Update)	after seeing how much space update files take

Tech tip: Downloads is the one box to watch. It starts unchecked, and its own warning says that checking it deletes everything in the personal Downloads folder and ignores the Storage Sense settings — worth knowing before a tech clicks Remove files on a customer's PC.

Storage → Storage Sense

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Storage Sense

Item	Description	Scenario
Cleanup of temporary files (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Keep Windows running smoothly**	Checkbox, checked. "Keep Windows running smoothly by automatically cleaning up temporary system and app files"	Tech wants Windows to clear temporary files on its own so they don't pile up
Automatic User content cleanup	Section header — toggle, On. "Storage Sense runs based on the frequency you choose here. We cleaned up 9.75 GB of space in the past month.	Customer wants Windows to clean up on its own, and the tech checks whether it has

	Last run: 10/11/2026 7:25 PM."	been running
Configure cleanup schedules (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Run Storage Sense**	Dropdown, "Every day". The dropdown lists how often cleanup can run	Customer wants cleanup to run more or less often
▸ **Delete files in my recycle bin if they have been there for over:**	Dropdown, "14 days". The dropdown lists the time limits	Customer's Recycle Bin keeps filling and they want old items cleared automatically
▸ **Delete files in my Downloads folder if they haven't been opened for more than:**	Dropdown, "Never (default)". The dropdown lists the time limits	Customer's Downloads folder is huge and they want old files removed automatically
Locally available cloud content	Section header. "Storage Sense can free up space by removing unused cloud-backed content from your device." "Content flagged as	Customer uses OneDrive and wants local space back without losing the cloud copies

	'Always keep on this device' will not be affected."	
▸ **Click here for more information**	Link	Tech opens Microsoft's explanation of what "online-only" means
▸ **[Cloud account name]**	One block per cloud-synced account (two on this PC). "Content will become online-only if not opened for more than:" Dropdown, "Never". The dropdown lists the time limits	Customer wants files they haven't opened to stop using space on this PC
Run Storage Sense now	Button	Tech frees up space right away instead of waiting for the schedule

Tech tip: The Downloads dropdown here is set to "Never (default)", and the Downloads box on the Temporary files page ignores the Storage Sense settings — worth knowing when a customer says Storage Sense never touches their Downloads folder.

Storage → Cleanup Recommendations

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Cleanup recommendations

Item	Description	Scenario
Temporary files	Expandable section (currently expanded)	Tech frees space from safe-to-clear files quickly
▶ **Downloads**	Checkbox, unchecked. "14.0 GB". "Warning: These are files in your personal Downloads folder. Select this if you'd like to delete everything. This does not respect your Storage Sense configuration."	Customer's Downloads folder is huge and they want it emptied
▶ **Recycle Bin**	Checkbox, unchecked. "187 MB". "The Recycle Bin contains files you have deleted from your computer. These files are not permanently removed until you empty the Recycle Bin."	Customer deleted files and the space didn't come back
▶ **Cleanup will also remove system files that are not in use**	Message — "See advanced options" link opens the Temporary files page (documented under Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB)	Tech goes to the fuller cleanup list when the short one isn't enough
▶ **Clean up 0 bytes**	Button, grayed out. Reads "0 bytes" until something is checked	Tech clears the checked items

Large or unused files	Expandable section (currently collapsed in the main view; expands to the rows below)	Customer has big files they haven't opened in a long time
▸ **Older files (0)**	Group heading with a checkbox, unchecked. A "Name" column header sits under it	Tech selects every old file in the group at once
▸ **File rows**	One row per file: a checkbox, the file name, and the folder it's in. The files listed are specific to the PC	Tech reviews which old files are worth deleting before cleaning up
▸ **Recent files (0)**	Group heading with a checkbox, unchecked. Same file-row layout as Older files	Tech reviews files that were opened more recently
▸ **See more files**	Link, under each group	Tech expands the list beyond the first few files
▸ **Clean up 0 bytes**	Button, grayed out, at the bottom of the section	Tech clears the checked files
Files synced to the cloud	Expandable section (currently expanded). "No recommended files to clean."	Customer's synced cloud files are using local space; the section lists files here when there are any
Unused apps	Expandable section	Customer has

	(currently expanded). "No recommended applications to clean."	apps they never open; the section lists them here when there are any

Tech tip: Nothing is removed until a box is checked and Clean up is clicked — the button reads "0 bytes" and stays grayed out until something is selected, which is worth knowing when a customer is nervous about opening this page.

Storage → Storage Used on Other Drives

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Storage used on other drives

Item	Description	Scenario
Local storage (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Local Disk (C:) - 930 GB**	Windows drive icon, usage bar, "435 GB used", "495 GB free"	Tech checks that the Windows drive still has room before installing updates
▸ **New Volume (E:) - 238 GB**	Drive icon, usage bar, "218 GB used", "19.8 GB free". Clicking the row opens that drive's storage usage page (documented next).	Customer's second internal drive is almost full; the tech spots it right away from the

		bar
▸ **USB Drive (D:) - 14.6 GB**	Drive icon, usage bar, "3.80 GB used", "10.8 GB free"	Customer plugged in a flash drive and wants to know how much room is left
▸ **ESD-USB (F:) - 31.9 GB**	Installer-media icon, usage bar, "6.59 GB used", "25.3 GB free"	Tech checks the free space on a bootable USB before adding tools to it

Tech tip: This page lists every connected drive, including USB drives, so it is a quick way to compare used and free space without opening File Explorer. A drive that isn't plugged in won't appear here, which is worth remembering when a customer says a drive is "missing."

Storage → Storage Used on Other Drives → New Volume (E:) - 238 GB

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Storage used on other drives → New Volume (E:) - 238 GB

Item	Description	Scenario
Storage usage	Section header. Usage bar with "218 GB used" and "19.8 GB free". "This is how your storage is used and how you can	Tech sees at a glance that this drive is nearly full

	free up space."	
▸ **Videos**	"157 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Videos folder" — clicking the row opens the Videos folder list (documented next).	Customer's second drive is full of video files, and the tech finds the biggest category
▸ **Other**	"45.4 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage other large folders"	Tech finds space used by folders that don't fit a standard category
▸ **Music**	"8.41 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Music folder"	Customer wants to know whether their music library is the problem
▸ **Pictures**	"5.61 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Pictures folder"	Customer's photo folder is small, so the tech rules it out
▸ **Documents**	"1.23 GB" with a usage bar. "Manage the Documents folder"	Tech confirms the customer's documents take almost no room
▸ **System & reserved**	"479 MB" with a usage bar. "System files help Windows run properly"	Customer asks why a drive with no Windows install still shows system files

▸ **Mail**	"101 MB" with a usage bar. "Manage mail with the default app"	Tech checks whether mail data is stored on this drive
▸ **Temporary files**	"4.00 KB" with a usage bar. "Choose which temporary files to remove"	Tech sees nothing worth cleaning on this drive
▸ **Installed apps**	"0 bytes" with a usage bar. "Uninstall unused or undesired apps & features"	Tech confirms no programs are installed on this drive
▸ **Maps**	"0 bytes" with a usage bar. "Delete offline maps or change their location"	Customer asks whether offline maps are using space on this drive
Last refreshed	Text — "Last refreshed on 10/13/2026 4:36 PM"	Tech checks how current the numbers are before trusting them
▸ **Refresh**	Button	Customer just deleted files and the page still shows the old totals

Tech tip: This is the per-drive version of the Local Disk (C:) page. It lists only the categories that have data on this drive, plus a few that show 0 bytes, so the list differs from C:. The

figures are a snapshot from the last refresh, not live. After a big cleanup, press Refresh before telling a customer the space didn't come back. A secondary drive can be nearly full while C: has plenty of room, so check this page whenever a customer reports "disk full" errors on a second drive.

Storage → Storage Used on Other Drives → New Volume (E:) - 238 GB → Videos

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Storage used on other drives → New Volume (E:) - 238 GB → Videos

Item	Description	Scenario
Folder list	List of folders on this drive that contain video files, largest first. Each row has a video-folder icon, the full folder path, the size, and a usage bar. The top rows show paths such as "E:\[folder name]" with sizes like "5.19 GB", "3.71 GB", and "582 MB". The list continues below with smaller folders.	Customer's drive is full of video; the tech finds the biggest folders without hunting through File Explorer
▶ **Folder row**	Clickable row. Opens File Explorer at that folder and shows its files.	Tech opens the biggest folder to see exactly which files to move, back up, or delete

Tech tip: The list is sorted by folder size and shows full paths, so it often turns up video files in places the customer never thinks of, such as backup or temp folders. Clicking a row jumps straight to the folder in File Explorer, which makes this page a fast way to go from "the drive is full" to the specific files. The sizes can include non-video files in those folders, since a folder is listed because it contains video, not because it's named for it.

Storage → Where New Content Is Saved

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Where new content is saved

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Change where your apps, documents, music, pictures, videos and maps are saved by default."	Tech reads this to confirm the page controls defaults for new files, not files that already exist
New apps will save to:	Dropdown, currently "Local Disk (C:)". The list shows every connected drive, including removable ones, and marks the current choice. Picking a different drive makes an "Apply" button appear to the right of that dropdown. The five dropdowns below work	Customer's C: drive is small and they want new Store apps installed on a bigger drive

	the same way.	
New documents will save to:	Dropdown, currently "Local Disk (C:)"	Customer wants their documents stored on a second drive so a Windows reinstall won't touch them
New music will save to:	Dropdown, currently "Local Disk (C:)"	Customer has a large music library and wants new downloads saved to a drive with more room
New photos and videos will save to:	Dropdown, currently "Local Disk (C:)"	Customer's phone backups and camera imports are filling C:
New movies and TV shows will save to:	Dropdown, currently "Local Disk (C:)"	Customer downloads movies for offline viewing and needs them on a roomier drive
Change where you store your offline maps	Dropdown, currently "Local Disk (C:)"	Customer downloads big offline map files and wants them moved off the

		system drive
▶ **Apply**	Button, appears to the right of a dropdown after a different drive is selected. No Cancel button appears with it. It stays visible even if the original drive is picked again.	Tech picks the new drive, then clicks Apply to make the change take effect

Tech tip: This page only changes where new content goes, and existing files stay where they are, so it won't free up any space on C: by itself. Moving files that are already there is a separate job. Removable drives such as USB sticks appear in the list, so it's possible to point a category at a drive that won't always be plugged in. It's worth checking before choosing one for a customer. Nothing changes until Apply is clicked, and there is no Cancel button. To discard a choice you haven't applied, leave the page and go back to Storage, which resets the dropdowns to their saved drives.

Storage → Storage Spaces

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Storage Spaces

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"Storage Spaces group drives together in a storage pool and then use capacity from that pool to create virtual drives called Storage	Customer asks what Storage Spaces is before deciding whether to use it

	Spaces. This helps protect your data from drive failure." Ends with a "Learn more" link.	
▶ **Learn more**	Link, opens a pop-up window with an online page explaining how Storage Spaces works	Tech reads the explanation before setting up a pool or answering a customer's question
Pools (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Add a new Storage Pool**	Row with an "Add" button. No pools exist on this PC. Add opens the "New storage pool" dialog.	Customer has several spare drives and wants them to act as one protected volume
▶ **Name**	In the dialog: text box, pre-filled with "Storage pool", with a clear (X) button	Tech gives the pool a name that describes its purpose
▶ **Add disks**	In the dialog: section header. "Select which disks you want to add to the storage pool."	Tech chooses which drives become part of the pool
▶ **Total projected pool capacity**	In the dialog: text, "0 bytes" until disks are selected	Tech checks how much space the pool will have

		before creating it
▸ **Available disks**	In the dialog: checkbox, unchecked. "There aren't any disks available to use with Storage Spaces." On a PC with eligible drives, they are listed here to select.	Customer asks why their drives don't appear; they're in use or not eligible
▸ **Create**	In the dialog: button, grayed out until a disk is selected	Tech creates the pool once the right disks are checked
▸ **Cancel**	In the dialog: button, closes the dialog without making changes	Tech backs out without touching any drives

Tech tip: Storage Spaces is Windows' built-in way to combine drives into one pool, and it can mirror data so a single drive failure doesn't lose it. This page only shows pools that already exist, so on most PCs it's empty. The dialog lists only drives that aren't already in use, so a PC with just its Windows drive and a few USB drives will show none. Creating a pool takes over the drives you choose, so a tech should confirm those drives are empty or backed up first.

Storage → Disks & Volumes

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Disks & volumes

Item	Description	Scenario
Intro text	"View and manage	Tech confirms

	properties of your disks and volumes."	this is the page for drive-level details
Create a virtual hard disk (VHD)	Row. "Create and mount a VHD or VHDX to your system"	Tech sets up a virtual disk to test software without touching real drives
▶ **Create VHD**	Button. Opens a "Create and attach virtual hard disk" dialog with a name box, a location box with a Browse button, a size box with a units dropdown (GB), format options (VHD or VHDX, with VHDX selected), and type options (Fixed size or Dynamically expanding, with Dynamically expanding marked "recommended" and selected). Create is grayed out until the name and size are filled in. Cancel closes it without changes.	Tech creates a virtual disk to test software or a Windows install without touching real drives
▶ **Attach VHD**	Button. Opens an "Attach Vhd" dialog: "Specify the virtual hard disk location on the machine." It has a	Customer has an existing VHD or VHDX file and wants it to

	Location box (showing "C:\") and a Browse button. Attach is grayed out until a file is chosen, and Cancel closes it without changes.	appear as a drive
Create a Dev Drive	Row. "Optimized performance for developer scenarios"	Developer customer wants a faster drive for code projects
▶ **Learn more about Dev Drives**	Link. Opens a Microsoft page in the browser titled "Set up a Dev Drive on Windows 11".	Tech reads Microsoft's setup steps before building a Dev Drive for a developer customer
▶ **Create Dev Drive**	Button. Opens a "Choose a Dev Drive location" dialog: "Choose where you want your Dev Drive to be created. 50 GB is the minimum size for Dev Drives." It offers two choices, "Create new VHD" (build the volume on a new virtual hard disk) and "Resize an existing volume" (creates new unallocated space to build on). Below them	Developer customer wants a faster drive for code projects and picks where to build it

	it shows "No disks with unallocated space available." when no disk qualifies. Next is grayed out until a choice is made, and Cancel closes it without changes.	
[Disk name]	One card per physical disk or USB drive: model name, "Disk" number, and "Online". Some disks also show "Healthy". Has a Properties button and is an expandable row, currently expanded. The Properties page is documented next.	Tech identifies each physical drive in the PC by model and number
▶ **Properties (disk)**	Button on the disk row	Tech checks a disk's details, such as its health and partition style
▶ **[Volume name]**	One row for each volume on the disk. Shows the label or "(No label)", the drive letter if there is one, the file system, "Healthy", and the partition type. Windows' own partitions show type labels such as "EFI	Tech sees every partition on a disk, including hidden ones, to check whether a repair or reinstall left the layout intact

	system partition", "Boot volume", and "Microsoft recovery partition". Has its own Properties button.	
▶ **Properties (volume)**	Button on each volume row. The volume Properties page is documented after the disk Properties page.	Tech opens a volume's details
▶ **(Unallocated)**	Row under a disk that has free space not assigned to any volume. Has a "Create volume" button instead of Properties.	Customer's new drive doesn't show up in File Explorer; the tech sees it here with its space unallocated
▶ **Create volume**	Button on the Unallocated row. Opens a "New Volume" dialog with a Label box, a Drive Letter dropdown (such as "G"), a File System dropdown (such as "NTFS"), and a Size (MB) box with the Max and Min sizes shown beneath it. An "Advanced" dropdown, collapsed, sits below. Format creates the volume and	Tech turns the unallocated space into a usable drive

Cancel closes the dialog without changes.

Tech tip: Every connected disk is listed here with its volumes, including the hidden ones. The EFI system partition and the recovery partition have no drive letter, so they never show up in File Explorer, which is worth knowing when a customer asks about "extra partitions" on a new PC. An (Unallocated) row means free space with no volume on it, so it won't appear as a drive until someone clicks Create volume. Format in the New Volume dialog erases anything on the space it uses, so check that the Unallocated space really is empty before clicking it. VHDX is the newer format and supports much larger sizes than VHD; a dynamically expanding disk starts small and grows as files are added, while a fixed-size disk reserves its full size up front. A Dev Drive needs at least 50 GB, and the dialog says when no disk has unallocated space to build on.

Storage → Disks & Volumes → [Disk name]

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Disks & volumes → [Disk name] (Properties)

Item	Description	Scenario
Name	Text, the disk's model name	Tech confirms they're looking at the right drive
Disk ID	Text, the disk number (such as "2")	Tech matches the disk number to the one on the main Disks &

		volumes page
Manufacturer	Text. Blank on some disks.	Customer asks who made the drive
Model	Text	Tech looks up the drive's specs or warranty
Serial number	Label that can be blank	Tech records the serial number for a warranty claim; some drives leave it blank
Media	Text, such as "Removable Device" or "SSD"	Tech confirms whether the drive is internal or removable
Bus type	Text, such as "USB", "SATA", or "Nvme"	Tech confirms how the drive connects to the PC
Location	Text, bus number, target ID and LUN	Tech needs the connection details while troubleshooting a drive that isn't detected
Capacity	Text, the drive's total size	Customer's flash drive is smaller than the label says

Type	Text, such as "Basic"	Tech checks whether the disk is a basic or dynamic disk
Advanced Disk Properties	Link. Opens a separate classic Windows properties window for the disk, with General, Volumes, Driver, Details, and Events tabs. The General tab shows the device type, manufacturer, location, and a device status message such as "This device is working properly."	Tech checks the driver or device status when a drive isn't behaving, without opening Device Manager
Removal policy	Section header, shown on removable disks. Two radio buttons; "Quick Removal" is selected.	Tech decides how a customer should handle unplugging a USB drive
▶ **Quick Removal**	Radio button. "You can physically disconnect removable devices without data loss, because write caching is disabled."	Customer pulls their flash drive out without ejecting it and wants to avoid losing files
▶ **Performance**	Radio button. "Uses write caching to improve disk performance. To prevent	Customer copies large files to an external drive

	potential data loss, use the Safely Remove Hardware and Eject Media icon before disconnecting the device."	and wants faster transfers
Status	Section header. Text, "Online"	Tech confirms the disk is online and usable
▶ **Take offline**	Button, shown on some disks	Tech takes a disk offline so Windows stops using it, for example before servicing
Detach	Section header, shown on some disks	—
▶ **Detach VHD**	Button. Opens a "Detach Vhd" dialog: "Detaching a virtual hard disk will make it unavailable until it is attached again. Virtual hard disk file location:" followed by the file path. Ok and Cancel buttons. On a physical disk the file location is blank.	Tech finishes with a mounted virtual disk and detaches it so it's no longer available as a drive
Drive health	Section header, shown on drives that report it, such as an NVMe SSD	Customer's PC is slow or crashing and the tech

		checks whether the drive is wearing out
▸ **Estimated remaining life**	Text, such as "100%"	Tech judges how much write life an SSD has left
▸ **Available spare**	Text, such as "100%"	Tech checks the drive's reserve of spare blocks, which shrinks as the drive wears
▸ **Temperature**	Text, such as "36°C"	Tech checks whether a hot drive is the cause of throttling or random shutdowns
▸ **Click here for more information**	Link. Opens an online Microsoft page titled "What to do about a critical warning for a storage device".	Tech reads Microsoft's guidance when a drive reports a low health number or a critical warning
▸ **Back up now**	Link. Opens Settings → Accounts → Windows backup (documented in the Accounts section).	Tech sees a drive with poor health and sends the customer straight to backup before

		anything fails
Partition Style	Section header. Text: "GUID Partition Table (GPT)" or "Master Boot Record (MBR)"	Tech checks whether a disk uses GPT or MBR before cloning it or installing Windows on it

Tech tip: The Properties page differs by disk. A USB disk shows Removal policy and Take offline, an NVMe SSD shows Drive health and Partition Style, and a SATA SSD shows Take offline, Detach, and Partition Style, so the layouts above are a superset. Quick Removal is the default for removable drives, so a customer can unplug a flash drive without ejecting it; switching to Performance speeds up transfers, but then the customer must use Safely Remove Hardware before unplugging or risk losing data. Partition Style can differ from disk to disk on the same PC. A GPT disk needs UEFI to boot, and an older MBR disk can't be the Windows boot drive on a UEFI-only setup, so check it before cloning or moving a Windows install. Advanced Disk Properties opens the same classic window as Device Manager, which is the place to check driver details when a drive misbehaves. Detach VHD appears only on some disks' pages and opens a confirmation dialog, so read the dialog and use Cancel unless the disk is a mounted virtual disk. Take offline stops Windows from using the disk, so check with the customer before using it.

Storage → Disks & Volumes → [Volume name]

Navigation path: Settings → System → Storage → Advanced storage settings → Disks & volumes → [Volume name] (Properties)

Item	Description	Scenario
Volume Data	Section header. Subtitle "Simple Volume"	Tech confirms the volume type before changing anything
▸ **Label**	Text, such as "New Volume"	Customer asks why their drive has a generic name
▸ **Drive letter**	Text, such as "E"	Tech confirms which letter the volume uses
▸ **Type**	Text, such as "IFS partition"	Tech checks the partition type
▸ **File system**	Text, such as "NTFS"	Customer asks whether a drive will work with a console or another OS
▸ **Status**	Text, such as "Healthy"	Tech confirms the volume has no errors
▸ **Change label**	Button. Opens a "Change Volume Label" dialog with a text box showing	Customer wants a descriptive name like

	the current label and a clear (X) button. Type the new name, then click Apply. Cancel closes it without changes.	"Backup" instead of "New Volume"
▶ **Change drive letter**	Button. Opens a "Change Drive Letter" dialog: "Choose which drive letter to use for this volume", with a dropdown showing the current letter. OK applies the change and Cancel closes without changes.	Tech fixes a drive letter that conflicts with a mapped network drive
Size	Section header with the volume's total size, such as "238 GB". Usage bar with used and free amounts.	Tech sees how full the volume is
▶ **Change size**	Button. Opens a "Change Size" dialog showing Current, Max, and Min sizes in MB, with the note "Unmovable files may limit the minimum size of a volume." Below that is a "New size" box with a clear (X) button and a units dropdown (MB). OK is grayed out until the size changes,	Tech shrinks a volume to free space for a new one, or grows it into unallocated space

	and Cancel closes it without changes.	
▸ **View usage**	Link. Opens the volume's storage usage page (documented earlier in this section under Storage used on other drives).	Tech sees what's filling a volume without going back to the Storage page
Format	Section header. "You can format or delete the volume to erase all data on it."	Tech wipes a drive before handing it to a new customer
▸ **Format**	Button	Tech reformats a volume, which erases everything on it
▸ **Delete**	Button	Tech removes a volume and leaves its space unallocated
Paths	Section header. "Allow access to this volume using the following NTFS paths."	Tech mounts a volume in a folder instead of giving it a drive letter
▸ **Add**	Button with a plus icon. Opens an "Add Path" dialog: "Mount this volume in an empty NTFS folder to access it	Tech mounts a volume in an empty folder instead of giving it a drive letter

	by path". It has a text box for the folder path and a Browse button. OK is grayed out until a path is entered, and Cancel closes it without changes.	
BitLocker	Section header. "Protect data on this volume by encrypting it with BitLocker"	Customer wants a drive's contents protected if it's lost or stolen
▸ **Status**	Text, such as "Not Encrypted"	Tech checks whether a volume is encrypted before moving or repairing it
▸ **Turn on BitLocker**	Link. Opens the classic BitLocker Drive Encryption window in Control Panel, which lists the PC's drives by type (operating system, fixed data, removable) with each drive's BitLocker status.	Tech starts encrypting a data drive for a customer with sensitive files

Tech tip: Format and Delete both erase all data on the volume, and they sit on the same row as harmless-looking buttons, so confirm a backup exists first. Paths lets a volume

appear as a folder, which is useful when a PC has run out of drive letters. Change drive letter can break shortcuts and programs that expect the old letter, so check before changing a letter on a drive that holds apps. A volume can't shrink below its Min size, since unmovable files can block it, and it can't grow past Max, which is limited by the free space next to it on the disk. BitLocker status is shown per volume here, so a PC can have one encrypted drive and one unencrypted drive. Check the status before moving or repairing a drive, since an encrypted volume needs its recovery key.

Share

Navigation path: Settings → System → Share

Item	Description	Scenario
Nearby sharing	Expandable section (currently expanded). Subtitle: "Share files, photos, and links with nearby Windows devices". Holds three radio buttons, listed below.	Customer wants to send files to a nearby PC without email or a USB drive
▶ **How to improve nearby sharing speed**	Link under the Nearby sharing subtitle	Tech looks up Microsoft's guidance when a customer says transfers are slow
▶ **Off**	Radio button, selected	Customer

		doesn't use nearby sharing and wants it switched off
▶ **My devices only**	Radio button, not selected	Customer wants to send files only between their own devices
▶ **Everyone nearby**	Radio button, not selected	Customer needs to receive files from other people's devices, such as at a meeting
Save files I receive to	Shows the current folder, here "C:\Users\[username]\Downloads", with a "Change" button on the right. The button is greyed out while Nearby sharing is Off. It becomes clickable once My devices only or Everyone nearby is selected.	Customer wants received files saved somewhere other than Downloads
▶ **Change**	Button. Greyed out while Nearby sharing is Off, and clickable once My devices only or Everyone nearby is selected. Opens the same "Select	Tech points received files at a drive with more room

	Folder" window with either option. The window starts at This PC and lists the drives under "Devices and drives", with a Folder box at the bottom and "Select Folder" and "Cancel" buttons. "Select Folder" is greyed out while the Folder box is empty.	
Your device is discoverable as "[device name]"	Shows the name other devices see, with a "Rename" button on the right	Customer's PC has a name they don't recognize, or one that shows a real name, and they want a clearer one
▶ **Rename**	Button	Tech sets a recognizable name so the customer can pick the right PC from another device
Show me suggested apps in share surfaces	Toggle, On	Customer sees app suggestions in the Windows Share window and wants them

		gone
Privacy Statement	"Understand how Microsoft uses your data for nearby sharing and for what purposes" — external-link icon on the right	Customer asks what data nearby sharing sends to Microsoft

Tech tip: Nearby sharing is Off on this PC. The Change button for the save location is greyed out while sharing is Off and works once My devices only or Everyone nearby is selected, so turn sharing on before changing the save folder. Before turning it on for a customer, check the save folder and the device name. The device name is what other people see, and it can be a real first name. "Everyone nearby" makes the PC discoverable to people close by, so on a shared or public-use PC "My devices only" or Off is usually the safer choice. The privacy link at the bottom is the quickest source to point a worried customer to.

Multitasking

Navigation path: Settings → System → Multitasking

Item	Description	Scenario
Snap windows	Toggle, On. Subtitle: "Snap windows to automatically resize and arrange them into layouts". Expandable section (currently expanded) holding five checkboxes, all checked,	Customer's windows keep resizing when dragged near the screen edge and they want snapping turned off

	listed below.	
▸ **When I snap a window, suggest what I can snap next to it**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the suggestions after a snap to stop appearing, or wants them back
▸ **Show snap layouts when I hover over a window's maximize button**	Checkbox, checked	Customer is bothered by a layout pop-up when the pointer rests on the maximize button
▸ **Show snap layouts when I drag a window to the top of my screen**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the layout choices that appear when dragging a window to the top, or wants them gone
▸ **Show my snapped windows when I hover over taskbar apps, in Task View, and when I press Alt+Tab**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants snapped window groups to show up in the taskbar, Task View and Alt+Tab views

▸ **When I drag a window, let me snap it without dragging all the way to the screen edge**	Checkbox, checked	Customer finds snapping hard to trigger, or triggers it by accident
Show tabs from apps when snapping or pressing Alt+Tab	Dropdown, currently "3 most recent tabs". The choices are "20 most recent tabs", "5 most recent tabs", "3 most recent tabs", and "Don't show tabs".	Customer sees app tabs mixed in with their windows in Alt+Tab and wants fewer or none
Desktops	Expandable section (currently expanded) holding two dropdowns, listed below	Customer uses more than one virtual desktop
▸ **On the taskbar, show all the open windows**	Dropdown, currently "Only on the desktop I'm using"	Customer with several desktops sees windows from the wrong desktop on the taskbar
▸ **Show all open windows when I press Alt+Tab**	Dropdown, currently "Only on the desktop I'm using"	Customer with several desktops sees windows from the wrong desktop in Alt+Tab

Title bar window shake	Toggle, On. "When I grab a window's title bar and shake it, minimize all other windows"	Customer's other windows minimize unexpectedly when they drag one back and forth
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Multitasking**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▷ **Getting new wallpapers every day from Microsoft**	Link	Customer asks about fresh wallpapers; the link sits here even though it isn't a multitasking topic
▷ **Splitting my screen**	Link	Customer wants to split the screen between two apps
▷ **Using Task View**	Link	Customer wants to learn how Task View works

Tech tip: When a customer says windows jump around, resize on their own, or minimize unexpectedly, check this

page first. Snap windows and Title bar window shake are both On here, and the five snap checkboxes are hidden until the Snap windows section is expanded. Clutter in Alt+Tab can come from three places: the tabs dropdown and the two Desktops dropdowns.

Advanced

Navigation path: Settings → System → Advanced

Item	Description	Scenario
Taskbar (section header)	Section header	—
End task	Toggle, On. "Enable end task in taskbar by right click"	Customer has a frozen app and wants to close it from the taskbar without opening Task Manager
File Explorer (section header)	Section header	—
File Explorer	Arrow opens its own page. "Adjust these settings for a more developer-friendly experience using File Explorer"	Tech wants File Explorer set up for developer-style use
Enable long paths	Toggle, On. "Remove MAX_PATH limitations	Customer gets errors copying or

	from common Win32 file and directory functions"	opening files buried in very long folder paths
Virtual Workspace (section header)	Section header	—
Remote Desktop	Arrow opens the Remote Desktop page, the same page found at Settings → System → Remote Desktop. "Enable Remote Desktop and ensure machine availability"	Tech wants to connect to the customer's PC remotely
Virtual Workspaces	Arrow opens its own page. "Adjust settings for virtual workspaces"	Customer or tech needs to adjust a virtual workspace
Terminal (section header)	Section header	—
Terminal	Dropdown, currently "Let Windows decide". "Choose the default terminal app to host command-line apps". The choices are "Let Windows decide", "Windows Console Host" and "Windows Terminal".	Customer's command-line windows open in the wrong kind of window

PowerShell	Expandable section. "Turn on these settings to execute PowerShell scripts". Holds one toggle, listed below.	Customer's PowerShell script is blocked from running
▸ **Change execution policy to allow local PowerShell scripts to run without signing. Require signing for remote scripts.**	Toggle, Off	Tech needs a local script to run that isn't signed
Enable sudo	Toggle, Off, with an expandable arrow. "Enable the sudo command. Running the sudo command could expose your device and personal data to security risks or harm your device."	Tech wants to run elevated commands from a normal terminal window
▸ **Learn more**	Link under the description	Customer asks what the risks of sudo are
▸ **Configure how sudo**	Dropdown, seen with Enable sudo turned On	Tech chooses where sudo

runs applications	and set to "In a new window". The choices are "In a new window", "With input disabled" and "Inline".	output and input appear
For developers (section header)	Section header	—
Developer Mode	Toggle, Off. "Install apps from any source, including loose files"	Tech needs to install an app that doesn't come from the Store, such as a test build
Device Portal	Toggle, Off, greyed out while Developer Mode is Off. "Turn on remote diagnostics over local area network connections". Expandable section holding the four rows below.	Developer wants remote diagnostics over the local network
▸ **Restrict to loopback connections only**	Toggle, Off, greyed out	Tech limits Device Portal to connections from the PC itself
▸ **Authentication**	Toggle, Off, greyed out	Tech wants Device Portal to ask for a login

▸ **Provide a username and password**	"Edit" button, greyed out	Tech sets the Device Portal login
▸ **Connect using:**	Text: "No network connection found"	Tech checks which network address Device Portal would use
Device discovery	Toggle, Off, greyed out while Developer Mode is Off. "Make your device visible to USB connections and your local network". Expandable section holding the two rows below.	Developer wants the PC to be visible for pairing with other devices
▸ **Note**	Info banner: "Note: This requires version 1803 of the Windows 10 SDK or later."	Tech finds out why discovery won't work on an older setup
▸ **Number of paired devices: 0**	Text, with two greyed-out buttons, "Pair" and "Unpair all"	Tech pairs a device, or clears all pairings
Dev Drive (section header)	Section header	—
Create a Dev Drive	Arrow opens the Disks & volumes page under Storage (Settings →	Developer wants a drive tuned for code and build

	System → Storage → Disks & volumes), which is documented there. "Optimized performance for developer scenarios", with a "Learn more" link	files
Control antivirus behavior	External-link icon on the right. "Control Microsoft Defender Antivirus across all trusted Dev Drives.", with a "Learn more" link	Tech reviews how Defender treats trusted Dev Drives

Tech tip: Most of this page is aimed at developers and can be left alone for a typical customer. Developer Mode, Enable sudo, and the PowerShell script setting each loosen a safeguard, so they are worth turning on only for a specific job and turning back off afterward; all three are Off on this PC. Device Portal and Device discovery are greyed out while Developer Mode is Off. End task and Enable long paths are On here.

Advanced → File Explorer

Navigation path: Settings → System → Advanced → File Explorer

Item	Description	Scenario
File Explorer (section header)	Section header	—
Show file	Toggle, On	Tech checks a

extensions		suspicious attachment's real file type
Show hidden and system files	Toggle, On	Tech needs to see hidden folders and system files while troubleshooting
Show full path in title bar	Toggle, Off	Tech wants to see which folder a File Explorer window is in at a glance
Show option to run as different user in Start	Toggle, Off	Tech wants to launch an app under another account without signing out
Show empty drives	Toggle, Off	Customer's card reader or empty drive doesn't appear in This PC
File Explorer + version control (section header)	Section header	—
Choose repository	"Choose folder" button	Developer wants File Explorer to

folder	work with a version-controlled code folder

Tech tip: Show file extensions and Show hidden and system files are both On on this PC, which is what a tech usually wants when hunting for malware or tracking down a file. Windows normally hides both, so a customer's PC may look different.

Advanced → Virtual Workspaces

Navigation path: Settings → System → Advanced → Virtual Workspaces

Item	Description	Scenario
Containers	Toggle, Off. "Provides services and tools to create and manage Windows Server Containers and their resources"	Developer needs container support on this PC
Guarded Host	Toggle, Off. "Enables the device to create and run Shielded Virtual Machine using remote attestation"	IT admin sets up shielded virtual machines on this PC
Virtual Machine Platform	Toggle, Off. "Enables platform support for virtual machines"	Tech finds that a virtual machine tool needs this platform support turned on

Windows Hypervisor Platform	Toggle, Off. "Enables virtualization software to run on the Windows hypervisor"	Tech's virtualization software needs to run on the Windows hypervisor
Windows Sandbox	Toggle, Off. "Enables the dependencies required to run Windows Sandbox scenarios"	Tech wants a throwaway environment to test an unknown program
Hyper-V settings (section header)	Section header	—
Hyper-V GUI Management Tools	Toggle, Off. "Includes the Hyper-V Manager snap-in and Virtual Machine Connection tool"	Tech wants the Hyper-V Manager window to manage virtual machines
Hyper-V Module for Windows PowerShell	Toggle, Off. "Includes Windows PowerShell cmdlets for managing Hyper-V"	Tech manages virtual machines from PowerShell
Hyper-V Hypervisor	Toggle, Off. "Provides the Hyper-V Hypervisor"	Tech needs the core Hyper-V layer on this PC
Hyper-V Services	Toggle, Off. "Provides the services that you can use to create and	Tech wants to create and run virtual machines

manage virtual machines and their resources"

Tech tip: All nine toggles are Off on this PC. Each one adds or removes a Windows feature, so turning one on may need a restart. Leave them off for a typical customer and turn one on only for a specific job.

Activation

Navigation path: Settings → System → Activation

Item	Description	Scenario
Windows 11 Pro	Edition name shown at the top of the page, next to the Windows logo	Tech confirms which Windows edition the customer has
Activation state	Status "Active" with a green check mark, and an expandable arrow (currently expanded)	Customer asks whether Windows is activated
▸ **Windows is activated with a digital license.**	Text shown when the row is expanded	Tech confirms the PC is activated by a digital license rather than a typed-in key
Change product key	"Change" button on the right	Tech needs to enter a different product key
▸ **Enter a**	Pop-up that opens from the Change button, with	Tech types in a new key to

product key	"Next" and "Cancel" buttons	activate or change the edition
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Activation**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▷ **Linking Microsoft account to digital license**	Link	Customer wants their license tied to their Microsoft account before a hardware change
▷ **Checking if your Windows is activated**	Link	Customer isn't sure whether Windows is activated
▷ **Activating Windows with product key**	Link	Tech walks a customer through activating with a key
▷ **Finding your product key**	Link	Customer lost their product key

Tech tip: This PC is activated with a digital license, so no product key is needed here, and the page does not display the key itself. Only open the Change product key pop-up when there is a real key to enter, and don't type in a guess.

Troubleshoot

Navigation path: Settings → System → Troubleshoot

Item	Description	Scenario
Info banner	"Share optional diagnostic data to get additional troubleshooting recommendations." with an "Open Diagnostics & feedback" link	Customer wants more troubleshooting recommendations and is willing to share extra diagnostic data
Options (section header)	Section header	—
Recommended troubleshooter preferences	Dropdown, currently "Ask me before running". "Microsoft can recommend and run troubleshooters to fix issues". The choices are "Run automatically, don't notify me", "Run automatically, then notify me", "Ask me before running" and "Don't run any".	Customer doesn't want Windows running fixes on its own, or wants it to
Recommended troubleshooter history	Arrow opens its own page	Tech checks which recommended fixes Windows has already run

Other troubleshooters	Arrow opens its own page	Tech wants to run a specific troubleshooter by hand
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Troubleshoot**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▷ **Fixing issues downloading from Microsoft Store**	Link	Customer's Store app won't download
▷ **Running a troubleshooter for PC issues**	Link	Customer asks how to run a troubleshooter
▷ **Fixing low disk space errors quickly**	Link	Customer's drive is nearly full
▷ **Fixing Windows Update issues easily**	Link	Customer's Windows Update is stuck or failing

Tech tip: The troubleshooter preference is set to Ask me before running on this PC. If a customer says Windows changed something on its own, check this dropdown first. Other troubleshooters is where you pick a specific troubleshooter to run by hand.

Troubleshoot → Recommended Troubleshooter History

Navigation path: Settings → System → Troubleshoot → Recommended troubleshooter history

Item	Description	Scenario
Message	"Your device hasn't run any recommended troubleshooters."	Tech checks whether Windows has run any recommended fixes on this PC

Tech tip: The page is empty on this PC. On a customer's PC, check it first when they say Windows changed something on its own.

Troubleshoot → Other Troubleshooters

Navigation path: Settings → System → Troubleshoot → Other troubleshooters

Item	Description	Scenario
Most frequent (section header)	Section header	—
Audio	"Run" button	Customer has no

		sound, or the sound cuts out
Network and Internet	"Run" button	Customer's Wi-Fi or internet connection is dropping or not working
Printer	"Run" button	Customer's printer won't print
Windows Update	"Run" button	Customer's updates are stuck or failing
Other (section header)	Section header	—
Background Intelligent Transfer Service	"Run" button	Tech suspects background downloads or updates are stalling
Bluetooth	"Run" button	Customer's Bluetooth device won't pair or connect
Camera	"Run" button	Customer's webcam isn't working in an app
Program	"Find and fix problems	Customer's older

Compatibility Troubleshooter	with running older programs on this version of Windows." "Run" button	program won't run on Windows 11
Video Playback	"Run" button	Customer's videos stutter or won't play
Windows Media Player	"Run" button	Customer's media won't play in Windows Media Player
Privacy resources	Shield icon, with a link: "About these settings and your privacy"	Customer asks how Microsoft handles their data
Quick assistance from a friend	Link at the bottom of the page, below "Get help"	Customer wants a friend or relative to help them remotely

Tech tip: Each troubleshooter has its own Run button and starts as soon as it is clicked, so they make a quick first step before deeper work. Audio, Network and Internet, Printer and Windows Update are grouped under Most frequent; everything else is under Other.

Recovery

Navigation path: Settings → System → Recovery

Item	Description	Scenario
Page text	"If you're having	—

	problems with your PC or want to reset it, these recovery options might help."	
Fix problems without resetting your PC	Arrow opens the Troubleshoot page (Settings → System → Troubleshoot), which is documented there. "Resetting can take a while — first, try resolving issues by running a troubleshooter"	Tech tries a troubleshooter before resorting to a reset
Fix problems using Windows Update	"Reinstall now" button. "Reinstall your current version of Windows (your apps, files, and settings will be preserved)"	Tech wants to repair Windows without losing the customer's apps and files
Recovery options (section header)	Section header	—
Reset this PC	"Reset PC" button. "Choose to keep or remove your personal files, then reinstall Windows"	Customer's PC is badly broken, or is being handed on and needs a fresh start
Advanced startup	"Restart now" button. "Restart your device to	Tech needs to boot the PC from

	change startup settings, including starting from a disc or USB drive"	repair media on a USB drive
Quick machine recovery	Arrow opens its own page. "If your device fails to start, we'll try to fix the problem with device recovery solutions"	Tech checks whether Windows will try to fix a PC that fails to start
Point-in-time restore	"View or edit" button. "Turn on and manage restore points to recover your PC to an earlier point in time". Clicking it shows a permission prompt ("Do you want to allow this to make changes to your machine?" with OK and Cancel), then opens the Point-in-time restore window, documented below.	Customer's PC broke after a change and they want to roll back
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Help with Recovery**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▷ **Reverting to**	Link	Customer wants

previous Windows version easily		to go back to an earlier version of Windows after an update
▹ **Resetting your PC for a fresh start**	Link	Customer asks how a reset works
▹ **Creating a recovery drive**	Link	Tech wants a recovery drive ready before a risky repair
▹ **Backing-up and Restore**	Link	Customer wants to back up their files before a repair

Tech tip: Reinstall now keeps apps, files and settings, while Reset PC lets the customer choose to keep or remove personal files. Make sure a backup exists before using either.

Recovery → Quick Machine Recovery

Navigation path: Settings → System → Recovery → Quick machine recovery

Item	Description	Scenario
Quick machine recovery	Toggle, On. "If your device fails to start, we'll try to fix the problem with device recovery solutions"	Customer's PC won't start and Windows should try to repair itself
Automatically	Toggle, On, with an	Tech wants

check for solutions	expandable arrow (currently expanded). "Turn on to automatically check for remediation solutions. Turn off to check manually."	Windows to check for fixes by itself, or to check by hand
▶ **Look for solutions**	Dropdown, currently "Once (recommended)". The choices are "Once (recommended)", "Every 10 minutes", "Every 30 minutes", "Every 1 hour", "Every 2 hours", "Every 3 hours", "Every 6 hours" and "Every 12 hours".	Tech sets how often Windows checks again for a fix

Tech tip: Both toggles are On on this PC and the check is set to Once, the choice marked recommended. The other choices make Windows check again at set intervals, from every 10 minutes up to every 12 hours.

Recovery → Point-in-Time Restore

Navigation path: Settings → System → Recovery → Point-in-time restore → View or edit (opens a separate Point-in-time restore window after a permission prompt)

Item	Description	Scenario
Point-in-time restore	Toggle, On, with an expandable arrow (currently expanded). "If point-in-time restore is	Customer's PC broke after a change and they want a restore

	on, your PC will save restore points to revert back to". Holds two dropdowns, listed below.	point to go back to
▸ **Restore point frequency**	Dropdown, currently "Every 24 hours". Greyed out in this capture.	Tech sets how often restore points are made
▸ **Restore point retention**	Dropdown, currently "72 hours". Greyed out in this capture.	Tech sets how long restore points are kept
Restore point disk usage	Expandable section (currently expanded). "Space limit for all restore points on your system". Shows "Current usage: 3.6 GB".	Tech checks how much space restore points are taking
▸ **Max usage**	Slider with a label under it, here "0.5% of disk (5 GB)"	Tech raises or lowers the space set aside for restore points
Current restore points	Expandable list (currently expanded). Each entry shows a date and time with a Windows version number underneath. One entry is listed on this PC.	Tech checks whether a recent restore point exists before a risky repair
Save and Close	Two buttons at the bottom of the window. "Save" is greyed out in	Tech saves a change, or closes the

	this capture; "Close" is available.	window

Tech tip: Restore points are being saved on this PC: the toggle is On, the frequency is Every 24 hours, retention is 72 hours, and the space limit is 5 GB with 3.6 GB in use. Before a risky repair on a customer's PC, open the Current restore points list to confirm a recent restore point exists.

Projecting to This PC

Navigation path: Settings → System → Projecting to this PC

Item	Description	Scenario
Page text	"Project your Windows phone or PC to this screen, and use its keyboard, mouse, and other devices, too."	Customer wants to show their phone or another PC on this screen
Wireless Display line	"Add the "Wireless Display" optional feature to project to this PC:" with a link below it, "Optional features"	Tech checks that the Wireless Display feature is added before projecting will work
PC name	Label with the name shown in grey beside it, written here as "[device name]"	Tech sees the name other devices will list when projecting
Rename your PC	Link under the PC name	Customer's PC has a name they don't recognize

		and they want to change it

Tech tip: Only these items show on this PC. The page says the Wireless Display optional feature is needed to project, so check Optional features first when a customer's projecting isn't working.

Remote Desktop

Navigation path: Settings → System → Remote Desktop (also opens from Settings → System → Advanced → Remote Desktop)

Item	Description	Scenario
Remote Desktop	Toggle, On, with an expandable arrow (currently expanded). "Connect to and use this PC from another device using the Remote Desktop app". Holds two rows, listed below.	Tech wants to connect to the customer's PC remotely to fix a problem
▸ **Require devices to use Network Level Authentication to connect (Recommended)**	Checkbox, checked	Tech's older Remote Desktop client can't connect and this requirement may be why
▸ **Remote**	Text, "3389"	Tech needs the

Desktop port		port number to allow through a router or firewall
PC name	Name shown on the right, written here as "[device name]". "Use this name to connect to this PC from another device"	Tech needs the name to type into the Remote Desktop app on another device
Remote Desktop users	External-link icon on the right. "Select who can remotely access this PC". Opens a separate "Remote Desktop Users" window, described below.	Tech adds the customer's account to the list of people allowed to connect
▶ **Window text**	"The users listed below can connect to this computer, and any members of the Administrators group can connect even if they are not listed." Followed by a list box, empty here.	Tech checks who is already allowed in
▶ **"[username] already has access."**	Text under the list box	Tech sees that the signed-in account doesn't need to be added
▶ **Add... and**	Two buttons under the list box	Tech grants or removes remote

Remove		access for an account
▸ **User Accounts**	Link in the text "To create new user accounts or add users to other groups, go to Control Panel and open User Accounts."	Tech needs a new account created before it can be allowed in
▸ **OK and Cancel**	Two buttons at the bottom of the window	Tech saves or discards changes to the list

Tech tip: Remote Desktop is On on this PC, with Network Level Authentication required and the port set to 3389. Anyone in the Administrators group can connect even if they are not in the Remote Desktop users list, so that list only matters for ordinary accounts. On a customer's PC, turn Remote Desktop back off when the job is done unless they need it.

Clipboard

Navigation path: Settings → System → Clipboard

Item	Description	Scenario
Clipboard history	Toggle, Off. "Save multiple items to your clipboard—press the Windows logo key + V to view your clipboard history and paste from it"	Customer wants to paste something they copied earlier, not just the last item

Sync across your devices	Arrow opens a page. On this PC, which uses a local account, it opens Settings → Accounts → Your info, which is documented in the Accounts guide. "Paste text from your PC to supported devices"	Customer wants to copy on this PC and paste on another device
Clear clipboard data	"Clear" button. "Pinned items won't be removed on this device"	Customer copied a password or private text and wants it gone
Related links (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Get help with clipboard**	External-link icon on the right	Customer wants Microsoft's help article on the clipboard
▶ **How to seamlessly transfer content between your devices**	External-link icon on the right	Customer wants to move content between their devices
Related support (section header)	Section header	—

▶ **Help with Clipboard**	Expandable row, expanded	—
▹ **Syncing clipboard across devices easily**	Link	Customer asks how clipboard syncing works

Tech tip: Clipboard history is Off on this PC; the page says the Windows logo key + V shows it once it is on. Clear clipboard data does not remove pinned items on this device. On a PC that uses a local account, the Sync across your devices arrow leads to the Your info page, where the sign-in with a Microsoft account option is.

System Components

Navigation path: Settings → System → System components

Item	Description	Scenario
Search system components	Search box. Placeholder text: "Search system components"	Tech looks for one built-in component by name
View buttons	Three buttons at the top right: "List view", "Grid view" and "Tile view". Tile view is selected here. List view shows each component's name, version, publisher, date and size in one row; Tile	Tech wants more detail about each component, or a more compact layout

	view shows the name, size and date.	
Filter by	Dropdown, currently "All drives". The choices are "All drives" followed by one entry for each drive on the PC.	Tech checks which components are on a particular drive
Sort by	Dropdown, currently "Date installed". The choices are "Name (A to Z)", "Name (Z to A)", "Date installed", "Size (Large to small)" and "Size (Small to large)".	Tech looks for the newest or the largest component
Results count	Text: "7 system components found"	Tech sees how many components match the current filter
System components list	Seven components on this PC: Phone Link, Microsoft Store, Get Help, Game Bar, Windows Security, Windows Advanced Settings, and Windows Application Compatibility Enhancements. Each has a "..." menu. On Phone Link, the menu has one choice, "Advanced	Customer asks what built-in components their PC has

	options". It opens that component's own page, documented next using Phone Link.	
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
Installed apps	Arrow opens its own page. "Uninstall and manage apps on your PC"	Customer wants to remove or manage regular apps rather than system components
AI components	Arrow opens its own page. "View and uninstall AI components that are installed on Windows"	Customer wants to see or remove AI components

Tech tip: List view shows the most detail for each component. Use the Filter by and Sort by dropdowns to narrow the list or to find the newest or largest component. For regular apps rather than built-in components, use Installed apps under Related settings.

System Components → Phone Link

Navigation path: Settings → System → System components → "..." menu on a component → Advanced options

Item	Description	Scenario
Specifications	Section header	—

(section header)		
Publisher	Text showing the publisher, here "Microsoft Corporation"	Tech confirms who made the component
Version	Text showing the version number	Tech checks which version is installed
App	Text showing the size of the component itself	Tech checks how much space the component takes
Data	Text showing the size of the data it stores	Tech checks how much data the component has stored
Total usage	Text showing the combined size of App and Data	Tech checks the component's total footprint
Background component permissions (section header)	Section header	—
Let this system component run in background	Dropdown, currently "Power optimized (recommended)". The choices are "Always", "Power optimized (recommended)" and	Customer's battery drains quickly, or a component needs to keep running in the

	"Never".	background
▶ **Learn more about the options**	Link under the dropdown	Customer asks what each choice means
Runs at log-in	Section header. Text: "These startup tasks can be configured to run when you log-in."	—
▶ **Phone Link**	Toggle, Off	Tech stops the component from starting when the customer signs in
▶ **Configure startup tasks**	Link	Tech opens the list of startup tasks
Defaults	Section header. Text: "Select which system components to use to listen to music, look at pictures, check mail, watch videos, and more."	—
▶ **Set default system components**	Link	Customer's files open in the wrong component and they want to change it
Terminate	Section header. Text:	—

	"Immediately terminate this system component and its related processes."	
▶ **Terminate**	Button	Tech stops a frozen component without restarting the PC
Reset (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Repair**	Button. Text above it: "If this system component isn't working right, we can try to repair it. The system component's data won't be affected."	Tech tries a repair first because the component's data is kept
▶ **Reset**	Button. Text above it: "If this system component still isn't working right, reset it. The system component's data will be deleted."	Tech resets the component when a repair didn't help, after warning the customer its data will be deleted
Component add-ons & downloadable content (section header)	Section header	—

▸ **Search this list**	Search box	Tech looks for one add-on by name
▸ **Filter by**	Dropdown, currently "All drives"	Tech checks add-ons on one drive
▸ **Sort by**	Dropdown, currently "Date installed"	Tech sorts the add-ons
▸ **Message**	Text: "There are no add-ons currently installed for this system component."	Tech confirms the component has no add-ons

Tech tip: Try Repair before Reset. Repair leaves the component's data alone, while Reset deletes it. Terminate stops the component and its related processes right away. Phone Link is the component documented here; the page title shows the name of whichever component you open.

AI Components

Navigation path: Settings → System → AI components

Item	Description	Scenario
Message	Text: "There are no AI components currently installed."	Customer asks whether any AI components are installed on their PC
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—

System components	Arrow opens its own page, documented above. "Manage system components that are preinstalled on Windows"	Tech wants to see the built-in components on the PC
Installed apps	Arrow opens its own page. "Uninstall and manage apps on your PC"	Customer wants to remove or manage regular apps

Tech tip: The System components page describes this page as the place to view and uninstall AI components. None are installed on this PC, so only the message and the two Related settings links show.

Optional Features

Navigation path: Settings → System → Optional features

Item	Description	Scenario
View or edit optional features	"View features" button, shown in the accent color	Tech needs to add or remove an optional Windows feature
Optional features history	"See history" button	Tech checks which optional features were added or removed
Related settings	Section header	—

(section header)		
More Windows features	External-link icon on the right	Tech looks for more Windows features beyond the optional ones

Tech tip: View features is where to look for the Wireless Display optional feature that the Projecting to this PC page asks for. The View features and See history buttons open further screens, described next.

Optional Features → Optional Feature History

Navigation path: Settings → System → Optional features → See history

Item	Description	Scenario
Search history	Search box. Placeholder text: "Search history"	Tech looks for one feature in the history
Sort by	Dropdown, currently "Date". The choices are "Date" and "Name".	Tech lists the history by date or by feature name
Message	Text: "No features found. Double check your search criteria." Below it: "No feature history."	Tech confirms no optional features have been added or removed on this PC

Tech tip: Both messages show on this PC because no optional feature has been added or removed. On a customer's PC, check this screen to see what changed before a problem started.

Optional Features → View Features

Navigation path: Settings → System → Optional features → View features

Item	Description	Scenario
See available features	Link at the top of the window	Tech wants to add a feature that isn't installed yet
Added features (section header)	Section header	—
Search added features	Search box. Placeholder text: "Search added features"	Tech looks for one installed feature by name
Sort by	Dropdown, currently "Name". The choices are "Name", "Total size" and "Date added".	Tech finds the largest or newest added feature
Results count	Text: "11 features found"	Tech sees how many optional features are installed
Feature list	Eleven features on this	Tech checks

	PC: Extended Theme Content, Facial Recognition (Windows Hello), Internet Explorer mode, Math Recognizer, Notepad (system), OpenSSH Client, Print Management, Steps Recorder, VBSCRIPT, Windows Media Player Legacy (App) and Windows PowerShell ISE. Each row has an icon, an unticked checkbox and an expand arrow, and some rows show a size. Expanding Notepad (system) shows: "The classic system Notepad, for editing text files when newer versions of the Notepad app are not available."	whether a feature a customer needs is already installed
Close	Button at the bottom of the window	Tech closes the window when finished

Tech tip: Wireless Display is not among the eleven added features on this PC, which fits the Projecting to this PC page asking for it to be added. Expand a feature's arrow to read what it does before changing anything.

Optional Features → Available Features

Navigation path: Settings → System → Optional features → View features → See available features

Item	Description	Scenario
See added features	Link at the top of the window	Tech returns to the list of installed features
Available features (section header)	Section header	—
Find an available optional feature	Search box. Placeholder text: "Find an available optional feature"	Tech looks for one feature that can be added
Results count	Text: "62 features found"	Tech sees how many optional features can be added
Feature list	62 features in alphabetical order. Each row has an icon, an unticked checkbox and an expand arrow. They fall into three groups, listed below.	Tech checks whether a feature a customer needs can be added
▶ **Supplemental fonts (24)**	The names below each end in "Supplemental Fonts": Arabic Script,	Customer can't read or write a language

	Bangla Script, Canadian Aboriginal Syllabics, Cherokee, Chinese (Simplified), Chinese (Traditional), Devanagari, Ethiopic, Gujarati, Gurmukhi, Hebrew, Japanese, Kannada, Khmer, Korean, Lao, Malayalam, Odia, Pan-European, Sinhala, Syriac, Tamil, Telugu, Thai. Expanding Korean shows: "Additional fonts: Batang, BatangChe, Dotum, DotumChe, Gulim, GulimChe, Gungsuh, GungsuhChe, Noto Sans KR, Noto Serif KR". Expanding Sinhala shows: "Additional fonts: Iskoola Pota, Iskoola Pota Bold".	because its font is missing
▶ **RSAT tools (21)**	The names below each start with "RSAT:" (Remote Server Administration Tools): Active Directory Certificate Services Tools, Active Directory Domain Services and Lightweight Directory	IT tech needs server management tools on this PC

	Services Tools, BitLocker Drive Encryption Administration Utilities, DHCP Server Tools, DNS Server Tools, Data Center Bridging LLDP Tools, Failover Clustering Tools, File Services Tools, Group Policy Management Tools, IP Address Management (IPAM) Client, Network Controller Management Tools, Network Load Balancing Tools, PowerShell module for Azure Stack HCI, Remote Access Management Tools, Remote Desktop Services Tools, Server Manager, Storage Migration Service Management Tools, Storage Replica Module for Windows PowerShell, System Insights Module for Windows PowerShell, Volume Activation Tools, Windows Server Update Services Tools.	
▶ **Other features (17)**	Listed in order: AzureArcSetup, EMS and	Tech needs one of these tools or

	SAC Toolset for Windows (client edition), Graphics Tools, IrDA infrared, Legacy Console Host, MSIX Packaging Tool Driver, Microsoft WebDriver, OpenSSH Server, RAS Connection Manager Administration Kit (CMAK), RIP Listener, Simple Network Management Protocol (SNMP), TPM Diagnostics, WMI SNMP Provider, Windows Fax and Scan, Windows Storage Management, Wireless Display, XPS Viewer.	services on this PC
Close	Button at the bottom of the window	Tech closes the window when finished

Tech tip: This is the same View features window, switched to the list of features that can be added. The link at the top switches back to the installed ones. Use the search box rather than scrolling through all 62. Wireless Display, the feature the Projecting to this PC page asks for, is in this list.

About

Navigation path: Settings → System → About

Item	Description	Scenario
Device info	Section header — "Copy" button	Tech copies the specs to paste into a ticket or email
▸ **Device name**	"[device name]"	Tech confirms they're on the right PC before changing settings
▸ **Processor**	"Intel(R) Core(TM) Ultra 7 265F (2.40 GHz)"	Customer asks whether their PC meets a program's minimum processor
▸ **Installed RAM**	"32.0 GB (31.6 GB usable)"	Tech compares installed and usable memory to see whether it's all being used
▸ **Graphics card**	"NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5060 (8 GB)"	Customer asks whether their PC can run a game
▸ **Storage**	"642 GB of 1.14 TB used"	Customer's drive is filling up; tech sees the total at a glance
▸ **Device ID**	Long ID string, specific to this PC	Microsoft support or a tech

		asks for the Device ID to identify the PC
▸ **Product ID**	Long ID string, specific to this PC (not the product key)	Tech identifies the license type of the PC
▸ **System type**	"64-bit operating system, x64-based processor"	Customer needs to know whether to download the 32-bit or 64-bit version of a program
▸ **Pen and touch**	"No pen or touch input is available for this display"	Customer asks why pen or touch settings are missing
Related links (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Domain or workgroup**	Link — opens a separate classic Windows window	Tech joins a PC to a work network or changes its workgroup
▸ **System protection**	Link — opens a separate classic Windows window	Tech turns on restore points
▸ **Advanced system settings**	Link — opens a separate classic Windows window	Tech opens the classic System Properties window

Windows info	Section header — "Copy" button	Tech copies the Windows version details into a ticket
▸ **Edition**	"Windows 11 Pro"	Tech confirms the edition before promising a feature, since some features, such as hosting Remote Desktop, need Pro
▸ **Version**	"26H2"	Tech confirms which feature update the PC is on before following a how-to
▸ **Installed on**	"6/19/2026"	Tech checks how old a customer's Windows installation is
▸ **OS build**	"26300.9711"	Tech matches the build against Microsoft's release notes when chasing a specific update problem

▶ **Experience**	"Windows Feature Experience Pack 1000.26100.372.0"	Tech notes the Feature Experience Pack version, which is listed separately from the OS build
▶ **Microsoft Services Agreement**	Link	Customer asks about the terms of their Microsoft account services
▶ **Microsoft Software License Terms**	Link	Customer or business asks about licensing terms
CE mark	Logo shown below the license links — not a control	Customer asks what the CE logo means — it's a regulatory mark, not a setting

Tech tip: Product ID is not the product key, so use the Activation page for license status. Installed RAM and usable RAM can differ slightly because some memory is reserved by the hardware, but a large gap often points to a seating or BIOS problem — worth knowing when a customer says "I installed 32 GB and only see 16."

SECTION 11 OF 12



Time & Language

10 Settings screens · pages 448–470

- Date & Time
- Language & Region
- Typing
- Speech

Richard Stevens

Time & Language

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Time & Language Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language

Item	Description	Scenario
Clock and date (top of page)	The current time in large type with the full date under it	Customer says their clock is wrong, and the tech sees the time and date at a glance
Time zone tile	Time zone icon. Title “Time zone”. Shows the current time zone, written as a UTC offset and the zone name	Customer traveled or moved and the tech checks the time zone without opening Date & time
Region tile	Globe icon. Title “Region”. Shows the current country or region	Tech checks the region without opening Language & region
Date & time	Clock icon. Subtext: “Time zones, automatic clock settings, calendar display”. Opens the Date	Customer’s clock is wrong or shows the wrong time zone

	& time page (documented below)	
Language & region	Language icon. Subtext: “Windows display language, preferred languages, regional formats”. Opens the Language & region page (documented below)	Customer wants a different display language or regional format
Typing	Keyboard icon. Subtext: “Touch keyboard, text suggestions, preferences”. Opens the Typing page (documented below)	Customer wants to change autocorrect or touch keyboard behavior
Speech	Voice icon. Subtext: “Speech language, speech recognition microphone setup, voices”. Opens the Speech page (documented below)	Customer wants to change the speech language or text-to-speech voice

Tech tip: The Time zone and Region tiles at the top show the current values at a glance. Each row below opens the page of the same name.

Date & Time

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Date & time

Item	Description	Scenario

Live clock display	The current time and date, shown large at the top	Customer says their clock is wrong, or the tech confirms the PC has the right time
Time zone	Dropdown showing the current time zone, written as a UTC offset followed by the zone name	Customer traveled or moved and the clock is an hour or more off
Region	The current country or region	Customer's time zone list or local content does not match where they are
Set time zone automatically	Toggle, On	Customer's time zone does not change when they travel, or keeps changing and they want to set it by hand
Set time automatically	Toggle, On	Customer's clock drifts, or they need to set the time by hand
Show time and date in the System tray	Subtext: "Turn this off to hide your time and date information on the taskbar". Toggle, On,	Customer's taskbar clock is missing, or they want to hide it

	expanded below	
▶ **Show seconds in system tray clock (uses more power)**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants the clock to show seconds
▶ **Additional clock 1**	“Not set”. Change button and “...” (more options)	Customer works with someone in another time zone and wants a second clock
▶ **Additional clock 2**	“Not set”. Change button and “...” (more options)	Customer wants a third clock for another time zone
Change the date and time format	Opens the page documented below as Date & time → Change the date and time format	Customer wants dates and times shown in a different style
Show time in Notification Center	Toggle, On	Customer wants the time shown, or hidden, in the Notification Center
Additional settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Sync now**	Subtext: “Last successful time synchronization:”	Customer’s clock is wrong and the

	followed by the date and time. Checkmark and Sync now button (grayed out right after a successful sync). Expandable row, shown expanded (up arrow)	tech forces a sync with the time server
▷ **Change the time server**	“Change” button	Tech needs to point the PC at a different time server (NTP) when the default one is not working
Show additional calendars in the taskbar	Dropdown, “Don’t show additional calendars”	Customer wants the taskbar calendar to also show another calendar type
Related links (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Language & region**	Subtext: “Windows and some apps format dates and time based on your region”. Opens the Language & region page (documented below)	Customer wants dates and times formatted for another region
Related support (section	Section header	—

header)		
▶ **Help with Date & time**	Globe icon. Expandable row, shown expanded. Four links (below)	Customer or tech wants Microsoft's help articles on date and time
▷ **Setting your time and time zone manually**	Link	Customer's time or time zone is wrong and automatic setting does not work
▷ **Setting up Date and Time in Windows**	Link	Customer wants help with the basic date and time setup
▷ **Change time format in windows**	Link	Customer wants help changing how the time is displayed
▷ **Setting an alarm**	Link	Customer wants to set an alarm

Tech tip: A clock that keeps losing time, or resets after the PC has been powered off for a while, can point to a failing BIOS (CMOS) battery on the motherboard.

Date & Time → Change the Date and Time Format

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Date & time → Change the date and time format

Item	Description	Scenario

Calendar	Dropdown, “Gregorian Calendar”	Customer needs a different calendar system
First day of week	Dropdown, “Sunday”	Customer wants calendars to start the week on Monday or another day
Short date	Dropdown, for example “4/5/2017” (format example)	Customer wants dates written another way, for example day first
Long date	Dropdown, for example “Wednesday, April 5,” (format example, truncated)	Customer wants the long form of the date written differently
Short time	Dropdown, for example “9:40 AM” / “2:40 PM”	Customer wants 24-hour time instead of AM/PM
Long time	Dropdown, for example “9:40:07 AM” / “2:40:0…” (format example, truncated)	Customer wants the long time format changed
AM/PM symbol	“Change” button	Customer wants a different AM/PM symbol
Format examples text	“The dates and times above are provided as format examples.”	—

	Descriptive text	
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Change number format**	Opens the Number format page (documented below)	Customer needs different decimal or grouping symbols
▸ **Change currency format**	Opens the Currency format page (documented below)	Customer needs a different currency symbol or style

Tech tip: Use this page when a customer needs dates and times displayed in another convention, such as an international date format, 24-hour time or a different calendar.

Date & Time → Change the Date and Time Format → Change Number Format

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Date & time → Change the date and time format → Change number format

Item	Description	Scenario
Decimal symbol	Dropdown, “.”	Customer works with documents that use a comma as the decimal mark

Number of digits after decimal	Dropdown, “2”	Customer wants more or fewer decimal places
Digit grouping symbol	Dropdown, “,”	Customer needs a different thousands separator
Digit grouping	Dropdown, “123,456,789”	Customer needs a different grouping pattern
Negative sign symbol	Dropdown, “-”	Customer needs a different negative sign
Negative number format	Dropdown, “-1.1”	Customer needs negative numbers written another way
Display leading zeros	Dropdown, “0.7”	Customer wants numbers below 1 written with or without a leading zero
List separator	Dropdown, “,”	Customer’s spreadsheet imports split the wrong way because of the list separator
Measurement system	Dropdown, “U.S.”	Customer wants metric or U.S.

		measurements
Standard digits	Dropdown, “0123456789”	Customer wants a different set of digits
Use native digits	Dropdown, “Never”	Customer wants digits shown in their own script

Tech tip: Number format matters most to customers who work with international documents or spreadsheets.

Date & Time → Change the Date and Time Format → Change Currency Format

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Date & time → Change the date and time format → Change currency format

Item	Description	Scenario
Currency symbol	Dropdown, “$”	Customer works with invoices in another currency
Positive currency format	Dropdown, “$1.1”	Customer wants the symbol before or after the amount
Negative currency format	Dropdown, “($1.1)”	Customer wants negative amounts written another way
Decimal	Dropdown, “.”	Customer needs

symbol		a different decimal mark for amounts
Number of digits after decimal	Dropdown, “2”	Customer wants more or fewer decimal places on amounts
Digit grouping symbol	Dropdown, “,”	Customer needs a different thousands separator for amounts
Digit grouping	Dropdown, “123,456,789”	Customer needs a different grouping pattern for amounts
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Change number format**	Opens the Number format page (documented above)	Customer wants to change number formatting too
▸ **Change date & time format**	Opens the Date and time format page (documented above)	Customer wants to change date and time formatting too

Tech tip: Currency format matters most to customers who work with international invoices or e-commerce.

Language & Region

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Language & region

Item	Description	Scenario
Language (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Windows display language**	Subtext: “Windows features like Settings and File Explorer will appear in this language”. Dropdown, currently “English (United States)”	Customer wants Windows menus and Settings in another language
▸ **Preferred languages**	Subtext: “Microsoft Store apps will appear in the first supported language in this list”. “Add a language” button	Customer wants to add a language for typing, speech or apps
▹ **Language entry**	One row per installed language, for example “English (United States)”, listing what is installed: language pack, text-to-speech, speech recognition, handwriting, basic typing. Drag handle and “...” (more options)	Customer wants to reorder or remove a language

Region (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Country or region**	Subtext: “Windows and apps might use your country or region to give you local content”. Dropdown	Customer moved to a new country and local content is wrong
▶ **Regional format**	Subtext: “Windows and some apps format numbers, currency, date and time based on your regional format”. Dropdown, “Recommended”, expanded below	Customer wants dates, numbers and currency formatted for another region
▷ **Number format**	Opens the same page as Date & time → Change the date and time format → Change number format	Customer needs a different number style
▷ **Currency format**	Opens the same page as Date & time → Change the date and time format → Change currency format	Customer needs a different currency style
▷ **Date & time format**	Opens the same page as Date & time → Change the date and time format	Customer needs a different date or time style
▶ **Device setup**	Subtext: “Country or	Tech checks

region	region selected during device setup". Display only	which region the device was set up in
Additional settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Copy current user settings to welcome screen and system accounts**	Subtext: "This includes display language, input language, format and location". Checkmark (applied); Copy button	Tech sets up a PC for someone else and wants the sign-in screen to match
▸ **Copy current user settings to new user accounts**	Subtext: "This includes display language, input language, format and location". Checkmark (applied); Copy button	Tech wants new accounts on the PC to start with the same language and region

Tech tip: Number format, Currency format and Date & time format here open the same pages documented under Date & time → Change the date and time format.

Typing

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Typing

Item	Description	Scenario
Touch keyboard	Expandable section	Customer uses a touch keyboard and wants to

		change how it behaves
▸ **Play key sounds as I type**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the touch keyboard quiet, or wants key sounds
▸ **Capitalize the first letter of each sentence**	Checkbox, checked	Customer's touch keyboard capitalizes when they do not want it to
▸ **Add a period after I double-tap the Spacebar**	Checkbox, checked	Customer's touch keyboard adds a period when they double-tap Space
▸ **Show the voice typing mic button**	Checkbox, checked	Customer wants the dictation button shown, or hidden, on the touch keyboard
▸ **Show the touch keyboard**	Dropdown, "When no keyboard attached"	Customer wants the touch keyboard to appear, or not appear, on a 2-in-1
▸ **Related**	Link	Customer wants

links: Size and theme		to change the size or look of the touch keyboard
Show text suggestions when typing on the physical keyboard	Subtext: “Not available in some languages”. Toggle, Off	Customer wants word suggestions while typing on a normal keyboard
Multilingual text suggestions	Subtext: “Show text suggestions based on my language preferences”. Toggle, Off	Customer types in more than one language and wants suggestions for each
Autocorrect misspelled words	Toggle, On	Customer’s typing is being changed when they do not want it to, or they want it turned on
Highlight misspelled words	Toggle, On	Customer wants red underlines on misspelled words, or wants them gone
Typing insights	Subtext: “View your typing and corrections history”. Opens the Typing insights page	Customer is curious how much typing Windows has

	(documented below)	helped with
Advanced keyboard settings	Opens the Advanced keyboard settings page (documented below)	Customer needs to change which input method is used or how switching works
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Language & region**	Subtext: “Windows display language, preferred languages, regional formats”. Link	Customer wants to change the display language or add a language
▶ **Inking & typing personalization**	Subtext: “Custom dictionary”. Link	Customer wants to edit or clear their custom dictionary
▶ **Text cursor**	Subtext: “Color, size, thickness”. Link	Customer has trouble seeing the text cursor

Tech tip: If a customer wants Windows to autocorrect or highlight spelling mistakes as they type, the two toggles are on this page. If they switch between several keyboard languages and the wrong input method is active, check Advanced keyboard settings.

Typing → Typing Insights

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Typing → Typing insights

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	Text explaining that Windows uses AI to suggest words, autocorrect and interpret swiped typing, that the statistics are stored only on the device, and that Microsoft does not collect typing insights data	Customer asks whether Microsoft collects their typing
Autocompleted words	Counter, for example “0”. Text: “As you start typing, we make suggestions so you can quickly finish a word.”	Customer wants to know how many words Windows has finished for them
Suggested words	Counter, for example “0”. Text: “We’ll even guess your next word before you start typing it.”	Customer wants to know how many next words Windows has suggested
Keystrokes saved	Counter, for example “0”. Text: “With text suggestions and swiped words, you save time by avoiding keystrokes.”	Customer wants to know how many keystrokes suggestions have saved
Spelling	Counter, for example	Customer wants

corrections	“0”. Text: “We all make typos, and we’re here to make sure they don’t slip through the cracks.”	to know how many typos Windows has corrected
Swiped words	Counter, for example “0”. Text: “Did you know that you can swipe your finger on a touch keyboard to type?”	Customer uses swipe typing and wants to see how often

Tech tip: The counters only grow when text suggestions, autocorrect or the touch keyboard are used, so all zeros is normal on a PC typed on with a physical keyboard.

Typing → Advanced Keyboard Settings

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Typing → Advanced keyboard settings

Item	Description	Scenario
Override for default input method	Subtext: “If you want to use an input method that’s different than the first one in your language list, choose it here”. Dropdown, “Use language list (recommended)”	Customer’s keyboard types in the wrong language by default
Switching input methods (section header)	Section header	—

▸ **Let me use a different input method for each app window**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants each program to remember its own input language
▸ **Use the desktop language bar when it's available**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer wants the older language bar back
▸ **Language bar options**	Link	Customer wants to adjust the language bar
▸ **Input language hot keys**	Link	Customer presses a shortcut by accident and the keyboard language changes

Tech tip: When a keyboard suddenly types the wrong characters, the customer has often switched input method by accident with Alt + Shift or Windows logo key + Space. Set Override for default input method here, and use Input language hot keys to change or turn off that shortcut.

Speech

Navigation path: Settings → Time & language → Speech

Item	Description	Scenario

Page description (top of page)	Text under the page title: “Choose the primary language you speak, manage voices for your device and apps, and set up your microphone.”	—
Speech language (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Choose the language you speak with your device**	Dropdown, “English (United States)”	Customer wants speech recognition to expect a different language
▸ **Recognize non-native accents for this language**	Checkbox, unchecked	Customer has an accent and speech recognition misses words
Voices (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Choose a voice**	Dropdown, “Microsoft David”	Customer wants a different text-to-speech voice
▸ **Voice speed**	Slider	Customer says the voice reads too fast or too

		slowly
▶ **Listen to voice sample**	“Preview voice” button	Customer wants to hear a voice before choosing it
Manage voices (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Add voices**	“+” button	Customer wants more voices or languages
▶ **Installed voice packages**	Subtext: “Select a voice package to remove it.” One row per installed package, for example “English (United States)” with its size	Customer wants to free up space by removing a voice package
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▶ **Speech privacy settings**	Link	Customer wants to check or change what speech data is shared
Related support (section	Section header	—

header)		
▶ **Help with Speech**	Globe icon. Expandable row, shown expanded. One link (below)	Customer or tech wants Microsoft's help articles on speech
▷ **Opening the dictation toolbar**	Link	Customer wants to start dictating and cannot find the dictation toolbar

Tech tip: The voice chosen here is used by apps that read text aloud. Narrator has its own voice setting under Accessibility → Narrator. Speech privacy settings opens Privacy & security → Speech, where online speech recognition is turned on or off.

SECTION 12 OF 12

Windows Update

7 Settings screens · pages 472–487

- Update History
- Advanced Options
- Windows Insider Program

Richard Stevens

Windows Update

Captured on: Windows 11 Pro, version 26H2, OS build 26300.9711

Windows Update Overview

Navigation path: Settings → Windows Update

Item	Description	Scenario
Update status	Status heading, for example “You’re up to date”, with “Last checked:” and the time. Check for updates button	Customer wants to know whether their PC is up to date
More options (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Get the latest updates as soon as they’re available**	Toggle, On. Subtext: “Be among the first to get the latest non-security updates, fixes, and improvements as they roll out.” Learn more link	Customer wants new features as soon as Microsoft releases them
▸ **Pause updates**	Subtext: “Select the date to pause updates until.” Learn more link. Pick a date button with a calendar icon	Customer has a deadline and does not want an update restart this week
▸ **Update history**	Opens the Update history page	Tech wants to see what was

	(documented below)	installed recently
▸ **Advanced options**	Subtext: “Delivery optimization, optional updates, active hours, other update settings”. Opens the Advanced options page (documented below)	Customer wants to change when updates restart the PC
▸ **Windows Insider Program**	Subtext: “Get preview builds of Windows to share feedback on new features and updates”. Opens the Windows Insider Program page (documented below)	Customer asks how to try upcoming Windows features early
Carbon emissions line	“Windows Update is committed to helping reduce carbon emissions.” Learn more link	Customer asks what the leaf message under the options means
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help with Windows Update**	Expandable row, expanded. Four links: “Uninstalling problematic Windows updates easily”, “Installing pending Windows updates easily”,	Customer wants Microsoft’s help on removing an update that caused a problem

	“Manually updating your device drivers”, “Pausing updates for a convenient time”	

Tech tip: Check for updates and Pause updates are the two controls customers use most. Pausing only delays updates; once the pause ends, Windows installs everything that is waiting before it can be paused again.

Update History

Navigation path: Settings → Windows Update → Update history

Item	Description	Scenario
Feature Updates	Expandable row with a count, for example “(2)”. Each entry shows the Windows version, for example “Windows 11, version 26H2”, with “Successfully installed on” and a date. The newest has a See what’s new link	Customer wants to know when their PC moved to the latest Windows version
Quality Updates	Expandable row with a count, for example “(50)”. Each entry shows the update name and KB number, for example “2026-10 Security Update (KB5127648)	Tech looks up the KB number of an update that may have caused a problem

	(26300.9711)", its install status and a Learn more link	
Driver Updates	Expandable row with a count, for example "(29)". One entry per driver installed through Windows Update	Customer's printer or graphics card stopped working after an update, and the tech checks for a recent driver
Definition Updates	Expandable row with a count, for example "(24)". Microsoft Defender security intelligence updates	Tech confirms the antivirus definitions are updating
Other Updates	Expandable row with a count, for example "(5)". Updates that fit none of the other groups	Tech reviews anything else Windows Update installed
Related settings (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Uninstall updates**	Trash can icon. Opens a list of installed updates, each with an Uninstall button	Customer wants a problem update removed
▸ **Recovery**	Opens the System → Recovery page,	Customer wants to go back to the

	documented in the System section	previous version of Windows
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help from the web**	Expandable row, expanded. Four links: “Managing update restart schedules”, “Resolving failed update issues”, “Fixing stuck Windows updates”, “Backing-up and Restore”	Customer’s update keeps failing and they want Microsoft’s troubleshooting steps

Tech tip: Uninstall updates is the quickest way to roll back a single problem update, for example a driver that broke a device. Each group keeps its own count, which gives a fast picture of how the PC has been updating. The entries and counts differ on every PC.

Advanced Options

Navigation path: Settings → Windows Update → Advanced options

Item	Description	Scenario
Receive updates for other Microsoft products	Subtext: “Get updates for other apps and services together with Windows updates.” Learn more link. Toggle, Off	Customer’s Office apps are out of date and they want them updated with

		Windows
Get me up to date	Subtext: “Restart as soon as possible (even during active hours) to finish updating, and notify me 15 minutes before restarting so I can make sure this device is on and plugged in”. Toggle, Off	Tech wants a PC fully updated today, even if it restarts during work hours
Download updates over metered connections	Subtext: “Data charges may apply”. Toggle, Off	Customer on a phone hotspot does not want updates using their data
Notify me when a restart is required to finish updating	Subtext: “Show notification when your device requires a restart to finish updating”. Toggle, On	Customer was surprised by an update restart and wants a warning first
Active hours	Subtext: “We won’t restart your device during these hours”. Shows the current range, for example “7:00 AM to 1:00 AM”. Expandable row	Customer’s PC restarted for updates in the middle of work
Additional options (section header)	Section header	—

▶ **Optional updates**	Subtext: “Feature, quality, and driver updates”, with how many are available, for example “0 available”. Opens the Optional updates page (documented below)	Customer has a hardware problem and wants to check for an optional driver
▶ **Delivery Optimization**	Subtext: “Bandwidth limits for updates, downloads from other devices”. Opens the Delivery Optimization page (documented below)	Customer’s internet slows down while updates download
▶ **Recovery**	Subtext: “Reset, advanced startup, go back”. Opens the System → Recovery page, documented in the System section	Tech needs advanced startup to fix a PC that will not boot properly
▶ **Restart apps**	Subtext: “Automatically save my restartable apps when I sign out and restart them after I sign in”. Does not have a page of its own; opens Accounts → Sign-in options at the matching toggle, documented in the Accounts section	Customer wants their apps to reopen after an update restart

▸ **Configured update policies**	Opens the Configured update policies page (documented below)	Tech checks why some update settings are grayed out
Related support (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Help from the web**	Expandable row, expanded. Four links: “Managing update delivery optimization”, “Resetting your PC for a fresh start”, “Checking update history logs”, “Pausing automatic updates”	Customer wants Microsoft’s guidance on controlling updates

Tech tip: Setting Active hours to the hours the customer actually uses the PC is the simplest fix for surprise restarts. Restart apps has no page of its own; it jumps straight to Accounts → Sign-in options, so do not look for a separate Restart apps page.

Advanced Options → Optional Updates

Navigation path: Settings → Windows Update → Advanced options → Optional updates

Item	Description	Scenario
No updates message	“There are no optional updates available at this	Customer asks why the page is

	time.” Shown on 26H2 when nothing is waiting	empty
Driver updates	Seen on 25H2 when updates were waiting. Expandable row with a count, for example “(2)”. Text: “If you have a specific problem, one of these drivers might help. Otherwise, automatic updates will keep your drivers up to date.” One checkbox per driver	Customer’s printer or other device is not working right, and an optional driver may fix it
Download & install	Seen on 25H2. Button, grayed out until at least one update is checked	Customer has picked a driver and wants to install it

Tech tip: Only install optional drivers to fix a specific problem; otherwise automatic updates keep drivers current. The page can also list optional feature and quality updates, so the groups shown change with what is available. The breadcrumb at the top shows “...” in place of the earlier pages.

Advanced Options → Delivery Optimization

Navigation path: Settings → Windows Update → Advanced options → Delivery Optimization

Item	Description	Scenario
Page	“Delivery Optimization	—

description (top of page)	downloads updates from Windows, Microsoft Store, and other Microsoft products quickly and reliably.”	
Allow downloads from other devices	Two-monitor icon. Subtext: “If you turn this on, your device may send parts of previously downloaded Windows updates and apps to devices on your local network or on the internet”. Toggle, On. Expandable row, expanded	Customer is worried their PC is sharing update files with strangers
▶ **Devices on my local network**	Radio button, selected	Household with several PCs wants them to share updates with each other only
▶ **Devices on the internet and my local network**	Radio button, not selected. Text: “Your device won’t upload content to other devices on the internet when Windows detects you’re on a metered network”	Customer asks what the internet option shares and when it stops
Related links (section	Section header	—

header)		
▸ **More about Delivery Optimization and privacy**	Link	Customer wants Microsoft's explanation of what is shared
Download options	Two-monitor icon. Subtext: "Limit bandwidth used for downloads." Dropdown, "Percentage of measured bandwidth". Expandable row, expanded	Customer's video calls stutter while updates download
▸ **Background limit as a %**	Checkbox, unchecked, with a number box, for example "45". Text: "Limit how much bandwidth (5% - 100%) is used for downloading background updates (measured against the update source)"	Customer wants background updates to use less of their connection
▸ **Foreground limit as a %**	Checkbox, unchecked, with a number box, for example "90". Text: "Limit how much bandwidth (5% - 100%) is used for downloading foreground updates (measured against the update source)"	Customer wants updates they start by hand to leave some bandwidth free

Upload options	Two-monitor icon. Subtext: “Limit bandwidth used for uploads. Applicable to uploads to devices on the internet”. Expandable row, expanded	Customer on a slow upload connection wants sharing limited
▸ **Limit as a % of measured bandwidth**	Toggle, Off	Customer wants to cap upload speed
▸ **Limit as a % of measured upload bandwidth**	Slider, grayed out while the toggle above is Off. Text: “Limit bandwidth used for uploading to other devices on the internet”	Customer wants a specific upload cap
▸ **Monthly upload limit (GB)**	Number box, for example “500”. Text: “Limit how much data (5 GB - 500 GB) can be uploaded to other devices on the internet each month”	Customer on a data cap wants to limit monthly uploads
Activity monitor	Pie chart icon. Subtext: “Download and upload usage”. Expandable row, expanded	Tech checks where update downloads actually came from
▸ **Download Statistics**	Sub-heading with the start date of the period, for example “since	—

	10/1/2026”	
▶ **Download breakdown**	Donut chart with four sources and their share and size: From Microsoft, From Microsoft cache server, From PCs on your local network, From PCs on the Internet	Tech confirms whether other PCs are sharing updates with this one
▶ **Average download speed (user initiated)**	A speed, for example “9.3 Mbps”	Tech checks how fast updates the customer started downloaded
▶ **Average download speed (background)**	A speed, for example “23.5 Mbps”	Tech checks how fast automatic updates downloaded
▶ **Upload Statistics**	Sub-heading with the same start date	—
▶ **Uploaded to PCs on the Internet**	Amount uploaded, or “N/A”	Customer wants proof their PC is not uploading to strangers
▶ **Uploaded to PCs on your local network**	Amount uploaded, or “N/A”	Tech checks whether this PC is helping other PCs in the home update

Tech tip: Delivery Optimization is Windows' peer-to-peer update sharing. With Devices on my local network, PCs in the same home or office share update pieces and save internet bandwidth; the internet option shares more widely and is often turned off in businesses. If Activity monitor shows everything coming from Microsoft, no other PC on the network is sharing. The figures on this page differ on every PC and change over time.

Advanced Options → Configured Update Policies

Navigation path: Settings → Windows Update → Advanced options → Configured update policies

Item	Description	Scenario
Page description (top of page)	"Some settings and controls might not be available for you if your organization has set policies to manage updates, or if you've joined the Windows Insider Program."	—
Policies set on your device (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **Status**	"No policies have been configured yet", or one row per policy that is in force	Customer's update settings are grayed out and the tech checks whether

		a policy is the cause

Tech tip: When Windows Update options are grayed out or missing, this page shows whether an organization's policy (Group Policy, Intune or other device management) is the cause rather than a fault. A home PC normally shows "No policies have been configured yet". Joining the Insider Program can also lock some settings.

Windows Insider Program

Navigation path: Settings → Windows Update → Windows Insider Program

Item	Description	Scenario
Warning banner	Yellow banner with an exclamation icon: "To join the Insider Program, turn on optional diagnostic data". Open Diagnostics & feedback link	Customer cannot join the Insider Program and does not know why
Join the Windows Insider Program (section header)	Three-hearts icon. "Shape the future of Windows by trying new features early and sharing your feedback."	—
▶ **Be the first to try new features**	"Get early access to upcoming Windows capabilities and OS	Customer wants new features before everyone

	improvements.”	else
▸ **Help improve Windows for everyone**	“Your feedback directly influences what we build and ship.”	Customer wants to send feedback to Microsoft
▸ **Connect with the community**	“Discover tips, insights, and stories from other Windows Insiders and Microsoft experts.”	Customer wants to learn from other Insiders
▸ **Get invited to exclusive insider opportunities**	“Join special events and feature previews.”	Customer asks what extra perks the program has
Get started	Button, grayed out until optional diagnostic data is turned on	Customer is ready to join once the diagnostic setting is changed
Related links (section header)	Section header	—
▸ **About Windows Insider Program**	Link	Customer wants to read about the program before joining

Tech tip: Joining requires optional diagnostic data, which is set under Privacy & security → Diagnostics & feedback. Insider builds are pre-release and can be less stable, so they are best kept off a customer’s only or work PC.

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